BENNETT, COLEMAN & CO. LTD. | Estd. 1838 | VOL. 43 NO. 260 BENGALURU | TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 3, 2026 | METRO | PAGES 28 | PRICE ₹5

Karl Bushby, 57, completes 28-year, 51,000-km walk around the world and returns to mother's house in northern England, P 16

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A clip of actor Dia Mirza urging citizens to shun fire crackers as part of Mumbai civic corporation's anti-pollution campaign **triggers political slugfest, BMC takes down the video** from its social media pages, **P 15**

Tucker Carlson, former Fox News host and penitent Trump loyalist, says US Prez may be hours away from ordering nuclear strike on Iran under pressure from Benjamin Netanyahu, **P 16**

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A 60-SECOND DAILY WORD CHALLENGE. Crack the word, build your streak, share your score. Top scorers get featured in **TOI**

Mercedes driver Kimi Antonelli becomes youngest F1 world champion at 20, breaking Vettel's record (he was over 23). Antonelli finished 3rd in dramatic Mexico City GP, which was won by Red Bull's Verstappen, **P 19**

B'luru teen bags Youth Oly bronze

Teen talent Dhinidhi Desinghu continued her impressive rise with a bronze in the women's 100m freestyle at the Youth Olympic Games in Dakar, Senegal, Monday. The 16-year-old clocked 56.27 secs to finish third, **reports Chitrangada C.** **P 18**

Truck carrying illegal liquor runs over cop

Inspector Dilip Puri, who was leading a late-night crackdown on liquor smuggling in an MP district that saw a dozen hooch-linked deaths recently, was run over early Monday by one of the trucks he had stopped. TNN

5 days on, no trace of 7 U'kashi trekkers

Search teams found tents near the location of eight people missing on Kedartal trekking route in Uttarkashi, but there was no trace of seven trekkers and their guide, five days after they were scheduled to return. **P 15**

8 villagers building road electrocuted

Eight road workers were electrocuted and five injured after an iron pipe attached to a cement mixer came into contact with an 11,000-volt overhead line in Chhapoli of Rajasthan's Jhunjhunu Monday. TNN

Upper Siang shut over anti-dam stir

Despite Arunachal CM's word, a 36-hr bandh took effect in Upper Siang Monday after the govt failed to release 40 arrested in the Oct-23 violence in Pasighat in standoff over the proposed multipurpose dam project. **P 11**

After apology, HC extends relief to actor Imran Khan

'You Cannot Behave Like An Indian Citizen'

Swati.Deshpande
@timesofindia.com

Mumbai: Bombay high court on Monday extended its interim protection against a 'Leave India' notice to actor Imran Khan Pal, a 44-year-old US citizen and Overseas Citizen of India (OCI), after he filed an undertaking and an unconditional apology as directed by the court.

The Union govt's Foreigner Registration Regional Officer (FRRO) had given him two weeks to leave India, four days after registering an FIR against Khan for unlawful assembly in Mumbai during an Oct 10 protest against the ongoing SIR and CEC.

Additional Solicitor General (ASG) Anil Singh said, "Centre through the FRRO has unfettered rights to deport such a person," a foreigner (Khan) from India, "without the need to establish any jurisdictional fact."

The high court order by Chief Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi and Justice Advait Sethna said: "The state, in exercise of its sovereign functions, would have the right to deport a person out of India in a given case. To further clarify this aspect and clarify its stand, Centre agreed to file an affidavit."

HC said Khan's senior counsel V R Dhond "fairly acknowledged the limitations of an OCI card holder, who is not an Indian citizen". The HC was hearing Khan's challenge to the FRRO's "arbitrary" notice.

"You cannot behave like an Indian citizen. You are not even remotely associated with the SIR process," said the CJ orally to Khan, via Dhond.

"The right to protest is not even available to you as an OCI…," added Justice Sethna.

▶ **Visa doesn't mean..., P 12**

What were you (Imran) there for? There is a difference between rights of an OCI card holder and citizen of India. You will have to categorically make a statement that you have no association with the protest... **you had no remote cause...**

If an Indian was doing this in another country, would it have been permissible or tolerated...

—Bombay HC

DKS asks KMF to reconsider curd price hike

Bengaluru: Under pressure from hoteliers and consumers, chief minister D K Shivakumar on Monday said he has asked the Karnataka Milk Federation (KMF) to reconsider the hike in curd prices, even as he defended the increase in milk rates. "I have asked KMF to reconsider as it is becoming too expensive for the public. They will look into it," he added. Curd rates rose by Rs 14 a litre, from Rs 54 to Rs 68, after the govt raised milk prices by Rs 8.

However, he ruled out a rollback in milk prices. "The hike in fuel prices has had a cascading effect on dairy farmers... We discussed the issue of milk price hike in detail and arrived at it."

With a hike in bus fares also looming, he said the govt was giving special grants to run state buses. "With the situation being dire, we have let transport corporations decide on pricing," he said. TNN

Khata upgrade hits wall as upload errors, tech glitches stall applications

Santoshkumar.B
@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Thousands of property owners waiting to upgrade from B-khata to A-khata within GBA limits are stuck, with portal glitches and document-upload failures holding up their applications for over 10 days now.

Without A-khata, owners struggle to access civic services, complete property transactions or get bank loans. Many said sales and registrations had stalled, while some claimed their applications were rejected despite repeated online attempts.

There's no clear indication of how soon the system will be restored, sources said.

The delay follows the Sept 22 launch of upgraded e-Aasthi 2.0 software, meant to simplify khata services, cut paperwork and reduce visits to govt offices. Citizens soon complained of trouble uploading documents. GBA officials said minor glitches in the early days had been fixed and maintained there were no major problems with the software, but complaints continued.

Greater Bengaluru development minister Krishna Byre Gowda told **TOI** officials found some owners had uploaded blank files, wrong property photos or incorrect locations.

▶ **Special adalats, P 4**

OF 7L, 80K APPLY

- Govt launched 100-day **Namma Khate Namma Hakku campaign that ended in Aug**
- Campaign targeted 7 lakh B-khata properties, but received only **80,400 applications by end of Aug**
- Many **property owners claim that their applications were rejected** despite repeated online attempts

'Airfares up by 700%': Don't fly, says top court

New Delhi: Supreme Court Monday refused to urgently list a plea against steep rise in domestic airfares during Diwali season and seeking a direction to Centre to frame a mechanism to cap airfares on domestic routes during festival periods.

The issue of regulation of airfares is still pending before SC, a bench hearing the plea was informed while seeking the court's intervention. But the court turned down the plea.

Advocate Abhinav, appearing for the petitioner, submitted that fares have gone up 700% amounts to a violation of Article 14 of the Constitution. "Don't travel by air," the bench said.

The Centre had earlier told the top court that the rules on airfares under Bharatiya Vayuyan Adhiniyam, 2024, will be published in two weeks. TNN

▶ **IndiGo hires 600 pilots, will add another 400, P 17**

HDK: Focus on who ran sting op, not on who uploaded it

Bengaluru: Union minister HD Kumaraswamy Monday questioned why police were concentrating on identifying who uploaded the sting video allegedly targeting ex-CM Siddaramaiah, instead of probing who recorded it & who masterminded the operation.

Questioning the timing of police commissioner Seemant Kumar Singh's statement that the phone used to upload the video had changed hands at his Delhi residence, HDK alleged that the police statement followed a meeting involving CM, DGP and the commissioner. TNN

▶ **Claims conspiracy, P 6**

SC orders trial in Ram temple donation case

New Delhi: Five months after news broke of pilferage of donations at Ayodhya Ram temple, Supreme Court cleared trial of eight people, who figure in the chargesheet filed by the SIT for allegedly siphoning Rs 2.7 crore.

It also gave the petitioners, who had sought probe, the status of victims of crime and allowed them to assist in the trial, **reports Dhananjay Mahapatra**.

The SIT's status report informed the top court that financial and forensic examination extended to cash deposits, transactions, property purchases, construction expenditure, vehicles, jewellery, other assets, and event-related spendings. "The amount of alleged embezzlement is approximately Rs 2.7 crore," the report said.

On Monday, solicitor general Tushar Mehta explained to the court the process that involved scrutiny of bank accounts and acquisition of immoveable properties by the accused, as well as examination of CCTV footage that culminated the chargesheet Sept 23.

▶ **CCTV must not invade neighbours' privacy: HC, P 7**
▶ **EC can't monopolise voter awareness drives: SC, P 12**

▶ **Petitioners as victims, P 8**

Contractors meet DKS, govt may relax tender norms

Bengaluru: The state govt is considering relaxing tender eligibility norms, including the turnover requirement, as contractors on Monday urged chief minister DK Shivakumar to clear Rs 38,000 crore in pending bills and stop inviting tenders for works without budgetary allocation.

In a memorandum submitted at a meeting with the CM, the Karnataka State Contractors' Association demanded that new development works be taken up only after clearing outstanding bills. TNN

▶ **MLAs' interference, P 6**

FM weighs in on Tata row: 'Should be resolved amicably, internally'

Mumbai: Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman said on Monday the dispute between Tata Trusts and Tata Sons should be resolved amicably, describing the salt-to-software conglomerate as a critical component of the Indian economy.

In her first public comments on the dispute, she said govt would prefer an early resolution that allowed the group to return to normal functioning. "I know the brand value of Tata, the contribution that the Parsi community has made to make Tata a huge global brand. I also know the expanse of activity in which Tatas are invested in. So, this is a very critical component of the Indian economy, and therefore it has to be amicably settled among themselves," Sitharaman said during a fireside chat organised by Financial Express. TNN

▶ **No favouritism, P 17**

Darius Khambata won't seek fresh term at Trusts, calls Sept 17 a 'day of infamy'

Darius Khambata, a close ally of Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata, will leave Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and Sir Ratan Tata Trust when his term ends Nov 8. In a 4-page letter to Noel and Trusts CEO Siddharth Sharma, Khambata said he won't seek another term, even though both wanted him to stay. Khambata said Sept 17 was "a day that will live in infamy", referring to N Chandrasekaran being reappointed Tata Sons chairman for five more years, a move opposed by Noel. **P 17**

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ATTENTION: BEWARE OF AN UNAUTHORISED ENTITY MISUSING THE C. KRISHNIAH CHETTY NAME

The C. Krishniah Chetty Group is issuing this caution notice to protect from ongoing misrepresentations regarding our authentic heritage brand and business.

One conflicting new entity headed by a set of our own shareholders & directors in our company (viz: Mr. C. Ganesh Narayan & Mrs. C. Valli Narayan) along with Ms. Vidya Nataraj are misusing our respected name. It has come to our attention that these shareholders and directors are sending what's app, social media communications and operating an unauthorized parallel jewellery business under the name "BLUE CKC / C. KRISHNIAH CHETTY & CO." Furthermore, they are disseminating information claiming that multiple families are independently running multiple C. Krishniah Chetty jewellery companies. This claim is factually false, incorrect and misleading and is being strongly disputed by the C. Krishniah Chetty Group in appropriate legal forums.

There is only one authentic C. Krishniah Chetty Group, which operates four magnificent showrooms in Bengaluru. The authentic CKC Group is headed by a common set of directors & shareholders, namely:

C. V. Hayagriv • C. Vinod Hayagriv
C. Visala Hayagriv • C. Valli Narayan*
C. Triveni Vinod • C. Ganesh Narayan*
Chaitanya V Cotha • Shreyas V Cotha
*(*Now trying to run an in-conflict business entity)*

Under Section 166 of the Companies Act, 2013, which mandates the fiduciary duties of directors, none of the aforementioned individuals are permitted to operate a competing parallel business or independently utilize the "C. Krishniah Chetty" name. **A "No Objection Certificate" has never been issued to any party to use our trademark for any independent ventures.**

The C. Krishniah Chetty Group continues to operate as a single, unified entity, ethically and efficiently managed by the majority directors i.e. the "Hayagrivs". The "Narayans" have a vested interest herein despite which they are acting against the interests of the business they are still part of.

The in-conflict shareholders & directors, i.e. the "Narayans" (nor anyone else), have not been authorised to use our name and a "NO OBJECTION CERTIFICATE" for use of the same has never been issued.

Only one official & authentic C. Krishniah Chetty Group exists and involves the same set of common Board of Directors, which has been managing the business since 1869. The only official and authentic GROUP. The 3 business entities run by common directors and forming a part of the said Group are:

- C. Krishniah Chetty & Sons P Ltd
- C. Krishniah Chetty Jewellers P Ltd
- C. Krishniah Chetty & Sons Manufacturers P Ltd

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- **Parallel Operations:** Starting and operating an unauthorised parallel jewellery business while still being shareholders & directors in the C. Krishniah Chetty Group.
- **Trademark Circumvention:** Renaming their loss making entity earlier known as "Deepali Company P Ltd" to "C. Krishniah Chetty & C0." **deliberately substituting the letter 'O' with the numerical '0' (zero)** to circumvent Registrar of Companies (ROC) restrictions regarding already existing names.
- **Brand Infringement:** Using the phrase "Since I869" with the letter 'I' instead of the numerical number '1' as an attempt to bypass the Group's registered "1869" trademark.
- **Data Misappropriation:** Unauthorizedly accessing and using the C. Krishniah Chetty Group's legacy customer database to solicit clients. Please note that the Group has subsequently secured and sealed this database to protect customer privacy.

The C. Krishniah Chetty Group and the "Hayagrivs" have raised claims of over Rs.150 Cr (and counting) as damages & dues from the "Narayans".

CONSUMER ADVISORY

We urge our patrons to exercise caution. Jewellery or products sold by "BLUE CKC / C. KRISHNIAH CHETTY & CO." are not manufactured, endorsed, or sold by the authentic C. Krishniah Chetty Group. Consequently, products sold by them will not be accepted for re-sale, buy-back, or exchange at any of our showrooms that feature the RED identity.

The C. Krishniah Chetty Group and its majority directors, the "Hayagrivs", have filed petitions in the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT), Bengaluru seeking closure of the unauthorised entity called "BLUE CKC" etc., which is not related to the authentic C. Krishniah Chetty Group - which is identifiable with the red facade and red colour based communication & brand. The C. Krishniah Chetty Group and its majority directors have further raised claims exceeding Rs. 150 Crores (and counting) toward damages and dues resulting from these unauthorized actions.

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Bengalureans to cut back on cuppa, but it's not enough

Vindhya Pabolu, Hamsaveni N & Anush S | TNN

From smaller cups and home-made evening snacks to restaurant menu revisions, the latest dairy price hike is beginning to reshape how several Bengalureans eat, spend and socialise. While milk and curd remain difficult to do without, consumers are looking at other ways to absorb the additional expense. The ripple effect could extend from neighbourhood tea stalls and household kitchens to restaurants, paying guest accommodations and Nandini parlours.

AI Images

Tea cups go small, but habits stay

A glass of tea is both a ritual and a refreshment. As has been with cigarettes, tea vendors expect customers to become cautious and make budget tweaks than kick the habit altogether. "Whenever prices of tea or cigarette go up, consumption slows initially but never comes down," said Sadik AS, a vendor in Ejipura. Munzir N, a tea vendor in Viveknagar, expects customers to now opt for half cups. For consumers, the cumulative cost of a tea break is becoming a concern. Ashok KA, an IT employee from BTM Layout, said tea, cigarettes and a snack such as vada or bajji could now cost more than Rs 50, making daily consumption a strain on budget.

More on plate? Restaurants may pass on costs to diners

The hike is adding to the cost pressures faced by restaurants, particularly vegetarian establishments and chains that consume large quantities of milk and curd.

Sandeep Jain, founder of Desi Masala, which operates six outlets, said the chain consumes 300-350 litres of milk and curd every day. The latest increase alone is expected to add more than Rs 1 lakh to its monthly expenses.

"Our bigger concern is the likely increase in paneer prices, which is a key ingredient for a vegetarian restaurant like ours," he said. With input costs such as LPG, rice, coffee powder and sugar having already risen, Jain said the chain had little option but to increase menu prices by at least 15%.

PG owners stare at higher bills

According to PG Owners' Welfare Association, a facility accommodating 40-50 residents typically consumes 10-12 litres of milk and curd daily. The increase could raise monthly expenditure by nearly Rs 6,000-7,000 for such establishments.

Arun Kumar DT, president of the association, said owners were already under pressure following increases in rice prices and other operating expenses. "While we may not immediately hike rents, such increases inevitably add to operating costs and we could be forced to pass on the burden to tenants in the coming months," he said.

Nandini parlours fear customer shift

Nandini milk parlour operators fear the latest revision could initially affect customer footfall, particularly as competing dairy brands offer alternatives. A parlour owner said customers might gradually get used to the revised prices. However, operators are concerned that consumers may now find it easier to switch brands.

They also pointed to inconsistent supplies of milk and curd in recent weeks with some outlets receiving lower quantities than usual. Sources said there has been no corresponding revision in the commission or margin paid by Karnataka Milk Federation to parlour owners.

Treats & non-essentials out; home curd in

For homemakers, the challenge is to accommodate higher dairy bills without compromising on everyday consumption. Usha Goyal, a homemaker from Banashankari, said her family of four already spends around Rs 3,500 a month on milk and curd. She may reduce her son's daily milk intake slightly and make curd at home.

She is also reconsidering how much milk and curd she gives her pet dog, which has been with the family for eight years. With paneer a regular part of her family's diet, she is concerned about possible further price increases. Nalini S, from South End Circle, has started replacing packaged evening snacks such as biscuits and chips with homemade dosa, sundal and upma. Not everyone is willing to cut back on dairy. Pushpavathy KB, a working woman from Horamavu, said her family will absorb the additional expense rather than compromise on its daily milk and curd consumption.

TOI

RARE GIFT FOR NEWLYWEDS

The bride and groom received an unusual gift at their wedding in Kadakola on the outskirts of Mysuru on Monday: their friends presented them with sachets of Nandini milk and curd! The gesture was to draw the state govt's attention to rising prices of essential commodities. The awareness initiative was organised by Prajnantha Nagarika Vedike president Kadakola Jagadish at the wedding of localites Manju and Ananya held at Sri Kalibheereswara Kalyana Mantap. Jagadish congratulated the couple and presented them the sachets, highlighting the financial burden caused by the recent increase in milk and curd prices, particularly on poor and middle-class families.

Commercial Ops Likely To Begin On Nov 14

PM may open Pink Line's elevated stretch on Nov 13

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: The long-awaited elevated section of Namma Metro's Pink Line, from Kalena Agrahara to Tavarekere on Bannerghatta Road, is likely to be inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Nov 13, with commercial operations expected to begin the following day.

Bangalore South MP Tejasvi Surya mentioned the date on X, but Bangalore Metro Rail Corporation Ltd (BMRCL) is yet to formally confirm the inauguration.

Sources said Modi is scheduled to visit the state on Nov 13 for some events in Mysuru before travelling to Bengaluru. After flagging off the new Metro services, he is likely to take a ride on Namma Metro.

In March 2023, Modi inaugurated KR Pura-Whitefield stretch ahead of assembly elections. In Oct 2023, he virtually inaugurated two sections of Purple Line — Benniganahalli-KR Pura and Kengeri-Challaghatta. In Aug 2025, he launched Yellow Line between RV Road and Bommasandra.

Like earlier corridors, Pink Line has faced multiple deadline extensions. BMRCL began construction of its elevated section in 2017, but work was delayed due to various factors. The 21.3-km corridor runs between Kalena Agrahara and Nagawara stations.

While the 7.5-km elevated stretch between Kalena Agrahara and Tavarekere stations is set to open shortly, the remaining 13-km underground section between Dairy Circle and Nagawara is expected to be operational next year.

BMRCL plans to deploy four trains initially on the elevated section, with a frequency of six minutes during peak hours and 10 minutes during non-peak hours.

Jayadeva set to become 3rd interchange station

Chethan Shivakumar

Bengaluru will get its third Metro interchange station with the opening of the elevated section of Pink Line. After Majestic and RV Road, the six-level interchange at Jayadeva will connect Pink Line with operational Yellow Line, providing commuters with another crucial transfer point in the Metro network.

BMRCL expects the new connectivity to complement ridership of Yellow Line, which connects Electronics City, one of Bengaluru's major IT corridors, with the wider Metro network.

"The elevated section of Pink Line is likely to complement ridership on Yellow Line. People travelling from Bannerghatta Road towards Electronics City are expected to use Pink Line and interchange with the Yellow Line to reach Electronics City and other areas along Hosur Road," an official said.

Spread across a built-up area of 19,826 sqm, Jayadeva is the tallest Metro station in the city. Designed as a multi-level transport hub, it integrates Metro corridors with a double-decker flyover, an underpass and at-grade roads. The station is expected to handle around 25,000 passengers during peak hours.

However, despite its scale and connectivity potential, last-mile access remains a concern. Poorly lit roads beneath the double-decker flyover and the absence of proper footpaths on either side of Bannerghatta Road have raised questions about pedestrian safety.

"Every day, hundreds of commuters use the road beneath the double-decker flyover to cross the junction, and many of them are Metro passengers. The stretch is poorly lit, and even during the day, it is difficult to assess movement of traffic. Persons with disabilities face particular risks while crossing the road," Varsha R, a commuter, said.

Srihari, a regular commuter, said Jayadeva's platforms were wider than those at Majestic and RV Road, but changing platforms remained a challenge. "Compared to the other two interchange stations, the platforms at Jayadeva are wider. However, changing platforms is quite a task. BMRCL should introduce a proper signage system to help commuters locate the different Metro platforms," he said.

PRR-1 work soon, next phase prep underway

Sanjay.Murty@timesofindia.com

TOI

BACK ON TRACK

Bengaluru: After years of delay, work on Bengaluru Business Corridor (BBC) or Peripheral Ring Road-1 is finally set to begin, with around 8km of the 21.5km Package 1 stretch cleared and ready for construction, BBC chairperson LK Atheeq said.

The cleared stretches are largely around Shivaram Karanth Layout and nearby areas. The contractor is setting up a casting yard and bringing in machinery for precast work, Atheeq said after inspecting the area last week.

"We are not going to do any groundbreaking ceremony. We are going to go ahead and start building the road," he told **TOI** Monday.

With land acquisition for PRR-1 facing legal challenges in the high court, Atheeq said stay orders applied to specific survey numbers. Work could proceed on acquired private land where compensation had been paid.

"We will build the entire 21.5km of Package 1 to begin with. As we show progress, we will hopefully have more clarity from the high court. We will then resolve the issues of compensation," he said.

Atheeq said preparations were underway to invite tenders for Package 2, from Kogilu near Yelahanka to Old Madras Road. Around 60-70% of the land acquisition for Package 2 and 35% for Package 3 have been completed. "We will be calling tenders when we have about 50% of the land and ensuring it is 80% before the work is awarded," he said.

PRR-NICE integration

Atheeq ruled out dropping the proposed NICE integration from BBC near Madavara despite opposition from landowners. However, acquisition for the 3km NICE integration could take longer as the issues had to be resolved, he added.

Residents have been protesting the NICE integration and land acquisition for this portion of the road.

"We are not against the main PRR, but are asking them to spare our homes as we had constructed them after obtaining the necessary clearances. The NICE integration on the other end, at Electronics City, was dropped. Why can't this portion be dropped too?" asked Sathish Gowda, a resident of Thotadaguddadahalli.

Families united by SIR, divided by booth reshuffle

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Bengaluru: With Election Commission rationalising allocation of polling stations in its bid to assign booths within 2km from home or stick to a maximum of 1,200 voters in a booth in the special intensive revision (SIR), several families find themselves in different booths.

The decision on which voters to shift from overcrowded booths was based on a matrix prepared by booth-level officers (BLOs), their supervisors and electoral registration officers (EROs).

"All members of a family were identified as one unit and allocated the same booth," an official said. However, during enumeration, some families had multiple BLOs visiting their homes because their members were mapped to different polling stations. An official from the chief electoral officer's office said 1,875 polling stations had been added during SIR. The exercise has left several voters struggling to locate their names, with polling station part numbers and serial numbers changed, families are split across booths.

Election Commission's ECInet app displays the latest details when a voter's EPIC number is entered. However, volunteers assisting voters said those relying on pre-SIR part and serial numbers would struggle to trace their entries in the revised rolls. Voters in Bengaluru, however, questioned whether the rationalisation had been properly implemented. A resident of RT Nagar said the changes should have been reflected in the draft rolls but were not. Raj Kumar said his 22-year-old son had been assigned a booth in the neighbouring CV Raman Nagar constituency, while the rest of the family was listed in Shanti Nagar.

"There was no change to the booth allotted to my son. We have lived in this house for 50 years, and the previous rolls placed him in the neighbouring constituency. We hoped SIR would set this right. We do not know if we can apply through Form 8, which requires an old and a new address. In our case, there has always been just one address," he said.

Despite the mega exercise being aimed at cleaning up electoral rolls, voters reported errors in age, names and addresses. "My age has been increased by three years," said a voter from Dakshina Kannada. A Bengaluru voter said a correction sought through the BLO had not been incorporated. "I am 54, but have been listed as 56, even after seeking corrections," the voter said.

Data entry errors

In a Yelahanka polling booth, several entries had incomplete addresses. Some house numbers were replaced with a dot or a hyphen, while others carried landmarks such as Palekamma temple or Ganesh temple. BLO Nagarathnamma said she had entered all the details provided to her. "Wherever the data was vague, neighbours helped us identify voters using their photographs," she said. Yelahanka ERO Maruthi attributed some discrepancies to data entry errors and promised a review. "There was no issue with the software. Yelahanka had the highest progress with the lowest deletions," he said.

Activists seek hiring data from tech firms

Niranjan.Kaggere @timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Discussions over employing Kannadigas in Bengaluru's IT sector following allegations of hiring bias against local talent took a dramatic turn Monday when Kannada activists visited over 100 tech companies across the city and submitted representations seeking recruitment data.

The move comes despite chief minister DK Shivakumar urging Kannada activists and organisations to avoid moral policing.

KANNADA ROW

Karnataka Rakshana Vedike (KRV) president TA Narayana Gowda told **TOI:** "We started with a survey of tech companies as there were complaints about discrimination in hiring, Kannadigas being sidelined during recruitment to favour outside candidates. We created teams to carry forward the audit campaign and these teams will be visiting private companies and submitting representations to the management seeking details of the total number of people employed and the percentage of Kannadigas."

Gowda said: "We have instructed the teams that there should be no shouting of slogans or bitter confrontations with the management or security personnel. Our workers will approach the companies politely and explain their intention by displaying identity cards. The companies need not furnish details immediately. Our representation will include address and email IDs of KRV central committee, and companies can email the details over the next four to five days."

The representations submitted by the visiting teams will also seek details of the nature and category of jobs (including Group A, B, C and D Groups) in which Kannadigas are employed and the facilities extended to Kannadiga employees at the workplace.

Responding to concerns that several companies were unaware of the visits, Gowda said the issue had been under discussion for a month. He submitted a memorandum to the police commissioner Monday, seeking cooperation. The campaign, he said, will not be confined to Bengaluru or only to the tech sector. After collecting the information, KRV plans to submit a report to the state govt.

Don't burst crackers in public places, say police

For representation

Bengaluru: Karnataka police urged people to celebrate Deepavali peacefully, responsibly and in an eco-friendly manner, while following directions issued by Supreme Court and other competent authorities.

According to guidelines, firecrackers must not be burst at public places such as bus stands, railway stations, hospitals, educational institutions, religious places and other crowded or sensitive locations. People have been advised against bursting crackers on roads, near parked vehicles or in areas with heavy pedestrian movement.

Cops advised people to buy firecrackers only from licensed shops, check the packaging for prescribed markings and QR codes to ensure the products are genuine. They have been asked to alert local police or call 112/108 if they notice illegal sales or storage of firecrackers. TNN

Norm on paper: Made in K'taka, but no Kannada on product labels

Niranjan.Kaggere@timesofindia.com

CM: Local, pvt-made products have Kannada labelling on pack

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: CM Siddaramaiah Friday said all products, manufactured by both govt and privately owned companies in Karnataka, should henceforth mandatorily have their names written in Kannada on their packages and product information in Kannada on their labels.

After felicitating 69 Rajyotsava awardees and 100 achievers with Suvarna Mahotsava awards at Vidhana Soudha, the CM said most

CM: Use Kannada, teach it to non-Kannadigas, P 2

factured by both private and public sector enterprises in Karnataka now carry their descriptions and names only in English. "It is mandatory that all these goods and products manufactured have descriptions and product names in Kannada on the packages," he said.

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YOU READ IT FIRST IN TOI

Bengaluru: Nearly two years after the state govt ordered mandatory Kannada labelling on products manufactured in Karnataka, the directive appears to have made little difference, as products continue to be sold with details printed in English and other languages, but not Kannada.

The failure to implement the directive has once again come under scrutiny, with Kannada Development Authority (KDA) expressing concern over the lack of effective enforcement despite repeated efforts to ensure greater prominence for Kannada in everyday life.

In Nov 2024, during the valedictory ceremony of 69th Kannada Rajyotsava, then chief minister Siddaramaiah had announced that all consumer, industrial and other products manufactured in Karnataka, whether by govt or private-sector entities, must carry their product names and labels in Kannada alongside other languages, if any. The directive was intended to ensure that Kannada received due recognition on products manufactured in the state and that consumers could identify and read product information in their mother tongue. However, ground reality suggests that the initiative has remained largely ineffective, with little visible change in the labelling practices of manufacturers and companies.

KDA chairperson Purushothama Bilimale said the authority had made efforts to follow up on the implementation of the govt order, including conducting field visits and coordinating with officials from other departments. "I've personally toured 24 districts and followed up with food inspectors in those districts. But the problem is that most of these products are manufactured here, packaged elsewhere and marketed by companies from other states. Because of this, the govt order has failed to take proper shape in reality," Bilimale said, pointing out that the absence of effective enforcement mechanisms and coordination among departments has undermined the initiative.

The issue also highlights the challenges in ensuring the use of Kannada beyond govt offices, signboards and public institutions, particularly in the commercial space, where products manufactured in Karnataka often reach consumers without any identification in Kannada.

Two sisters, one mission to mend umbrellas

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TOI

CARRYING CRAFT FORWARD: Selvi (top inset) and Amaravathi at work

Bengaluru: Every morning at 7, sisters Selvi and Amaravathi set out from their Jayanagar home, boarding a bus with a bag full of umbrella repair tools. They travel through the streets of east Bengaluru, mending broken umbrellas and keeping an age-old craft alive in a world increasingly driven by overconsumption and throwaway culture.

Selvi, 52, and Amaravathi, 60, moved to Bengaluru from Tamil Nadu with their parents nearly 40 years ago. "My entire family repaired umbrellas — my parents, brother and about 20 others. My sister and I would follow them through the streets, watching and learning the craft. Decades later, we are the only ones left carrying on the trade," Selvi said.

Her son, too, chose a different path, moving to Kuwait for work rather than learning the age-old trade.

The sisters travel by BMTC bus to areas such as Shivajinagar, Koramangala and Ulsoor, walking the streets with a pre-recorded audio message advertising their services. They carry spare parts, including pipes and handles, balanced carefully on their heads.

Are there still enough customers in a city like Bengaluru who want their umbrellas repaired? "Plenty," says Selvi, adding: "People who buy umbrellas for Rs 100-200 tend to discard them when they break. But someone who has spent Rs 500 on a good folding umbrella is less likely to throw it away. Some umbrellas also have sentimental value. Just the other day, a woman brought six or seven umbrellas gifted to her by her late mother and grandmother. She wanted to preserve them as family memories."

The sisters repair handles, pipes and ribs, replace fabric, and fix patches and caps. Depending on business, they earn between Rs 500-600 and Rs 1,000-1,500 a day. Daily expenses amount to around Rs 200-300, while every two months they set aside Rs 10,000 to buy spare parts from KR Market.

"About 25 years ago, we worked longer hours, from 6am to 9pm, but earned less. Expenses were also lower, around Rs 25-30 a day. Now, we work until 1 or 2pm and earn more, but our expenses have risen too," Selvi points out.

For Selvi and Amaravathi, however, the trade is about more than money. "I educated my children with what I earned from this work. Today, I don't want to sit at home doing nothing. We want to honour the profession that gave us our livelihood. That is why we continue to walk the streets," Selvi says.

Will the trade survive after them? Selvi is doubtful. "I don't think it will. This is not a skill you can simply teach someone. You have to develop it by observing others."

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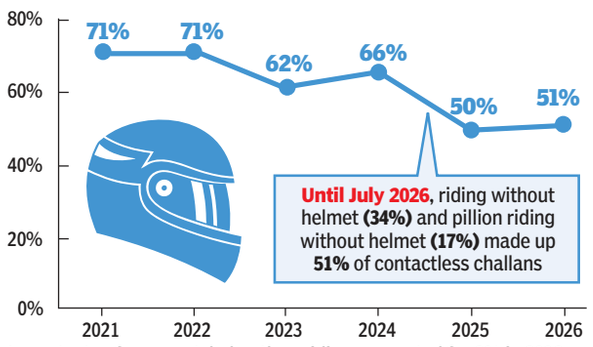
GOING HELMETLESS?

Top on challan list, but share is shrinking

Jump a signal, park where you shouldn't, ride without a helmet, and someone is probably watching you. Between Jan 2021 and July 2026, the city's cameras and traffic police booked about 52 million challans. This year, cameras are logging 33,179 cases every day, finds ***Vindhya Pabolu***

1 Helmets Still Lead, But Less Than Before



In contact enforcement, helmetless riding accounted for 9% in 2026 compared to 44% in 2021. The share has fallen, but the count hasn't: there were 1,05,651 contact helmet challans in the first seven months of 2026, already above the 95,874 for all of 2025. The corresponding contactless figures are 3.6 million and 3.1 million, respectively

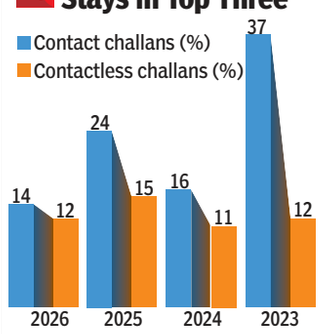
2 Cameras Dominate, But Cops Booking More Again

Year	Contactless enforcement (%)	Contact enforcement (%)
2026	91	9
2025	88	12
2024	94	6
2023	97	3
2022	92	–
2021	84	–

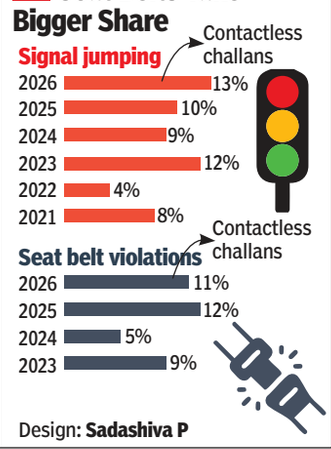
3 No-Entry Booked On Streets

Year	Contact challans (%)	Contactless challans (%)
2026	32	<1
2025	24	<1
2024	25	1
2023	33	1
2022	12	4

4 Wrong Parking Stays In Top Three



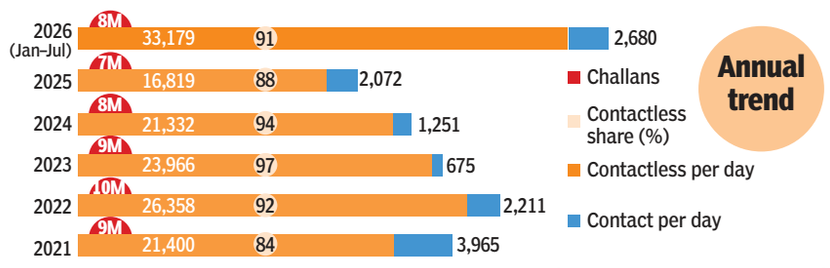
5 Signal Jumping & Seat Belts Take Bigger Share



Design: **Sadashiva P**

OVERALL PICTURE

52 million	91%	9%	23,140	2,101
challans from Jan 2021 to July 2026	Booked through contactless enforcement	Total violations booked via contact	Avg violations per day (contactless)	Average violations per day (contact)



Odd Ones Out: Analysis Of Data

Busiest month | July 2026 saw 2 million challans generated (incl. 1.8 million contactless), the busiest month on charts

Drunk driving accounted for 3% of contact challans in 2026, 5% in both 2025 and 2024, and 3% in 2023 and 2022. It was unlabelled in 2021

Rare ones | 'Dazzling headlight' (2% in 2026 and 2024), 'demanding excess fare' (1% in 2024) and 'lane indiscipline' (1% in 2021) were among the smallest-labelled slices

The more not the merrier | Carrying excess passengers made up 2.8% of challans generated in 2026. The violation accounted for 2.2% in 2025 and 0.8% in 2024. It hit its lowest point in 2023, at 0.7%, before climbing again

> "Riding without helmet tops the violation list because it is easily identifiable and can be booked through AI cameras. Contactless challans are rising since police cannot chase every offender. Yet, violations like footpath riding persist, especially in IT corridors, on highways and well-laid roads, despite our efforts to bring offences down
> — **Senior traffic police officer**

Source: BTP AsTram analysis from 2021 to 2026

Spl adalats will be held: KBG

▶ Continued from page 1

Krishna Byre Gowda added: "I've instructed officials to hold special adalats and clear pending applications soon."

The then deputy CM DK Shivakumar had announced the Namma Khate Namma Hakku campaign, with a 100-day window that ended on Aug 23 and it was subsequently extended. The govt cut the conversion fee from 5% to 2% of guidance value for applications filed by that date. It has since returned to 5%. The campaign targeted 7 lakh eligible B-khata properties among 23 lakh in GBA limits. Eligible properties were those registered on or before Sept 30, 2024, with a clear tax history and no major encroachment. Despite the 60% fee rebate, only 80,400 applications had come in by the end of Aug.

2 sell foreign cigs at airport, caught

Bengaluru: Two men were detained for illegally selling foreign-made cigarettes in the parking area of Kempegowda International Airport's T2. Head constable Shivaprasad said while patrolling near T2 at 1.15pm on Oct 30, he got to know from an informant that Aadil Abdul and Harunbhai Mansuri were selling cigarettes that had been smuggled into the country. A case has been registered and investigation is under way. TNN

Powering 4th: K'taka moves up in India's TOEFL league

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Bengaluru: Karnataka has overtaken Gujarat to become the fourth-largest state in terms of TOEFL-takers, according to data shared by Educational Testing Service (ETS), which administers English-language test. The state's share of test-takers has seen a consistent increase, up from 8.1% in FY 2023-24 to 8.7% in FY 2024-25 and 9.3% in FY 2025-26.

Telangana leads overall with a share of 18.1%, followed by Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh (15.1% each). Karnataka is marginally ahead of Gujarat at 9%. "Bengaluru continues to be a significant centre for TOEFL participation. The city ranked fourth among India's leading TOEFL iBT test-taking cities in 2021 before moving to third place in 2022 and 2023. Mysuru also featured among the country's top 10 test-taking cities in 2023," said Karan Lalit, executive director – South Asia, TOEFL & GRE, ETS.

According to ETS, it currently has more than 60 active institutional partners across Karnataka, including Bengaluru, Mangaluru, Mysuru, Hubballi and Dharwad. These partnerships support student outreach, awareness initiatives and access to TOEFL preparation resources.

However, access to testing infrastructure remains concentrated in Bengaluru, which has four TOEFL test centres. ETS said it is in discussions with several universities and colleges across Karnataka to strengthen student support, particularly in test preparation and registration.

While the US, UK, Canada and Australia continue to be popular choices among Indian students, interest in destinations such as Germany, France, Ireland and countries in West Asia is also growing. "At a global level, TOEFL score reports sent to universities in Japan increased by 10% in FY 2025-26, while reports sent to universities in Hong Kong increased by 24% in 2025. These figures reflect global ETS data and should not be interpreted as trends specific to Karnataka," Lalit said.

ETS said students are increasingly evaluating multiple countries before making study-abroad decisions, taking into account visa regulations, affordability, admission requirements, and post-study work opportunities.

"Germany enrolled approximately 59,000 Indian students in the 2024-25 winter semester, representing a year-on-year growth of around 20%. France recorded approximately 9,100 Indian students in 2025. Ireland recorded 9,175 Indian students in 2024-25. The Niti Aayog report on internationalisation of higher education also identifies the UAE as a destination for Indian students. These figures illustrate the range of international education markets attracting Indian students," he said.

TOEFL iBT is accepted by more than 13,500 institutions across over 160 countries as a common English-language proficiency assessment when applying to universities in different destinations.

ONWARDS AND UPWARDS

- Karnataka overtakes Gujarat, with 9.3% share of India's TOEFL-takers in FY 2025-26
- The state's share was 8.1% in FY 2023-24 and 8.7% in FY 2024-25
- Telangana tops the list at 18.1%, followed by Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh at 15.1% each
- Bengaluru moved from fourth place in 2021 to third in 2022 and 2023; Mysuru featured in top 10 in 2023

While the US, UK, Canada and Australia continue to be popular choices among Indian students, sources said interest in destinations such as Germany, France, Ireland and countries in West Asia is also growing

KPSC scam: Court recasts SIT for fair probe, appoints IPS officer R Hitendra team chief

Times News Network

Bengaluru: The high court Monday reconstituted the special investigation team (SIT) probing cases related to the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) recruitment scam, appointing senior IPS officer R Hitendra, ADGP (law and order), as its head in place of Alok Kumar, DGP (prisons).

Senior IPS officer Soumendu Mukherjee, ADGP (administration), will replace Divya Gopinath. The other three members — Anup A Shetty, Kushal Chouksey and Kshama Mishra — will continue on the five-member team.

Justice M Nagaprasanna said the changes were made after considering the names suggested by the state govt, objections raised by the petitioners and the need to ensure an investigation that was demonstrably independent. Alok Kumar and Divya Gopinath had been named in the SIT constituted under the court's Sept 21 order.

The reconstitution, the judge observed, must mark the beginning of a fresh investigation that inspires confidence and remains free from institutional or external influence. The objective was not merely to change the officers handling the probe but to ensure that the investigation itself was conducted with renewed independence.

Transfer embargo

The court directed that SIT members should not be transferred out of Bengaluru from their present assignments in a manner that would hamper their work while investigation was under way, unless the court granted prior permission. Continuity of investigating officers was as important as their independence, Justice Nagaprasanna said.

The court also directed that no officer associated with the earlier investigation by Criminal Investigation Department (CID), irrespective of rank or designation, be inducted into the SIT's assisting team. The SIT will be free to select its own supporting officers and personnel, provided they have had no association with the earlier CID probe. The separation, the court said, must be complete in letter and spirit.

Govt has been directed to extend full cooperation and provide SIT with all necessary infrastructure, personnel, logistical and technical support, and other resources required to complete the investigation expeditiously, in accordance with the court's Oct 29 order.

Simultaneous probe

Taking note of the Enforcement Directorate's ongoing investigation following the registration of an Enforcement Case Information Report, the court said both agencies must proceed simultaneously, independently and in cooperation, within their respective statutory jurisdictions. The SIT and ED investigations should complement each other in the pursuit of truth rather than become competing exercises over jurisdiction, the judge said. The ED has also been directed to continue placing progress reports on its investigation before the court from time to time, in keeping with the HC's Sept 21 order.

The latest directions are to be read in conjunction with and as a continuation of the orders passed on Sept 21 and Oct 29. All other earlier directions will remain in force and must be complied with, the judge added. On Sept 21, while allowing petitions filed by Vijayapura MLA Basanagouda Patil Yatnal and others, HC had ordered the constitution of an SIT to conduct a fresh probe and complete it within 100 days.

The state govt subsequently challenged the composition of the SIT before Supreme Court, which allowed it to suggest alternative names in place of Alok Kumar and Divya Gopinath within two weeks. The apex court left it to HC to consider the objections, hear both sides, and decide on the replacements.

Bring tech, we'll give land: Govt appeals to Japanese firms

Times News Network

Bengaluru: Karnataka govt has called for more Japanese investment in the state across industries. S Selvakumar, principal secretary, commerce and industries department, said the state offers more than a destination for Japanese businesses.

Speaking at India-Japan Business Summit 2026 organised by Bangalore Chamber of Industry and Commerce, he appealed: "To every Japanese company here, the message is simple: bring your technology and we'll bring the talent, land and partnership."

Drawing applause, he mentioned that Karnataka has long been one of Japan's most active economic bridges with India. "With regard to technology, Karnataka is India's largest chip design hub, with over 100 fabulous design houses, and 800+ research and development centres, making it the ideal place for Japanese companies to develop and localise advanced tech."

Hirotsugu Ueda, vice-governor of Japan's Tokushima Prefecture (an administrative division), revealed that eight companies from Tokushima across various sectors are currently in Bengaluru looking for strategic opportunities. The companies, he said, included two regional banks, those from construction machinery, logistics clearance, glass processing and packaging sectors. "It will serve as an opportunity to expand the economic ties with India," he added.

Hiroshi Nawata, consul general of Japan in Bengaluru, said Karnataka was home to more than 200 Japanese companies and over 500 Japanese establishments, reflecting the depth of the economic relationship between the two sides. "Bengaluru's strengths in information technology, artificial intelligence, research and innovation complement Japan's expertise in engineering, manufacturing, robotics and industrial excellence," Nawata said.

HC bins Maha cops' action in Tumakuru

Bengaluru: Karnataka high court has held that an investigative operation conducted by Maharashtra police against two pan masala trading entities in Tumakuru was unsustainable, as it was carried out without coordination with jurisdictional police and without establishing compliance with constitutional and statutory safeguards.

Partly allowing petitions filed by Shiva Enterprises and Siddhi Agencies, along with their partners, Justice Suraj Govindaraj ruled that statements recorded from the petitioners during the operation, in the absence of jurisdictional police, could not be treated as lawful.

The case originated after an FIR was registered at Vadagaon police station in Maharashtra for alleged offences under Food Safety and Standards Act and Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

Officers from the police station visited the two entities in Tumakuru as part of their investigation. They took away documents, including ledger books, and directed the partners to appear before Vadagaon police. Examining the provisions of BNS, particularly Section 179, which deals with a police officer's power to require the attendance of witnesses, the court noted that the petitioners' business in Tumakuru was outside the jurisdiction of Vadagaon police.

However, the court declined to grant a blanket restraint against Maharashtra police contacting the petitioners or interfering with their business, beyond the specific directions issued. It also rejected their plea to quash the FIR or the investigation in its entirety. TNN

ALMANAC (3.11.2026)

Tula Masa 16 – Shri Parabhava Nama Samvatsara – Dakshinayana – Sharath Ritu – Tithi: Ashwayuja Krishna Navami h. 11-55 Nakshatra: Magha h. 27-27 Yoga: Sukla (Sukra) h. 9-54 Karana: Gara h. 11-55 22 Jumadu'l awwal | Kali Day 1872882

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Lake group seeks halt on rd plan; GBA chief says nothing finalised

Sanjay.Murty@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: The Federation of Bengaluru Lakes (FBL) has urged Greater Bengaluru Authority (GBA) to put on hold the proposed road expansion and other infrastructure projects affecting lakes, wetlands and buffer zones.

It highlighted concerns over flooding, groundwater depletion and loss of green cover. The demand comes amid questions over GBA's proposed road circulation plan, which has identified alignments through Lalbagh Botanical Garden, lakes and forest lands. In a representation to GBA's climate action cell, the federation said road widening, tunnel roads, underground drainage pipelines and sewage treatment plants within lake areas could damage the city's natural drainage system and weaken its ability to withstand flooding and heat stress.

It sought a lake-wise assessment of the proposed roads, including their impact on water-storage capacity, groundwater recharge, biodiversity and tree cover. The federation has also called for the disclosure of detailed project reports, traffic studies, environmental assessments and alternative alignments for public scrutiny. Questioning the need to divert lake land for road infrastructure, it said GBA should first complete pending Comprehensive Development Plan (CDP) roads, improve the existing network, remove obstructions and strengthen traffic management and public transport.

Photo for representation

PROTECTING GREEN SPACES

Meanwhile, GBA's urban planners said they had not been consulted during the preparation of the road circulation plan. An urban planner from one of the city corporations said the plan appeared to have been prepared by BDA. "Each corporation has an urban planning cell with an urban planner, urban designer and a transport planner. These plans seem to have been made without any inputs from GBA's urban planning cell," the planner told **TOI** on the condition of anonymity.

Responding to queries on roads proposed through Lalbagh, lakes and forest land, GBA chief commissioner Maheshwar Rao said no parks or lakes would be taken over for roadworks.

₹50k-cr civic spend, but infra is crumbling: BNP

Bengaluru: Alleging a glaring mismatch between public expenditure and the city's infrastructure conditions, Bengaluru Navanirmana Party (BNP) Monday claimed that nearly Rs 50,000 crore has been spent on around 80,000 civic projects over the past decade. However, residents continue to grapple with potholes, flooding and traffic congestion.

The party, as part of its #LekkaBeku campaign, released an updated database of civic-related projects and contracts executed over the past 10 years. According to BNP, the citizen portal compiles details of project costs, contractors, expenditure, work status and completion records across 198 wards in the city.

Based on its analysis, BNP alleged that more than Rs 3 crore per kilometre has been spent on roads, footpaths and related civic infrastructure works. Despite this, it claimed Bengaluru's infrastructure continues to fall far short of citizens' expectations.

Srikanth Narasimhan, founder and general secretary of BNP, asked, "These numbers raise a fundamental question: if so much money has been spent on Bengaluru's development, why is it still struggling with basic civic problems?" He alleged that citizens continue to face dangerous roads, flooding during monsoons and severe traffic congestion despite the scale of spending. "Taxpayers are paying hard-earned money while politicians and authorities misuse public funds. Bengaluru's citizens have every right to know where their money has gone," he said. The party said the database has been created to improve transparency and enable citizens to scrutinise public spending more effectively. TNN

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Increase in milk and curd prices: Political bane or boon for Cong?

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ANI

NOTED: CM DK Shivakumar met members of milk producers' unions, including his brother DK Suresh, in Bengaluru Monday

Bengaluru: Congress govt's decision to raise milk prices by Rs 8 a litre and curd by Rs 14 a litre has triggered an uncomfortable debate within the governing party: has it undermined the economic protection its five flagship guarantee schemes were meant to provide?

The hit will be felt hardest by Bengaluru's middle-class, already stretched by high rent, rising food prices and costlier LPG. Households are also grappling with job losses linked to the geopolitical crisis and the AI boom. Milk and curd are daily purchases, and the steep hike adds to an already strained monthly budget.

The timing is sensitive. Congress is preparing for taluk and zilla panchayat elections with CM DK Shivakumar asking party functionaries last week to begin preparations. Polls are likely in Jan. The hike could complicate efforts to carry the welfare plank into the next electoral cycle, especially in urban and semi-urban areas.

The guarantees were conceived ahead of the 2023 assembly polls as a buffer against inflation and fuel price rise, which Congress blamed on the BJP-led Centre. Political analyst Vishwas Shetty said they helped the party assure people of relief from rising living costs.

"Middle-class people were especially happy with them, but the govt seems to have forgotten the purpose behind the guarantees," Shetty said. "If the hike had been between Rs 3 and Rs 4, as in previous instances, I don't think there would have been much fuss about it. A family may save on free bus travel and electricity yet pay more for milk and curd."

The govt's case is that small and marginal dairy farmers deserve better returns amid rising input costs. Shivakumar said 67% of Karnataka Milk Federation (KMF) members belong to these categories. The procurement price goes up from Rs 35 to Rs 42 a litre, and with the existing Rs 5 govt incentive, farmers will get Rs 47. The govt estimates an additional Rs 1,850 crore to Rs 2,100 crore a year for them.

But the benefits and costs are unevenly spread. Of around 26.8 lakh dairy farmer members in Karnataka, only 8.9 lakh supply milk to cooperative societies, while the hike touches virtually every household.

The curd increase has drawn particular attention. The Bangalore Hotels Association has questioned why curd rose by Rs 14 a litre when milk went up by Rs 8 a litre. Ghee, butter and buttermilk prices will also rise depending on fat content, which could push up bills at hotels and eateries.

BAMUL president DK Suresh, the CM's brother, had been pressing for better returns for farmers, citing costlier feed, fodder, veterinary care and transport. He attended meetings with the CM, KMF officials and milk union functionaries before the decision. Unions had sought Rs 12 a litre; Shivakumar deferred a decision in Sept and sought price and production cost details from neighbouring states.

The question is whether a gradual revision, or other ways of supporting farmers, could have spared consumers the full burden at once.

Political analyst MN Patil said the impact would extend beyond milk and curd, triggering a cascading effect on household expenditure, much like fuel price hikes.

"While dairy farmers may welcome the move, Congress party will have to explain to middle-class consumers why a govt that promised relief from inflation has made an essential buy costlier, especially with local body elections approaching," Patil said.

Farmers mock govt's ₹2.5k drought relief

Farmers in Dharwad Monday protested state govt's announcement of Rs 2,500 drought relief by submitting a cheque for Rs 3,000 to CM's relief fund. Led by farmer leader Mallikarjun Balagoudra, protesters gathered outside the deputy commissioner's office and raised slogans against govt. They said severe drought had caused extensive damage to their crops and called the interim compensation "inadequate". Farmers demanded Rs 50,000 per acre for crop losses, immediate settlement of crop insurance claims for the 2025-26 kharif and rabi seasons, and waiver of loans taken from nationalised and cooperative banks. They also sought continuous water supply to Malaprabha right bank canal for 40 days to ensure adequate drinking water for livestock and demanded that the sugarcane price be fixed at Rs 6,000 per tonne. TNN

Cane farmers to gherao DC offices, protest in B'luru

Times News Network

TOI

DISCONTENT: Sugarcane farmers began a 95km march from Mudalagi taluk to Belagavi and threatened to lay siege to Hindalga central jail

Bengaluru: Sugarcane growers have announced a two-phase agitation on Tuesday and Thursday to press for a state-specific price for cane, a higher central fair and remunerative price (FRP), a complete farm loan waiver and measures to prevent farmers from being cheated in weighing and sugar recovery calculations.

Karnataka Sugarcane Growers' Coordination Committee has called on farmers to gherao deputy commissioners' offices in all districts on Tuesday. They have also called for a statewide protest at Freedom Park, Bengaluru, Thursday.

Meanwhile, thousands of farmers Monday launched a 95km 'Jail Bharo' march from Gurlapur Cross in Mudalagi taluk to Hindalga central jail in Belagavi. A huge convoy of two-wheelers and four-wheelers joined the rally, organised under the banner of the Karnataka Rajya Raita Sangha and Hasiru Sene (KRRS & HS). Farmer leaders said thousands of cultivators will lay siege to the jail Wednesday.

KRRS & HS president Chunappa Pujeri said: "This is a do-or-die struggle. Our agitation will remain peaceful, but we will not retreat until justice is done."

State sugarcane growers' association president Kurubur Shanthakumar said Karnataka should announce a state-advised price (SAP), on the lines of Punjab, Tamil Nadu and Uttar Pradesh, which have fixed sugarcane prices at Rs 4,480, Rs 4,000 and Rs 4,200 per tonne, respectively.

He demanded that the Centre raise FRP to at least Rs 4,500 per tonne for a 10.25% sugar recovery rate, citing rising cultivation costs. Shanthakumar said farmers had no objection to sugar factories commencing operations if they announced a price of Rs 4,000 per tonne. Farmers could supply sugarcane to such factories, he said.

The committee also demanded withdrawal of police cases against farmers who participated in agitations across the state.

No crushing without farmers' nod: Jarkiholi

Sugar factories in the state will begin crushing only after securing farmers' consent, public works minister and Belagavi district minister Satish Jarkiholi said Monday. He said a negotiated settlement between growers and mill owners was the only way to end the cane-price impasse. "Factory owners are not prepared to take risks right now," Jarkiholi said. "Any decision must balance farmers' demands with the financial realities of the sugar industry." The minister accused the Union govt of politicising the sugar minimum selling price (MSP), which only the Union govt can fix. "If it is serious about the crisis, the Centre must take an appropriate decision. Factory owners insist that a higher MSP would strengthen the financial viability of mills and enable them to offer better prices to farmers," he said.

HDK links Prajwal's ex-driver to DKS' home

IANS

Siddaramaiah met Rahul Gandhi and KC Venugopal Monday and briefed them about the sting case

Bengaluru: In what appeared to be a tit-for-tat after Bengaluru police commissioner Seemant Kumar Singh said the mobile phone used to upload the sting video targeting former CM Siddaramaiah had changed hands at Union minister HD Kumaraswamy's official residence in New Delhi, Kumaraswamy Monday displayed purported call detail records (CDRs) to claim that Karthik, former driver of Prajwal Revanna and accused No 2 in the sexual abuse case, had visited CM DK Shivakumar's residence on Aug 5 and 6, 2023, months before the videos began circulating.

JD(S) functionaries believe Singh made the statement at the behest of Shivakumar and home minister Priyank Kharge, who they say are irked by Kumaraswamy's repeated outbursts over the sting operation linked to Siddaramaiah.

"Both were involved in the circulation of obscene videos," Kumaraswamy alleged. Shivakumar was deputy CM then. "The CM, who is making allegations against me, must answer questions about his own wrongdoing. I have placed the facts before the people. Let them decide."

Kumaraswamy accused Congress of exploiting the Prajwal case to target the Deve Gowda family and weaken the BJP-JD(S) alliance, and alleged that the videos were allowed to circulate without masking identities of the women. TNN

SHORT TAKES

Union min urging ED action against us: HM

Home minister Priyank Kharge accused a Union minister, whom he did not name, of lobbying the Centre for I-T and ED action against Karnataka ministers. "Whispers in Delhi are that a Union minister is desperately pressuring Modi Sarkar to weaponise I-T and ED against my cabinet colleagues and me, using the KPSC investigation as political cover," Priyank said on X. Sources say the barb was aimed at HD Kumaraswamy. Priyank alleged the minister, whom he called "RSS's newest Group D recruit", was also trying to use ED to pressure KPSC accused into falsely implicating Congress members.

Govt students to get refurbished computers

Higher education department, along with Rotary International, Bengaluru, signed an agreement to provide refurbished computers to students of govt degree and polytechnic colleges under Jnana Setu scheme. As part of the initiative, 500 computers donated by Microsoft and 1,000 by Cognizant will soon be distributed to colleges.

10 yrs of RERA: Homebuyers still given runaround

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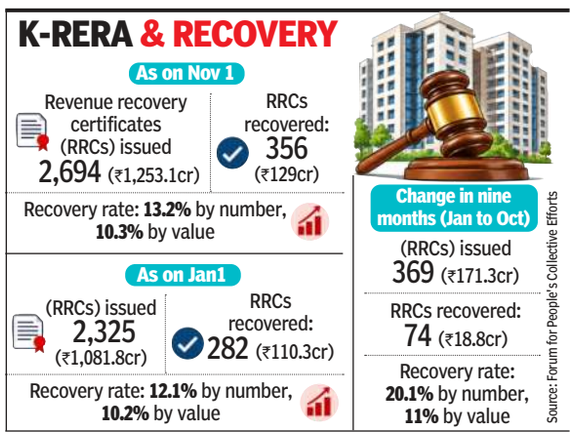

Bengaluru: Ten years after Karnataka Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act (RERA) promised to protect homebuyers from unscrupulous developers, buyers continue to face the same problems the legislation was intended to address — delayed possession, stalled projects, diversion of funds and difficulty recovering their investments. For many, approaching K-RERA has not necessarily been a relief.

Consider three situations that expose the gaps in the regulatory framework: A family books an apartment, takes a home loan and pays EMIs for years, but the developer fails to complete the project on time. The family is left paying both rent and loan instalments, with no certainty on when they can move into their new home.

In another instance, a buyer who loses patience with repeated construction delays approaches K-RERA and obtains a refund order. But the developer refuses to pay. The buyer is forced to pursue further legal proceedings to recover his money, defeating the purpose of approaching a consumer-focused regulator.

A third buyer discovers that construction has stalled because the developer has allegedly diverted money to other projects or purposes. Although RERA provides safeguards for the use of project funds, weak enforcement can leave buyers exposed to financial losses.

These are among shortcomings flagged by Forum for People's Collective Efforts (FPCE), a member of the central advisory council under RERA in the Union ministry of housing. FPCE detailed the issue in a letter to PM Narendra Modi, marking 10 years of RERA.

The forum argues that the law has failed to deliver meaningful protection because its enforcement mechanisms remain weak.

In Feb 2026, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant criticised the functioning of regulatory institutions, observing: "Except facilitating builders in default, this institution is doing nothing."

> Regulatory failure has turned a landmark reform into a tool of promoter accommodation. Rs 12.4 lakh crore of 27.6 lakh families is stuck in stalled projects, with the Supreme Court noting that authorities are doing little except facilitating defaulting builders. In Karnataka, over 3,100 projects have lapsed, yet K-RERA rarely inspects them. Only 33% of projects have been completed. A panel under the chief secretary must set time-bound targets
> **MS Shankar** | SECRETARY, FORUM FOR PEOPLE'S COLLECTIVE EFFORTS

What needs to change

FPCE's proposed reforms seek to address the gap between regulatory orders and actual relief for buyers. The forum wants stronger enforcement mechanisms to ensure developers comply with refund orders instead of leaving buyers to fight separate legal battles to recover their money. It also urged stricter monitoring of project funds so that money collected from buyers is used for the projects for which it was raised. Effective scrutiny of withdrawals from project accounts and liability for diversion of funds are essential to curb construction from being stalled.

Another priority is ensuring that project completion deadlines are enforced.

The forum also highlighted the need to address one-sided builder-buyer agreements, which often place buyers at a disadvantage. Standardised and fairer contractual provisions, along with stronger accountability for developers, could help correct this imbalance. The larger question is whether RERA needs amendments to address gaps in the legislation or whether existing provisions need to be enforced more effectively.

Consumers oppose higher infra charges, retrospective billing

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DRAFT ELECTRICITY SUPPLY RULES

Bengaluru: From arbitrary deductions in security deposits and hefty infrastructure charges to retrospective billing demands and the looming threat of disconnection, electricity consumers across Karnataka could face a fresh set of financial and procedural hurdles if proposed regulations are implemented without changes.

Several consumer rights groups, trade and commerce bodies raised objections to the draft Karnataka Electricity Regulatory Commission (KERC) Electricity Supply Regulations (ESR), 2026 at a public hearing Monday. They alleged that several provisions could leave consumers bearing the financial consequences of decisions and delays beyond their control.

A contentious proposal is the provision allowing electricity supply companies (Escoms) to deduct 10% of the security deposit when an applicant decides not to proceed with a power connection. Tushar M Baddi, general secretary of Vidyuth Grahakara Hitharakshana Vedike, Karnataka, questioned the legality of the deduction. "The Electricity Act, 2003, does not provide for such automatic forfeiture," he pointed out.

Karnataka Small Scale Industries Association (KASSIA) also raised concerns over the proposed requirement for occupancy certificates (OCs) or completion certificates (CCs) for power connections. Its vice-president HN Ramakrishnaiah said, "Making both these certificates an absolute precondition for electricity connections is unfair... We are all aware of the lengthy bureaucratic procedures involved in obtaining these documents, and these processes are not in our hands. However, while insisting on these certificates, Escoms should not deny us an essential service, as we would have already invested in raw materials and human resources. They can demand the certificates at a later stage when they visit the premises for verification."

The financial implications of the proposed infrastructure provisions have triggered another objection. "If you go by the draft rules, there is a possibility that both consumers and developers could be made to pay twice for the same electricity infrastructure. What is the objective behind levying an additional 5% charge on distribution transformers when developers are already required to deposit 80% of the estimated cost?" said an advocate representing a group of resident welfare associations.

MG Prabhakar, an independent energy consultant, drew attention to the metering and billing provisions in the proposed rules. "Consumers could face retrospective demands for up to six billing months merely because a meter is found to be non-recording during inspection. Therefore, laboratory testing should be made mandatory to establish the actual cause and duration of the malfunction before any additional bill is raised," he said.

He also opposed the provision allowing an additional security deposit demand for a single instance of payment default and sought protection against disconnection while billing disputes are pending.

HDK claims conspiracy to save Siddaramaiah at his expense

▶ Continued from page 1

Kumaraswamy claimed the meeting involving the CM, director general of police and commissioner took place at Kanteerava Stadium after Sunday's Rajyotsava celebrations. Claiming that it had been issued at the CM's direction, he said the disclosure violated Supreme Court guidelines governing information about pending investigations.

He said police are free to investigate any suspected exchange of phones and that he will instruct his security personnel to facilitate their inquiry.

Alleging a political conspiracy to implicate him, **Kumaraswamy** accused state police of acting at the behest of Congress functionaries to build a case against him and give Siddaramaiah a clean chit. "My doors are always open to anyone who wants to inquire. But nobody can touch me. Let me see who has the guts," he said.

He also questioned Singh's declaration on Oct 29 that the alleged sexual assault was fabricated, pointing out that forensic science laboratory (FSL) report had not yet been received. He asked how police could reach such a conclusion before receiving forensic findings.

Assn cites MLAs' interference

▶ Continued from page 1

It sought an end to interference by MLAs in tendering and scrapping of the package system, which, it said, excluded small and medium contractors.

During the meeting, Shivakumar is said to have agreed to consider some of their demands, including relaxing tender norms and curbing MLA interference. He, however, declined to disclose details, describing the meeting as fruitful.

"Some of the demands have been agreed upon. The previous BJP govts under former CMs BS Yediyurappa and Basavaraj Bommai had taken up a large number of works without allocating funds, which has led to this problem. Currently, we are bringing this under control," the CM said.

"Some 70% MLAs in Karnataka indulge in tendering interference. This needs to stop. At district and taluk levels, we asked the CM to issue directions to award the tenders to local contractors," the association said.

B'luru staffer's body found on Gokarna beach

Karwar: The body of **Vishwesh**, 24, who went missing after being swept away at Dubbansashi beach in Gokarna, was recovered Monday. The body was found about 1km from the spot where he and four others were caught in strong waves.

Three people died in the incident — Shobha, 22, Mohammed Akram and Vishwesh. Bodies of Shobha and Akram were recovered Sunday.

They were among a group of 16 employees of Aloria Ecospace, a company based in Bellandur, Bengaluru. The group had travelled to Gokarna in Kumta taluk of Uttara Kannada district, for a trip. They stayed near Dubbansashi beach. TNN

Exam topper under lens over Google Lens help

Basavaraj Maralihalli | TNN

Haveri: A candidate who emerged as the state topper in Village Administrative Officer (VAO) recruitment examination with 151.2 out of 200 marks, allegedly used Google Lens to scan questions, search for answers online and mark them on his OMR sheet, CCTV footage from the examination centre in Shiggaon has revealed.

Shankar Bannur, a resident of Elepet in Hanagal taluk, allegedly smuggled a mobile phone into the examination hall on Oct 4 as only Aadhaar cards were checked at the entrance. Seated in the rear row, he reportedly used the phone without attracting the attention of invigilators.

The alleged malpractice came to light after his score raised suspicion, as he had secured just 25 marks in the KSRP constable recruitment examination held less than three weeks earlier.

Following complaints, Karnataka Examinations Authority (KEA) executive director H Prasanna sought a detailed examination of CCTV footage from the Shiggaon centre. Preliminary findings reportedly confirmed the use of a mobile phone during the test.

Hanagal police summoned Bannur for questioning. Sources said he admitted to carrying the phone into the hall and using it to search for answers. He reportedly told police he occupied a rear seat after entering the centre with the device.

However, Bannur maintained he had appeared for nearly 45 competitive examinations, including banking tests, and had performed well in the past. He said he was willing to face any investigation.

DC Vijay Mahantesh Danammanavar said an inquiry was under way.

Vendor, 75, saves for last rites; fake cop swindles him of ₹1.9L

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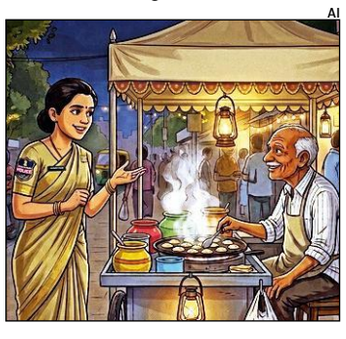
AI



Bengaluru: A 75-year-old paddu vendor, who continued working despite his advanced age to save money for his last rites, was allegedly cheated of Rs 1.9 lakh and a mobile phone by a 35-year-old woman who posed as a police officer and promised to help him recover his wife's missing gold chain.

Paddu, a popular South Indian snack, particularly in Karnataka and Tamil Nadu, is prepared by steaming batter in a specially designed mould.

The woman allegedly gained the vendor's trust over three months, collecting Rs 40,000 from him on various pretexts before taking his mobile phone and transferring another Rs 1.6 lakh from his digital payment accounts. She subsequently fled, leaving the elderly man devastated.

According to a complaint filed by Sriramulu Naidu, who runs a paddu stall on 16th Main Road in Mico Layout, the woman, identified as Siva Rani, a resident of the same south Bengaluru locality, first visited his stall around three months ago. Introducing herself as a police officer, she struck up conversations with him during subsequent visits and gradually gathered his personal details.

During one of her initial visits, Rani allegedly wore a khaki-coloured sari, similar to those worn by women police constables, to lend credibility to her claim of being a police officer.

During their conversations, Naidu told her that his wife's gold chain had gone missing at Hosur bus stand around six months ago and that they had lodged a complaint with jurisdictional police. Rani allegedly claimed her brother worked at a court and assured Naidu that she could help recover the chain by using her contacts.

After gaining his confidence, she allegedly collected around Rs 40,000 from him over the next three months, citing various reasons, including the need to pay local police personnel in Hosur.

Naidu said Rani had taken him to her rented house in Mico Layout on several occasions. She lived alone and would often discuss financial matters with him, he said.

The alleged fraud took a more serious turn on Oct 26. At around 10pm, Rani called Naidu and asked him to bring his documents. When he reached her house, she took his mobile phone, claiming that her own phone had no network and that she needed to make a call.

Transfter to multiple accounts

She allegedly used his phone to transfer Rs 1.6 lakh from his digital payment application accounts to multiple accounts.

When Naidu later asked her for her brother's phone number, Rani asked him to fetch some tablets from a medical store, promising to save the number on his phone in his absence. However, when he returned, she had disappeared.

Naidu said his total loss amounted to Rs 1.9 lakh, including the Rs 40,000 allegedly collected over three months and Rs 1.6 lakh transferred from his accounts. His phone, valued at around Rs 18,000, was missing.

Naidu said the money was meant to meet his funeral expenses after his death. His children live separately from him due to personal reasons, and he did not want them to bear the financial burden of performing his last rites. Despite his advanced age, he had continued running the stall to save money for this purpose.

According to his family members, Naidu has been deeply distressed by the loss and even attempted to end his life by consuming an excessive number of pills.

Begur police registered a case under Section 318 of Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) for cheating. A senior police officer said Rani is absconding and that efforts are under way to apprehend her.

Rani is also an accused in another cheating case registered at Banaswadi police station around six months ago. She was previously accused of cheating a cab driver of approximately Rs 16 lakh.

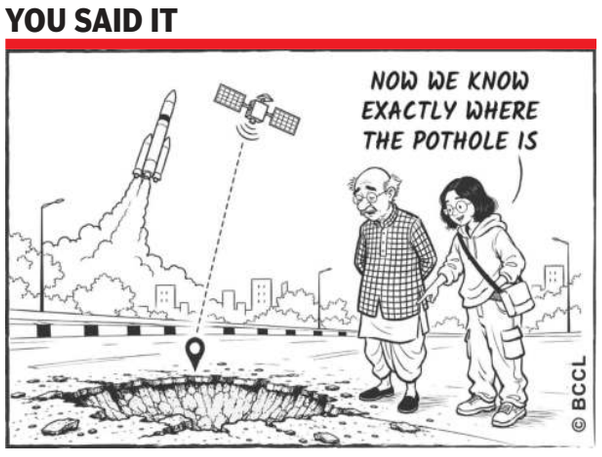
TIMES NATION

THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 3, 2026

ADITYANATH SAYS WHENEVER SAMAJWADI CAME TO POWER, IT BROUGHT RIOTS, CURFEWS AND CRIME TO UTTAR PRADESH

RAHUL GANDHI HITS BACK AT MODI OVER FOREIGN HELP CHARGE, CHALLENGES PM TO OPEN DEBATE

YOU SAID IT



CCTV must not invade neighbours' privacy: HC

But Does Not Order Camera Removal

Rajesh Kumar Pandey | TNN

Prayagraj: Private CCTV cameras cannot be installed or positioned in a manner that interferes with a neighbour's privacy, Allahabad high court has ruled.

The division bench of Justices Ajit Kumar and Garima Prashad was hearing a writ petition that challenged the placement of a CCTV camera by a neighbour.

The petitioner, Yogendra Maurya, told the court that his neighbour had installed a camera oriented toward the entry and exit points of his residence. He argued that the camera's positioning enabled recording of the movements of people entering and leaving his premises, amounting to an intrusion into his private life and a violation of his right to privacy.

Recording its view, the court said, "In our considered view, no private CCTV camera can be installed and positioned in such a manner as to interfere with the privacy of a neighbour."

The bench, however, did not pass a direct order for removal or repositioning of the camera. Instead, the court directed Maurya to approach the district magistrate (DM) by filing an appropriate application.

In its order dated Oct 26, the bench, while disposing the petition, instructed that if such an application is submitted, the DM concerned must consider and decide it within one month of receiving it.

HC awards ₹1.25L to man kept in illegal custody for 5 days

Prayagraj: Allahabad high court has ordered compensation of Rs 1.25 lakh to a man found to have been illegally kept in police custody for five days, calling out investigating officer (IO) for what it termed "arrogance of authority", **reports Rajesh Kumar Pandey**.

"The manner in which the IO detained the person for a full five days without even thinking twice or following the procedure established by law makes it appear that he considered it business as usual."

HC passed the order on Oct 29, fixing compensation at Rs 25,000 for each day Chandan Rajbhar was unlawfully confined. It said the payout would not bar him from suing police for "damages in tort", based on the extent of the wrong done to the claimant — and that the harshest punishment should be considered if the officer was found guilty in departmental inquiry.

The case started with a July 18 FIR, accusing Chandan of eloping with the complainant's daughter (18). Police reached the couple's Pune home on Aug 25 and took them into custody, the petitioners said.

2 brothers held for killing cheetah

Two brothers have been arrested for killing a 19-month-old Kuno-born cheetah after mistaking it for a leopard while hunting, **reports P Naveen.** One allegedly shot the radio-collared animal from barely 15 feet in Sheopur on Oct 24. STF seized their licensed double-barrel gun. Bhagwan and Pritam Singh, residents of Morena district in Madhya Pradesh, belong to the nomadic Mongia community, which has a hunting tradition. Bhagwan was arrested on Oct 31, while his brother was traced outside MP. The slain cheetah, KNG-22, was born to Nirva at Kuno National Park. Poaching has been a recurring problem around the park since 2022.

Tribunal hears WB Christian victims

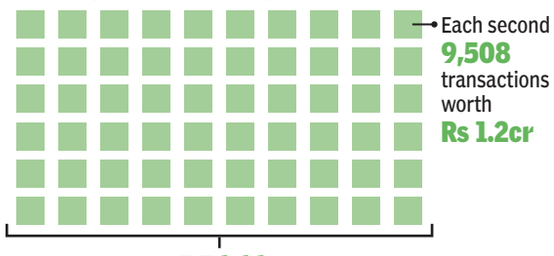
A people's tribunal organised jointly by civil rights groups was convened Monday to record testimonies of Christians facing violence in West Bengal over the past few months. The tribunal panel heard 15 accounts from victims and experts highlighting mob attacks, police apathy and false charges. One woman said a mob of 80-100 people attacked her house church on Oct 2 and assaulted her family. A pastor alleged he was falsely accused of forced conversions and assaulted by right-wing members, but police instead booked him for attempted murder. "We will make this a public issue," Jawhar Sircar, a member, said. TNN

STATISTICS A slice of life in numbers

India processes over 9,500 UPI transactions every second

In Oct, 2,547 crore transactions worth Rs 31.5 lakh crore were made through UPI — **an all time record.** That's an average of 82.2 crore transactions and Rs 1.02 lakh crore per day, with each payment worth about Rs 1,238

Average UPI transactions per minute in India, Oct 2026



Source: NPCI

After two decades in spotlight, lioness Heera—granny of circus—retires at 24

Vivek.Narayanan
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24 GOING ON 100: Heera was 18 months old when she was rescued from a travelling circus

For more than two decades, she remained the cynosure of many eyes. Now, at 24, Heera has retired.

Rescued from a travelling circus when she was 18 months old sometime in the early 2000s, today Heera is arguably the oldest living lion in India. For a lion, which has a life expectancy of 20 years in captivity (and 12 in the wild), Heera's age is comparable to a 100-year-old human's. Chennai's Arignar Anna Zoological Park authorities have moved her away from the visitors' gaze to the rescue centre attached to the zoo.

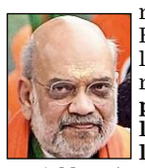
"Heera was brought here along with two other lions. We don't have a record of her birthplace," said T Ritto Cyriac, zoo director and chief conservator of forests. At the rescue centre, the lioness gets veterinary care including nutritional monitoring.

"Her daily diet comprises 4kg beef with bone, 150g liver and 4kg live chicken. She takes a stroll and sometimes plays with a wooden ball in the enclosure," says Cyriac.

The rescue centre at Vandalur has played a key role in rehabilitating animals rescued from circuses following Centre's 1998 ban on the exhibition of wild animals.

Amit Shah dares Rahul to debate infiltrators, SIR & EVMs in Parl

Hyderabad: BJP will deport every infiltrator, Union home minister Amit Shah said Monday, accusing Congress of resisting SIR to preserve its vote bank and daring Lok Sabha leader of opposition Rahul Gandhi to a parliamentary debate on electoral roll revision, EVMs and illegal immigration, **reports Sribala Vadlapatla**.



Addressing a public meeting after a BJP padayatra in Hyderabad, Shah said Rahul's rally in Delhi was not about saving votes but shielding illegal Bangladeshi immigrants. "Rahul Gandhi and Congress can organise as many rallies as they want, but BJP will deport every infiltrator from the country," he said, asserting that only Indian citizens could vote.

Shah renewed his challenge for a parliamentary debate, alleging Rahul was reluctant because PM Narendra Modi would expose Congress's arguments.

HC stays JNU prof termination in sex abuse case

New Delhi: Delhi high court Monday stayed Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) administration's decision to terminate the services of professor Angomcha Bimol Akoijam over allegations of sexual harassment.

HC also issued notice to JNU on his petition challenging the dismissal and listed the case for Jan. Akoijam, who is also Congress MP from Inner Manipur Lok Sabha seat, was a professor at School of Social Sciences and, as per reports, at least 10 women students filed sexual harassment complaints against him in May. He was dismissed on Oct 9. TNN

1,100-yr-old MP Jain temple to be dismantled & rebuilt

Vinita Chaturvedi | TNN

Bhopal: It will be dismantled to be saved. First, every stone will be marked. Every carving documented. ASI is preparing to take apart a 1,100-year-old rock-cut Jain temple on a hillock in Madhya Pradesh's Vidisha district, restore its stones and rebuild the monument on a new platform in an operation expected to stretch beyond two years.

Closed to visitors for years, the Pratihara-era monument has waited decades for a rescue. A conservation attempt by the erstwhile Gwalior state in 1930 made little headway.

"Sketches and drawings are ready. Each stone and architectural component is being identified and recorded manually as well as digitally. The platform on which the temple stands is extremely brittle, so another platform is being constructed to support the original," ASI director general Yadubir Singh Rawat said.

The plan is to stabilise the monument's foundation and build a supporting platform. Scaffolding will then go up before the structure is taken down. Every surviving fragment must be preserved and every stone put back where it belongs. The objective is to secure the shrine without erasing the craftsmanship.

The rock-cut Jain temple on a hillock in MP's Vidisha

"There is a deep moat and very little working space, which makes the operation challenging," Rawat said.

The work is being undertaken by ASI Bhopal circle under superintending archaeologist Shivakant Bajpai. A 12-member core team is handling the exercise. The temple's origins are traced to a Kalachuri inscription dating to 850-885 CE.

Keralam teen's body found in sack, 2 friends in custody

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Thiruvananthapuram: A 16-year-old boy who went missing from his home in Sreekaryam in Thiruvananthapuram Sunday was later found murdered, with his body stuffed inside a sack and abandoned in a vacant plot at Pangappara, another locality in the city. Police took two people, including a 17-year-old boy, into custody in connection with the case.

Abhiram, the deceased, was a student of Class 11 in Paruthippara NSS Higher Secondary School. Preliminary investigation indicates that a dispute linked to the friendship with a girl may have led to the killing, police said.

Police suspect the accused used the girl's Instagram account to communicate with Abhiram and lure him to an isolated location. Investigators believe Abhiram was strangled using a belt. His body was then stuffed inside a sack and abandoned in a vacant plot, police said.

Police detained two suspects for questioning, one a 17-year-old boy and the other aged 19. The younger suspect is likely to have been close to the girl, while investigators are examining whether Abhiram's interaction with her triggered a dispute between the boys.

Police are continuing their investigation, including examining whether more people were involved in the crime. His body has been sent for autopsy.

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अल्पकालीन ई–निविदा सूचना क्रमांक :– 24/2026–27

SUPPLY, DELIVERY AND OPERATION-MAINTENANCE OF 08 NO'S VEHICLE MOUNTED VACUUM BASED LITTER PICKER MACHINES AS PER TENDER CONDITIONS हेतु पंजीकृत फर्म्स से ई–निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र, विस्तृत सूचना एवं शर्तें आदि सम्पूर्ण विवरण वेबसाइट **www.jaipurmc.org**, **www.sppp.raj.nic.in** and **www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर स्टेट पब्लिक प्रोक्यूरमेन्ट के **UBN No. JMC2627WLOB00741** पर देखी जा सकती है।

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राज.संवाद/सी/26/12785

ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಸರ್ಕಾರ
ಕಾರ್ಯನಿರ್ವಾಹಕ ಇಂಜಿನೀಯರರು, ಲೋಕೋಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆ, ವಿಭಾಗ ಕಾರವಾರ

ಸಂ: ಕಾಸಿ/ಇಂ./ಲೋ.ಇ.ವಿ,ಕಾ/ಹಿ.ಬಿ–1/ಟೆಂಡರ್–23 / 2026–27/ 3150 ದಿನಾಂಕ: 02–11–2026

ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆ ಆಹ್ವಾನ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ (ಇ–ಪ್ರೊಕ್ಯೂರಮೆಂಟ್)

ಅರ್ಹ ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆದಾರರಿಂದ ಈ ಕೆಳಗೆ ವಿವರಿಸಿರುವ ಕಾಮಗಾರಿಗಳಿಗಾಗಿ ಕಾರ್ಯನಿರ್ವಾಹಕ ಇಂಜಿನೀಯರರು, ಲೋಕೋಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆ ವಿಭಾಗ, ಕಾರವಾರ ಇವರಿಂದ ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆ ಆಹ್ವಾನಿಸಲಾಗಿದೆ. ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆದಾರರು ಕೆಳಗೆ ಕೊಟ್ಟಿರುವ ಕಾಮಗಾರಿಯ ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆಯನ್ನು ಇ–ಪ್ರೊಕ್ಯೂರಮೆಂಟ್ ಮುಖಾಂತರ ಮಾತ್ರ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸುವದು. ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆಯನ್ನು ಪಡೆಸಲು ಅರ್ಹರಾಗಬೇಕಾದಲ್ಲಿ ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆದಾರರು (ಕೆಡಬ್ಲೂ–4)ರಲ್ಲಿ ನಿಗದಿಪಡಿಸಿರುವ ಪರತ್ತುಗಳನ್ನು ಗಮನಿಸುವದು.

(1) ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆಗೆ ಸಂಬಂಧಿಸಿದ ವಿಚಾರಣೆಗೆ ಕೊನೆಯ ದಿ: 12–11–2026 16.30 ಗಂಟೆವರೆಗೆ
(2) ಟೆಂಡರನ್ನು ಸ್ವೀಕರಿಸುವ ಕೊನೆಯ ದಿ: 13–11–2026 16.30 ಗಂಟೆವರೆಗೆ
(3) ಟೆಂಡರನ ತಾಂತ್ರಿಕ ಬಿಡ್ ತೆರೆಯುವ ದಿ: 16–11–2026 17.00 ಗಂಟೆವರೆಗೆ
(4) ಟೆಂಡರನ ಆರ್ಥಿಕ ಬಿಡ್ ತೆರೆಯುವ ದಿ: 18–11–2026 17.00 ಗಂಟೆವರೆಗೆ

ಕಾಮಗಾರಿಯ ಹೆಸರು: **H/Ac 4059-80-051-0-57-386 Residential Buildings During 2025-2026**

ವರ್ಕ್ ಇಂಡೆಂಟ್: (1) PWD/2025-26/BD/WORK_INDENT28113 H/Ac 5054-04-337-0-01-154 ಜಿಲ್ಲಾ ರಸ್ತೆಗಳು ಸುಧಾರಣೆ During 2025-2026
ವರ್ಕ್ ಇಂಡೆಂಟ್: (1) PWD/2026-27/RD/WORK_INDENT35790

* (ಕೆಡಬ್ಲೂ–4) ರಲ್ಲಿನ ನಿಭಂದನೆಗಳನ್ನು ಮುಂಬಿನ ದಿನಗಳಲ್ಲಿ e-proc ನಲ್ಲಿ ಸೂಚಿಸಲಾದ ನಿಭಂದನೆಗಳನ್ನು ಇಲಾಖಾ ವೆಬ್‌ಸೈಟ್‌ನಲ್ಲಿ ಅಂದರೆ "https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in" ನೋಡಬಹುದು. ಹೆಚ್ಚಿನ ಮಾಹಿತಿಗಾಗಿ help desk Bangalore (Phone No. 918025501216 & 918025501227) ಇವರನ್ನು ಸಂಪರ್ಕಿಸಬಹುದು.
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DIPR/KWR/KSMCA/493/26-27 dt. 02.11.2026

ಸಹಿ/– ಕಾರ್ಯನಿರ್ವಾಹಕ ಅಭಿಯಂತರರು, ಲೋಕೋಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆ, ವಿಭಾಗ, ಕಾರವಾರ

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No:KSTDC/PROJECT/32/2026-27/1969 Date: 02.11.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

The Karnataka State Tourism Development Corporation Limited (KSTDC), Bengaluru, invites tenders from eligible and interested contractors for the execution of repairs and renovation works at Hotel Mayura Hoysala, Mysuru a unit of the Corporation. The details of the tender are as follows:

Tender No	Description	Last Date & Time for Bid Submission
KSTDC/ 2026-27/ BD/ WORK_ INDENT6	Selection of eligible and interested contractors for the execution of repairs and renovation works at Hotel Mayura Hoysala, Mysuru	**30.11.2026 16:00 Hrs.**

The detailed tender documents are available in the website: **www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in** For any further clarifications contact 9240214000/01, Email: **support@eprochelpdesk.com**

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"REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL"

Nit & System No.	Project Name
NIT No.:6177/ योजना/म.प्र.ट्.बो/ 2026 and SYSTEM No.-2026_ MPTB_547154 Dated 02.11.2026	1. Request for Proposal for Appointment of Agency for Development of Tourist Experience/Museum & Immersive Experience Centre and for Operations, Maintenance & Management of Ahilya Lok at Maheshwar, Madhya Pradesh, India.
NIT No.: 6177/ योजना/म.प्र. ट्.बो/ 2026 and SYSTEM No.-2026_ MPTB_547162 Dated 02.11.2026	2. Request for Proposal for Appointment of Agency for Development of Experience Curation & Development for Immersive Experience, Interactive Exhibits in museum and for Operations, Maintenance & Management of Atal Smarak Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh, India.

MPTB invites offers for **"Request for Proposal for Appointment of Agencies for Execution/Development of projects as detailed above for Operations, Maintenance & Management of Ahilya Lok Maheshwar and Atal Smarak Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh, India"** The detailed terms & conditions can be downloaded from website https://www.mptenders.gov.in/www.tourism.mp.gov.in For any other information please contact. **Mob. No. +91-9993574567** or e-mail at **jdplg.mptb@mp.gov.in.** Last Date and Time for online submission of the RFP is 19.11.2026 @ 17:00 Hr.

M.P. Madhyam/128902/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

ಲೋಕೋಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆ

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ಇ–ಪ್ರೊಕ್ಯೂರ್‌ಮೆಂಟ್ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ
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ಕಾರ್ಯನಿರ್ವಾಹಕ ಇಂಜಿನೀಯರರು, ಲೋಕೋಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆ, ಧಾರವಾಡರವರು ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ರಾಜ್ಯಪಾಲರ ಪರವಾಗಿ ಕೆ.ಟಿ.ಪಿ.ಪಿ.ಪಿ 2000 ರನ್ವಯ ಮತ್ತು ಸ್ಟ್ಯಾಂಡರ್ಡ್ ಡಾಕ್ಯೂಮೆಂಟ್ ಕೆಡಬ್ಲ್ಯೂ–1,2,3 & 4 ರ ನಿಯಮದಂತೆ ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಸರ್ಕಾರದ ಕೆ.ಪಿ.ಪಿ.ಪಿ. **(kppp.karnataka.gov.in)** ಪೋರ್ಟಲ್ ಮೂಲಕ ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಲೋಕೋಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ನೋಂದಣಿ ಮಾಡಿದ ಅರ್ಹ ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆದಾರರಿಂದ ದ್ವಿ–ಲಕೋಟೆ ಪದ್ಧತಿಯಲ್ಲಿ ರೂ. 3.00 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳಿಂದ ಗರಿಷ್ಟ ರೂ.8000.00 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳ **ಲೆಕ್ಕಶೀರ್ಷಿಕೆ:– 5054–80–190–0–01–132** ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ರಸ್ತೆ ಅಭಿವೃದ್ಧಿ ನಿಗಮ ನಿಯಮಿತ – ಬಂಡವಾಳ ವೆಚ್ಚ, **CMIDP ಲೆಕ್ಕಶೀರ್ಷಿಕೆ 4059–80–051–0–60–132 ಅಡಿ, ಹಾಗೂ 8443, 2059, 2216, ಯೋಜನೆಗಳಡಿಯಲ್ಲಿ** ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಕರೆಯಲಾಗಿದೆ.

ಸಾಮಾನ್ಯ 1) 41078, (2) 40993, (3) 40994, (4) 39468, (5) 43772 (6)37615/Call-2, (7) 31543/Call-4, (8) 34417/call-3, (9) 44377, (10), 44427, (11) 44428, (12) 44421, (13) 45233, (14) 44429, (15) 44251, (16) 45356, (17) SE1453/Call-2 ಪರಿಶಿಷ್ಟ ಜಾತಿ (1) 45105 (2) 44408, (3) 44378 ಪರಿಶಿಷ್ಟ ಪಂಗಡ (1) 44376 CAT-I (1) 44418, CAT-IIA (1) 44379, (2) 44420, (3) 45243, (4) SE1558

Calander of Events: SHORT TERM

1) ಪ್ರಿಬಿಡ್ / ಆಕ್ಷೇಪಣೆಯನ್ನು /ಸಲ್ಲಿಸುವ ಕೊನೆಯ **ದಿನಾಂಕ: 11–11–2026 (ಬೆಳಿಗ್ಗೆ 12:30 ಗಂಟೆಯವರೆಗೆ).** 2) ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆ ಪತ್ರಗಳನ್ನು ಸ್ವೀಕರಿಸುವ ಕೊನೆಯ **ದಿನಾಂಕ: 12–11–2026 (ಸಾಯಂಕಾಲ 16:00 ಗಂಟೆಯವರೆಗೆ).** 3) ತಾಂತ್ರಿಕ ಬಿಡ್ ತೆರೆಯುವ **ದಿನಾಂಕ:13–11–2026 (ಸಾಯಂಕಾಲ 16:30 ಗಂಟೆಯ ನಂತರ).** 4) ಆರ್ಥಿಕ ಬಿಡ್ ತೆರೆಯುವ **ದಿನಾಂಕ:16–11–2026(ಸಾಯಂಕಾಲ 16:30 ಗಂಟೆಯ ನಂತರ).**

Calander of Events: LONG TERM

ಸಾಮಾನ್ಯ (1) 36186

1) ಪ್ರಿಬಿಡ್ / ಆಕ್ಷೇಪಣೆಯನ್ನು /ಸಲ್ಲಿಸುವ ಕೊನೆಯ **ದಿನಾಂಕ:03–12–2026 (ಬೆಳಿಗ್ಗೆ 12:30 ಗಂಟೆಯವರೆಗೆ).** 2) ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆ ಪತ್ರಗಳನ್ನು ಸ್ವೀಕರಿಸುವ ಕೊನೆಯ **ದಿನಾಂಕ: 05–12–2026 (ಸಾಯಂಕಾಲ 16:00 ಗಂಟೆಯವರೆಗೆ).** 3) ತಾಂತ್ರಿಕ ಬಿಡ್ ತೆರೆಯುವ **ದಿನಾಂಕ: 07–12–2026 (ಸಾಯಂಕಾಲ 16:30 ಗಂಟೆಯ ನಂತರ).** 4) ಆರ್ಥಿಕ ಬಿಡ್ ತೆರೆಯುವ **ದಿನಾಂಕ:08–12–2026 (ಸಾಯಂಕಾಲ 16:30 ಗಂಟೆಯ ನಂತರ).**

ಕಾಮಗಾರಿಗಳಿಗೆ ಸಂಬಂಧಿಸಿದ ಎಲ್ಲಾ ವಿವರಗಳನ್ನು ಅಂತರ್‌ಜಾಲ ವಿಳಾಸ **https://www.kppp.karnataka,gov.in** ದಲ್ಲಿ ಹಾಗೂ ಲೋಕೊಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆ ಧಾರವಾಡ ವಿಭಾಗ ಕಛೇರಿಯಿಂದ ಕಚೇರಿಯ ವೇಳೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಪಡೆಯಬಹುದಾಗಿರುತ್ತದೆ.

ಸಹಿ/– ಕಾರ್ಯನಿರ್ವಾಹಕ ಇಂಜಿನೀಯರರು,
ಲೋಕೋಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆ, ಧಾರವಾಡ ವಿಭಾಗ,
ಧಾರವಾಡ.

ವಾಸಾಸಂ೫/ಧಾರವಾಡ/708/ಅಡ್ಮಿರ್ಸ್/2026–27

Pressured into same-sex marriage, Pjb girl ends life

Ludhiana: A 15-year-old Class 10 student died by suicide in Ludhiana, allegedly because a 25-year-old woman had been pressuring her into a same-sex marriage. Police arrested the accused Monday evening.

The teen's father, a factory worker, alleged that his daughter befriended the accused on Instagram around six months ago, adding that the older woman relentlessly pressured his daughter for a relationship and marriage, leaving the minor severely distressed. On Saturday evening, the teen allegedly ended her life. Police did not find a suicide note but registered a case against the accused on Sunday under BNS Section 108 (abetment to suicide). Cops said the accused owns a shop in Ludhiana. Police were also examining whether she had befriended and pressured other girls similarly. TNN

KONKAN RAILWAY CORPORATION LIMITED

सादर सेवा

(A Government of India Undertaking)

TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of Konkan Railway Corporation Limited, Dy. Chief Engineer/Works, Karwar invites following open tenders through ireps.gov.in portal. **Name of the work** - Construction of Foot Over Bridge with Ramp Connecting Platform No. 1 to Platform No. 2 at Mulki Railway Station in Karnataka State. **Tender No. KR/KW/W/2026/46/CB/R1, Cost of the work** : ₹ 198.67/- Lakhs (Excluding GST), **Date & time of closing of tender** : 20/11/2026 at 15.00 Hrs. For further details, contact Office of Dy. Chief Engineer, Works, Konkan Railway Corporation Ltd. Karwar. For more details visit (https://www.ireps.gov.in)

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-20640)

Tender Enquiry no. 1965/Th.Op/O&M/PC-2834 Dated: 02.11.2026

Chief Engineer / O&M (P&P Cell-I), GHTP, Lehra Mohabbat-151111 Distt. Bathinda invites E-tender for the **Procurement of 140 MT of Sulphuric Acid for GHTP Lehra Mohabbat.** Quantity as per NIT. For detailed NIT & Tender Specifications please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from **02.11.2026** from 17:00 hrs. Onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and Addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

GHTP-81/26, DPR/Pb.: 1079/12/2026-27/16731

संजय गांधी स्नातकोत्तर आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, लखनऊ
Sanjay Gandhi Postgraduate Institute of Medical Sciences

Raebareli Road Lucknow-226014, India
Phones: +91-522-2668700-800 Ext. 4236

ONLINE GeM-BID INVITED ON GeM- PORTAL

Online GeM-Bid invited on GeM portal for Comprehensive Maintenance Contract for Water Purifiers (RO/Aquaguards). Bid details are as under:-

S.N.	Particulars	Bid Number	Date
1.	Comprehensive Maintenance Contract for Water Purifiers (RO/ Aquaguards)	GEM/2026/B/ 8222065	30.10.2026

The eligible bidders should submit their bids online only " in the submission module of GeM Portal".

Advt. No. I/58/CMMC/2026-27 Director

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-22942)

Tender Inquiry No : 14/MHC/2026-27, 15/MHC/2026-27, 16/MHC/2026-27 Dated : 02.11.2026

Sr. Xen/Civil, MHC O&M Division Talwara invites E-Tender for following as per technical specification :

1. Restoration of damaged CC Lining slabs in between RD 1846 M to RD 2975 M on both sides of MHC-II during the year 2026-27. **(14/MHC/2026-27)**
2. Filling of cavities behind CC lining slabs by coarse sand grouting in between RD 31722 M to RD 35500 M on both sides of MHC-I during the year 2026-27. **(15/MHC/2026-27)**
3. OUTSOURCING OF ACTIVITY/SERVICES FOR WATCH & WARD, CUTTING & CLEARANCE OF WILD GROWTH FROM THE JOINTS OF CEMENT CONCRETE LINING SLABS, INTERNAL SIDE SLOPES /EMBANKMENTS /DRAIN, STONE PITCHING ETC. OF MHC-I & II FOR THE PERIOD OF ONE YEAR. **(16/MHC/2026-27)**

For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 03.11.2026 from 05:00 PM onwards.

Note : Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C1039/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16713

Commissionerate of E.S.I.S Medical Services

S.Nijalingappa Road, 2nd Block, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru-560 010. Tel/Fax: 080-2332 4216
Website: https://esisms.karnataka.gov.in

RE-TENDER NOTIFICATION

ESIS Medical Service, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru-560 010, invites Re-Tender for the following services from the reputed companies.

1) Tender Notification No. **ESIS/EGS/03/2026-27 Date: 29.10.2026**. The E-Tender for Supply and Installation of various Equipments to ESI Hospitals, Diagnostic Centers & Dispensaries under PIP 2026-27.

2) Tender Notification No. **ESIS/EGS/03/2025-26(P1) Date: 29.10.2026**. E-Tender for Two Stage Quality Cum Cost Based Selection(QCBS) for Providing Haemodialysis Services under Public Private Partnership (PPP) in ESIS Hospitals.

3)Details regarding Tender visit: https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in **4)** Pre-bid meeting: **04.11.2026 at** Commissionerate of ESIS Medical Services, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru-10. **5)** Last date for receipt of submission of tender through e-Procurement Portal System: **16.11.2026 within 17.30 hrs. 6)** Technical Bid Opening date & time of Tender: **18.11.2026 at 11.30 a.m.**

For further details visit **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**

Sd/-
Commissioner,
ESIS Med. Services

DIPR/CP/3479/MAA/26-27

ओएनजीसी ONGC
ऑयल एण्ड नेचुरल गैस कॉरपोरेशन लिमिटेड
ONGC Oil and Natural Gas Corporation Ltd.

Publication of EOI notice

Oil and Natural Gas Corporation Ltd. (ONGC), a Government of India "MAHARATNA" Category Enterprise, is India's premier energy enterprise with diversified interests across the energy sector.

To ensure safety of personnel engaged in emergency response, firefighting, rescue, confined space entry and operations in hazardous atmospheres, ONGC requires reliable, certified and globally accepted Self-Contained Breathing Apparatus (SCBA) Sets conforming to applicable Indian and International Standards.

The objective of this exercise is to assess market capability, undertake a comprehensive review of BIS, EN, and NFPA standards, and identify the most appropriate international best practices for the procurement of SCBA sets. The initiative aims to ensure the highest levels of safety, performance, reliability, and equipment integrity, thereby enhancing firefighter protection in hazardous and life-threatening environments. It also seeks to promote fair competition and maximize participation from qualified and competent manufacturers.

Vendors whose products are successfully evaluated and proven through technical review may be considered for future procurement under applicable procurement policies. (Details available at ONGC tender portal: **https://tenders.ongc.co.in**).

A pre-submission meeting is scheduled for **November 06, 2026**, and the last date for submission of EOI is **November 18, 2026**. Interested parties are requested to submit their responses in electronic (PDF/PPT) format to **cfsc@ongc.co.in**.

To participate in the pre-submission meeting or for any clarifications, kindly reach out to the above email ID or contact numbers: +91-11-26751074

Corrigenda, addenda, amendments, and time extensions to the EOI (if any) will be published only on the ONGC tender portal only. No separate notification shall be issued in the press. Prospective participants are advised to visit the portal regularly for updates.

8,000+ addl preterm births in India linked to climate change

Nos. Reported During April '24 Heatwave

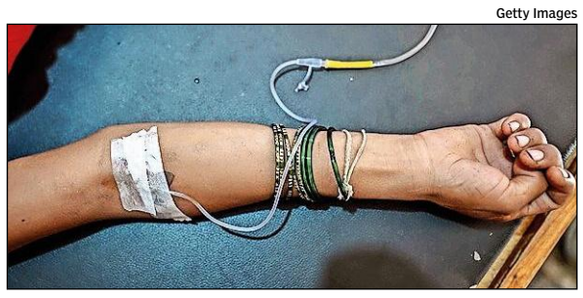
Malathy.Iyer@timesofindia.com

Mumbai: Climate change caused by human activity led to an estimated 8,830 additional preterm births in India during the April 2024 heatwave, according to a new analysis.

Climate change made the heatwave at least 45 times more likely, the analysis by international non-profit research group Zero Carbon Analytics found.

Across India, Bangladesh and the Philippines, climate change was linked to 10,600 additional preterm births in April 2024. However, the overall heatwave was associated with around 16,150 more preterm births than would have occurred during a typical April in recent decades. India saw a 3.6% increase, compared with 11.9% in Bangladesh and 10% in the Philippines.

Getty Images



The latest analysis found that within India, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, West Bengal and Jharkhand accounted for around two-thirds of the additional preterm births linked to the heatwave

Preterm birth – when a baby is born before 37 weeks of gestation – is the leading cause of newborn deaths worldwide. Premature babies also face a higher risk of long-term health and developmental problems.

Doctors say extreme heat puts the pregnant body under stress. "Any extreme climatic condition can affect pregnant women. Due to extreme heat, they could suffer from dehydration or suffer stress that releases hormones that could predispose them to preterm labour," said Arun Nayak, who heads the gynaecology department of BMC-run Sion Hospital. Western studies have shown that the risks are particularly high during the third trimester.

Bhagwan Keshbhat of NGO Waatavaran told **TOI** that pregnancy-related problems increase during heatwaves. Women had also reported such difficulties during community discussions organised by the NGO in rural Maharashtra.

The latest analysis found that within India, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, West Bengal and Jharkhand accounted for around two-thirds of the additional preterm births linked to the heatwave.

The burden could grow with rising temperatures. By mid-century, India could see more than 15,000 additional preterm births during a typical April due to heat, exceeding the estimated burden during April 2024. Uttar Pradesh is projected to face the highest burden, followed by Bihar and Rajasthan.

Petitioners can be given status of victims of crime, says SC

▶ Continued from page 1

A bench of CJI Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana asked the trial court to proceed with the trial in accordance with law.

On the large number of petitioners, who had sought an independent probe into the donation theft incident, the bench said the petitioners can be given the status of victims of crime, and in public interest, they can assist the prosecutor and trial court in proceedings.

Meanwhile, a petitioner sought a direction from SC for an "independent, impartial, technically competent survey/demarcation" of the land that was allotted for construction of the temple. He sought a direction to revenue and statutory authorities to place before SC relevant records and compare thereof with the site plan and actual location of the Ram Janmabhoomi Temple complex to determine if the present complex stands on the land allotted by the court.

Defence ministry inks ₹53k cr contracts with two shipyards

Surendra.Singh
@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: Defence ministry Monday signed contracts worth Rs 53,866 crore with two shipyards — Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers Limited (GRSE) and Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) — for the acquisition of eight next-generation corvettes (NGCs) for Indian Navy. Under the contracts, GRSE will construct five corvettes while GSL the remaining three.

The project marks a milestone as it is the first project in which these type of ships will be indigenously designed by Navy and constructed by defence public sector undertakings (DPSUs). The contracts were inked in the presence of defence secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh. "Great news for India's indigenous shipbuilding ecosystem. NGC project for Indian Navy will provide a significant impetus to India's shipbuilding sector by strengthening collaboration among DPSUs, private shipyards and Indian industrial partners, including MSMEs," defence minister Rajnath Singh said.

The construction of these ships will generate approximately 72 lakh person-days of employment in the shipyards and 460 lakh person-days in ancillary industries and MSMEs over the next 10 years, he said.

Corvettes are small, fast and heavily armed warships ranked below a frigate in size. These agile warships are meant for anti-submarine warfare, anti-surface warfare and coastal defence. They perform maritime surveillance, search-and-attack operations, escort duties for larger fleet ships, and patrol missions. Navy currently operates 18 to 24 corvettes.

NGCs will be equipped with capabilities such as advanced missiles, weapons and sensor suites, enabling them to undertake missions across the air, surface and sub-surface domains, a defence ministry release said.

TN man kills college student for befriending minor daughter

Trichy: The father of a 12-year-old girl stabbed a 21-year-old college student to death in Perambalur district of Tamil Nadu on Sunday night after he learned that the youth was in a relationship with her, police said.

Perambalur police on Monday arrested the girl's father and mother in connection with the murder.

S Abimanyu, the deceased, was an MCA student at a private college and worked part-time as a car driver for the girl's 45-year-old father, police said. During this period, he got into a relationship with his employer's daughter, a Class 7 student, and bought her a mobile phone to stay in touch with her, police said. On Sunday night, after the girl's parents found out about the relationship, they confronted Abimanyu at his house.

During a heated argument, the girl's father assaulted him with an iron rod and then stabbed him with a knife. The girl's 31-year-old mother was also present at the crime scene, police said. TNN

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CHANGE OF NAME

I, Celine Madhure w/o of 604795-H- (Ex) SGT C.H.Madhure, residing at No.1105, 'A' Block, Wing-2, Opposite Shirke Apartment, Kengeri, Bengaluru-560060, changed my name from Elizabeth Mendez to Celine Madhure. Also date of birth also has been corrected as 08-09-1956. Both the names are pertained to one and the same person. vide affidavit dated 27.10.2026, sworn before Notary, Ravi. Henceforth, I shall be known as Celine Madhure for all purposes.

I, Kahlaan Das Ghosh, aged 20 years, son of Smt. Karnika Ghosh, residing at Flat B5-034, DLF Westend Heights, Begur, Bengaluru, 560068, hereby give public notice that I have changed my name from Kahlaan Das to Kahlaan Das Ghosh vide affidavit, Certificate number: IN-KA15420658648781Y dated 10.10.2026 sworn before Aravind Patil G.G., Advocate and Notary, Govt. of Karnataka. Henceforth, I shall be known only as Kahlaan Das Ghosh for all purposes.

I, RAGHAVENDRA Residing at Flat No: 308, Aditya Harmony, Vakil Garden City, Kanakapura Road, Near Gyana Sweekara School Thalaghattapura, Bengaluru- 560062 have changed my name to Raghavendra Chimmalgi vide Affidavit dated 27.10.2026 sworn before notary R T Krishna Murthy, Bengaluru.

CHANGE OF NAME

I, AMRUTA AMOL TAMBEKAR, Aadhaar Card No.6799 5429 3696 & Pancard No: AOQPT0955D, R/o Flat No. 308, 3rd Floor, Sherwood Apartment, 4th A Cross, Kaggadasapura, C V Raman Nagar Post, Bengaluru - 560093, Karnataka, have changed my name from LAYKAR RUPALI YASHAWANT to AMRUTA AMOL TAMBEKAR, vide affidavit Dt: 31-10-2026 before notary A.R Muneer Ahmed, Bangalore.

I, LYDIA NOAH CHINNAPPA, w/o Noah Solomon Chinnappa r/o 001 VMR Rosedale Apts 3rd Cross BDS Nagar, K Narayanpura, Kothanur, Bengaluru-77 have changed my name from M.Chamandeswari to LYDIA NOAH CHINNAPPA for all purposes.

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tender & notices

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that as per the information provided by my client Anitha K.N who is absolute owner of property bearing No.176, PID No.2858653570 situated at 1st Cross Road, Tavarekere Extension, Cashier layout, Begur Hobli, Bangalore South Taluk. The original documents relating to the aforesaid property namely General Power of Attorney dated 20.01.1991 and Agreement of Sale dated 20.01.1991 have been lost, misplaced and not traceable and the same has been reported to the police under No.2491655. If any person finds aforesaid documents, he/ she/ they shall inform the same in writing within 7 days from publication of this notice at the below address.

Date: 02.11.2026 Sanjeeva Murthy D
Advocate, No.10, JP Complex, Kaggalipura, Bengaluru – 560116, 9481385201, sanjeevadvocate@hotmail.com

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PUBLIC NOTICE

In response to the paper publication dated 31.10.2026 and 01.11.2026 in Times of India, English Daily Newspaper, regarding the prime property measuring 28500 square feet with old building at Kudlu Gate, Hosur Road, is for sale. Our client **Lokesh Reddy** has instructed us to respond to the said Advertisement. The said Advertisement is misleading. Our client had filed a suit in respect of southern portion of the land bearing Survey No.36, measuring 29 guntas along with an unfinished farm house measuring 7350 square feet against K.H.Khan and K.N.Nisar Ahmed, The Case (RFA 258/2026) is Pending in High Court. Public are warned not to purchase the said land with old building and if any one does so, they may do so at their own risk.

SCHEDULE PROPERTY

All that piece and parcel of portion of southern portion of land in Sy.No.36 measuring 29 guntas out of 1 acre along with unfinished farm house measuring 7350 Sft without electricity and sanitary connections, situated at Kudlu village, coming under Kudlu Panchayat, Sarjapura Hobli, Anekal Taluk, bounded on:

East by: Property belonging to Srinivasa Reddy,
West by: PWD Road
North by: Remaining portion of land in same Sy No.36 belonging to Lokesh Reddy and others,
South by: AECS (HAL) Layout

Sd/-
H.R.ANANTHAKRISHNAMURTHY AND ASSOCIATES,
Advocates
#140, Infantry Road, Bengaluru-560 001 Ph: 080-22863713

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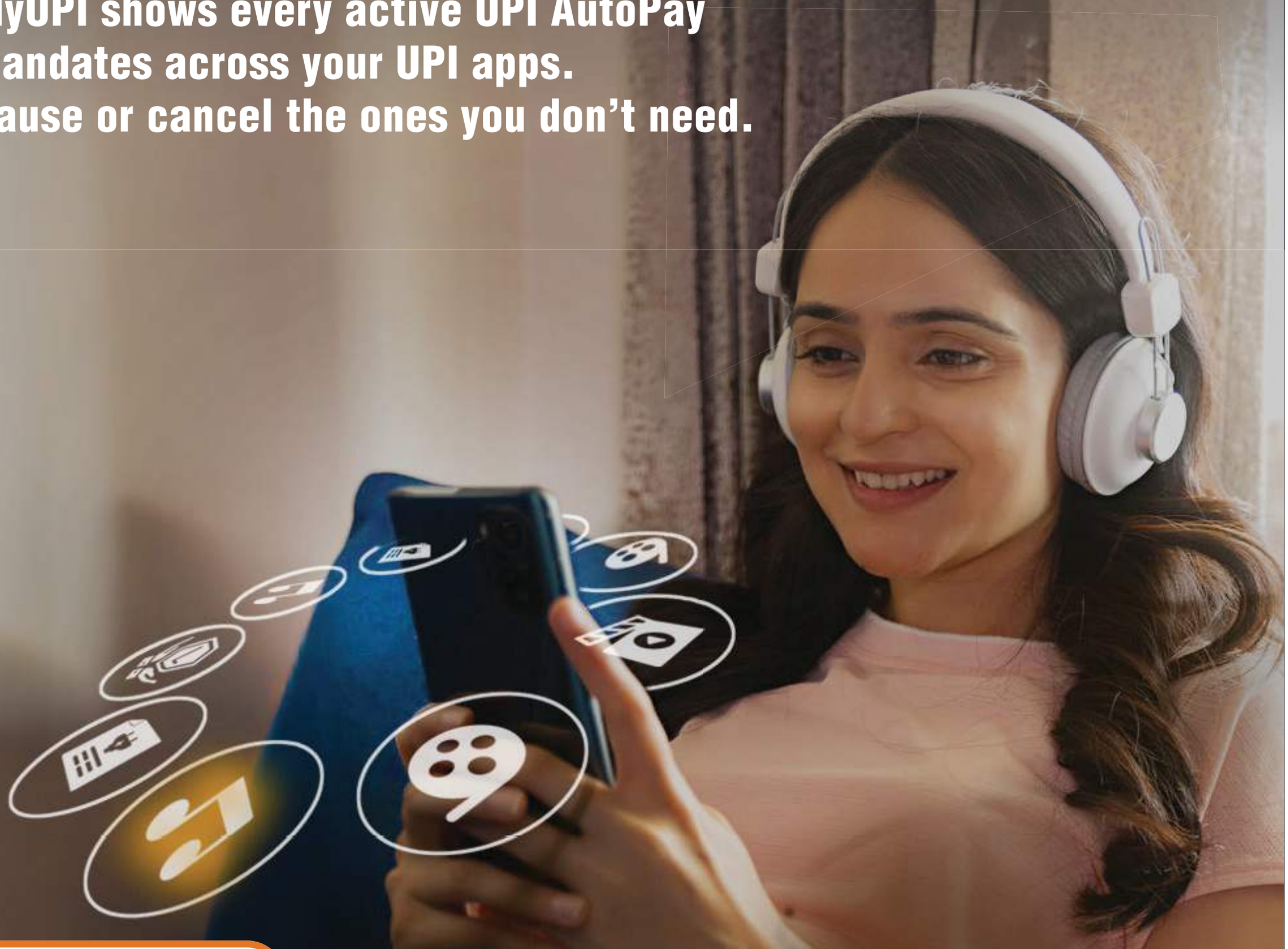

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PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-22185)
GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office : Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003
Telangana, India CIN : U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD - MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of Spares of Bottom Ash Hopper Feed Gate and Jet Pump which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 222/GATP/MMD/AHP/20018365**
"Procurement of Spares of Bottom Ash Hopper Feed Gate and Jet Pump which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP). Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02/11/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note : Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
GATP-116/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16728

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE No. 28 UBL 2026-27, Date: 29.10.2026
The undersigned, on behalf of the President of India, Invites E-Tenders (IREPS) for the following works:

Sl.	Description of work	Approx Value
1	**Hubballi Division: Bannihatti-Ranjitpura (BNHT-RNJP):** Protection of vulnerable cutting slope from boulder falling and soil erosion by Truf reinforcement mat and Boulder netting.	Rs. 6,41,52,136.00
2	**Hubballi Division: Hubballi-Gadag (UBL-GDG) Section:** Rebuilding of Bridge No. 14(DN Line) with Precast RCC Segmental Boxes by RH girder / cut and cover method in between Annigeri-Hulkoti (NGR-LKT) Stations.	Rs. 55,05,180.00
3	**Hubballi Division:** Proposed Track Machine sidings at 05 stations Harlapur (RLP), Talakal (TLKL), Ranjitpura (RNJP), Yeshwantnagar (YTG) and Rayadurga (RDG).	Rs. 2,72,83,434.00
4	**Hubballi Division: Hubballi-Bellary (UBL-BAY) Section:** Improvements (Drain, Speed humps, Cath Water Drain etc.) of RUB's No. 198A, between Hospete-Kudatini Section.	Rs. 1,96,99,796.00

Last date for submission of bids: **Upto 11:00 Hrs. on 25.11.2026**
For details log on: www.ireps.gov.in
PUB/583/AAD/PRB/SWR/2026-27 **Senior Divisional Engineer/Co-Ordination/Hubballi**

Download the **RailOne** app for easy ticket booking, PNR status, and more railway services.
South Western Railway - SWR | SWRRLY | SWRAILWAYHQ | sw_railways

KARNATAKA STATE POLLUTION CONTROL BOARD

No. 49, "Parisara Bhavan", 1st to 5th Floor, Church Street, Bengaluru-560001, Karnataka, INDIA.
Ph: 25581383, 25589112, 25586520 Fax: 080-25586321
E-mail: ho@kspcb.gov.in Website: https://kspcb.karnataka.gov.in

NO.PCB/52/SEO/MINES/EPH/2026-27/3474 DATE: 31-10-2026

ENVIRONMENTAL PUBLIC HEARING NOTIFICATION

Sri. Bharath S. has proposed to undertake Quarrying of River Sand with a production capacity of 20,000 tonnes per annum in a total land area of 12.20 Acres of Government land at **Ordinary Sand Block-RSB-36in Krishna Riverbed at Adjacent to Sy. No. 61, Konchapalli Village Block-01, Devadurga Taluk, Raichur District.** This project proposal falls under Category B1, Activity 1(a)–"Mining of Minerals" as per the Environmental Impact Assessment Notification, 2006 and its amendments.

As per the Environment Impact Assessment Notification dated: 14.09.2006 and its Amendment dated: 01.12.2009, the project proponent has to obtain prior Environmental Clearance from the State Level Environment Impact Assessment Authority and is required to go through the process of Environmental Public Hearing. As per the Terms of Reference (ToR) letter No. SEIAA 176 MIN 2026 dated: 11.05.2026 issued by the SEIAA, Karnataka and request letter of the project proponent dated: 31.07.2026 and the Environmental Officer, Regional Office, Raichur letter dated: 09.10.2026 intimating the date, the Environmental Public Hearing is being conducted by the KSPCB.

The details of the project are as follows:

1. Name & Address of the Project Proponent: Sri. Bharath S. S/o Shivaramu K. P. Plot No. 211, BHEL, Ramco Layout, Vijayanagara District.

2. Location of the proposed Quarry Project: Ordinary Sand Block-RSB-36 in Krishna Riverbed at Adjacent to Sy. No. 61, Konchapalli Village Block-01, Devadurga Taluk, Raichur District.

3. Details of proposed Project: Proposed to undertake Quarrying of River Sand with a production capacity of 20,000 tonnes per annum in a total land area of 12.20 Acres of Government land.

4. Date, time and venue of Environmental Public Hearing. Date : 03.12.2026(Thursday), Time: 12:30 PM. Place: Near Aanemallesh wara Temple, Benakal Village, Devadurga Taluk, Raichur District.

5. Places of availability of project documents as per EIA Notification, which is kept open to public are: (a) Office of the Deputy Commissioner, Raichur District, Raichur. **(b)** Chief Executive Officer, Zilla Panchayat, Raichur District, Raichur. **(c)** District Industries Centre, Raichur District, Raichur. **(d)** Tahasildar Office, Devadurga Taluk, Raichur District. **(e)** Department of Mines & Geology, Raichur. **(f)** City Municipal Council, Devadurga, Raichur District. **(g)** Gram Panchayat Office, Dhondabali, Devadurga Taluk. **(h)** Office of the Zonal Office, Karnataka State Pollution Control Board, Vijayanagara. **(i)** Office of the Regional Office, Karnataka State Pollution Control Board, Raichur. **(j)** SEIAA Karnataka (Ecology and Environment), Department of Forest, Ecology and Environment, Government of Karnataka, Room No. 709, 7th Floor, 4th Gate, MS Building, Bengaluru – 560 001. **(k)** HELP DESK Karnataka State Pollution Control Board, Ground Floor, No. 49, Parisara Bhavana, Church Street, Bengaluru – 560 001

NOTE: Suggestions, views, comments and objections of interested bonafide residents, environmental groups and others located at project site and likely to be affected by the proposed project are invited within 30 days from the date of publication of this Notification to make oral/written/E-Mail suggestions to the Karnataka State Pollution Control Board/Chairman, Environmental Public Hearing Committee **(Deputy Commissioner, Raichur District, Raichur)**. Interested public can participate in the Public Hearing at the above place. **For details please visit our Website: https://kspcb.karnataka.gov.in/**

Sd/-
MEMBER SECRETARY, KSPCB

34001/1089/2627

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER ELECTRICAL CIRCLE (R&B) NIRMAN SOUDHA BHUBANESWAR

E-mail seec.bbsr2010@gmail.com

Bid Identification No.S.E.E.C (R&B) 38/2026-27
No 5177 /Date 29.10.2026/

The Superintending Engineer, Electrical Circle (R&B) Odisha, Bhubaneswar on behalf of the Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bids for E.I. works which are to be received through online bidding, double cover system as detailed in : https://tendersorissa.gov.in. The details of bid documents will be available in the above website from dt.07.11.2026 at 05.00 P.M. to dt.23.11.2026 up to 05.00 P.M. The bidders must possess compatible Digital Signature Certificate of Class II or III. Bids received online shall be opened dt.25.11.2026 at 11.30 A.M. in the Office of the Superintending Engineer, Electrical Circle (R&B) Odisha, Bhubaneswar. Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal **www.tendersorissa.gov.in.**

Addendum / Corrigendum, if required, will be available only in the Website.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
Electrical Circle (R&B) Odisha, BBSR
OIPR-34001/34006/1/26-27/0039

32001/1208/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER
ANUGOLA IRRIGATION CIRCLE, ANUGOLA, ODISHA, PIN-759143
email :aceangulirrigationcircle@gmail.com
Government of Odisha "e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE
Bid Identification No. ACEAIC- 06/2026-27

Sl. No.	Name of work	Tendered Amount	Class of Contractor	Period of completion	Date and Time of availability of bid document in the portal	Last date/time for receipt of bid in the portal	Name & Address of the Officer Inviting Bid
01	Flood Protection to Left bank of river Mankada from Shiva temple to Sasan Sahi of Pallahara under Pallahara Block.	Rs. 379.32 lakh	"A"	08 (Eight Calendar Months)	03.11.2026 at 10.00 AM	18.11.2026 up to 5.30 PM	Additional Chief Engineer, Anugola Irrigation Circle, Anugola
02	Renovation and Modernization of Mordang Minor, Ratakhandi Minor and Basantapur Minor in Gohira Right Canal System under Debagada Irrigation Division, Debagada.	Rs. 482.17 lakh	"A"	08 (Eight Calendar Months)	03.11.2026 at 10.00 AM	18.11.2026 up to 5.30 PM	

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement Portal **http://tendersodisha.gov.in**.
Any corrigendum/ addendum/cancellation will be displayed in the **Govt. Website only.**

Sd/-
Additional Chief Engineer,
Anugola Irrigation Circle, Anugola.
OIPR-32001/32081/1/26-27/0007

राजस्थान राज्य क्रीडा परिषद

सवाई मानसिंह स्टेडियम, जनपथ, जयपुर कार्यालय दूरभाष नं0 0141-2744283 फैक्स नं0 0141-2740568, ईमेल आईडी - rssciapur@gmail.com

क्रमांक :- एफ-8/ति.शा./ब.घो. 65(XI-4)/2024-25/RajKaj Ref. 25162790 दिनांक :- 27/10/2026

निविदा सूचना संख्या 39, 40 व 41/2026-27

राजस्थान राज्य क्रीडा परिषद, जयपुर की ओर से विद्याधर नगर स्टेडियम–जयपुर में ओलम्पिक साईज स्वीमिंग पूल के निर्माण कार्य, विद्याधर नगर स्टेडियम–जयपुर के उन्नयन/आधुनिकरण एवं विकास कार्य व डीडवाना में मल्टीपरपज इन्डोर हॉल का निर्माण कार्य हेतु राज्य/केन्द्र सरकार के संगठनों/विभागों में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से ई–प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाइन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा से संबंधित अन्य आवश्यक विवरण वेबसाईट **http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, https://shpp.rajasthan.gov.in** व **www.rssc.in** पर देखी जा सकती है। **UBN : RSC2627WLOB00051**

राज.संवाद/सी/26/12756 **सचिव**

कार्यालय नगर पालिका मण्डल नोहर जिला हनुमानगढ़ (राज.)

क्रमांक :– नपानो॰/नि॰शा॰/2026–27/5032 दिनांक :– 23.10.2026

ई–निविदा सूचना संख्या 08/2026–27

इस कार्यालय द्वारा निम्नांकित कार्यो हेतु सरकारी विभागों के अधिकृत संगठनों के एवं स्थानीय निकाय विभाग में उचित श्रेणी के पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में दिनांक 18.11.2026 को मध्याह्न पश्चात् तक ई–निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। इन निविदा विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाईट **www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** एवं **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखी जा सकती है तथा निविदा के प्रपत्रों को डाउनलोड किया जा सकता है, सशर्त निविदा मान्य नही हो। निविदा का अन्य विवरण निम्न प्रकार है :–

NIB No.:- DLB2627A9255
UBN No.:-DLB2627WSOB23378 & DLB2627WSOB23381
राज.संवाद/सी/26/12725 **अधिशाषी अधिकारी**

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-22185)
GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office : Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003
Telangana, India CIN : U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of APH BASKETS, which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 223/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018404**
"Procurement of APH BASKETS which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib" at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02/11/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
GATP-114/26, DPR/Pb.: 1079/12/2026-27/16726

Karnataka State Tourism Development Corporation Ltd.

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
Corporate Office: 5th Floor, Indhana Bhavana, Race Course Road, Bengaluru-09
Tel: 080-42775575 Fax: 080-42775589 website: www.kstdc.co
No:KSTDC/PROJECT/28/2026-27/1968 Date: 02.11.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

The Karnataka State Tourism Development Corporation Limited (KSTDC), Bengaluru, invites tenders from eligible and interested contractors for the execution of Repairs and Renovation works at Hotel Mayura Chalukya, Badami, Hotel Mayura Adilshahi and Annex Under Package-3 for Karnataka state Tourism Development Corporation. The details of the tender are as follows:

Tender No	Description	Last Date & Time for Bid Submission
KSTDC/ 2026-27/ BD/ WORK_ INDENT5	Selection of eligible and interested contractors for undertaking the Repairs and Renovation works at Hotel Mayura Chalukya, Badami, Hotel Mayura Adilshahi and Annex Under Package-3 for Karnataka state Tourism Development Corporation (KSTDC).	**30.11.2026 16:00 Hrs.**

The detailed tender documents are available in the website: **www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in** For any further clarifications contact 9240214000/01, Email: **support@eprochelpdesk.com**
Sd/- General Manager (Admin), KSTDC

MINERAL RESOURCES DEPARTMENT
DIRECTORATE OF GEOLOGY AND MINING, MADHYA PRADESH

29- A Khanij Bhawan, Arera Hills Bhopal
Phone and fax 0755-2551795, Email: geology.dgm@mp.gov.in

No-/Auction -21/ Geology /F. No.- 21/ 2026-27 October 30, 2026

Notice Inviting Tender

"Invitation of bids for grant of Mining Lease for Limestone, Basemetal (Zn).and Basemetal and associated minerals (Zn, Pb, Cu, Ag) minerals and for grant of Composite Licence for Basemetal (Zn), Manganese & Dolomite, Copper, and Basemetal associated minerals (Cu, Ag, & Au)"

In exercise of the powers conferred by Section 10B and Section 11 of the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 and in accordance with the Mineral (Auction) Rules, 2015 notified thereunder, as amended from time to time, the Government of Madhya Pradesh has identified:

a) 8 mineral blocks (6 blocks of Limestone, 1 block of Basemetal (Zn), and 1 block of Basemetal (Zn, Pb, Cu, Ag)) for Electronic Auction and hereby invites tenders for the purposes of grant of **Mining Lease.**
b) 4 mineral blocks (1 block of Basemetal (Zn), 1 block of Copper, 1 block of Manganese & Dolomite. and 1 block of Basemetal (Cu, Ag, & Au)) for Electronic Auction and hereby invites tenders for the purposes of grant of **Composite Licence.**

Accordingly, financial bids are invited in digital format only and technical bids are invited both in digital and physical format from eligible bidders.

Eligibility conditions, date and time, terms, and conditions etc. for participating in the electronic auction are provided in the Tender Document. Detailed Tender Documents along with timelines, notifications, updates and other details for the e-auction process for the mineral blocks are available in electronic form only and can be downloaded from the e-auction portal of MSTC Limited [https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mlcln/index.jsp].

Interested and eligible bidders can register themselves on the above e-auction portal. On successful registration, eligible bidders will obtain login ED and password necessary for participation in the e-auction process. Interested and eligible bidders can participate in the bidding only after online purchase of the Tender Document on payment of the Tender fee from the above e-auction portal. The Tender Fee shall be waived, for those mineral blocks only which have been put up for auction under "second attempt" as per Mineral Auction Rule vide this Notice Inviting Tender, for such bidders only who have previously purchased the Tender Document in prior auction attempts of the said mineral block. Any revision, clarifications, addendum, corrigendum, time extensions, etc. to the tender document will be hosted on the above e-auction portal only and no separate notifications shall be issued in the press. Model Tender Document and Mineral Block Summaries are available free of cost on the e-auction portal of MSTC Limited website [https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mlcln/index.jsp]

List of Mineral Blocks for Auction

S. No	Name of the Block	District	Mineral	ML/ CL	Price of Tender Document without GST* *(in Rs.)*
First Attempt Blocks					
1.	Muhrai-Hatta Limestone Block	Damoh	Limestone	ML	5,00,000
2.	Kesharpura-Nayagaon-Ghasundi-Chainpura Limestone Block	Neemuch	Limestone	ML	5,00,000
3.	Shitalpani Copper Block	Balaghat	Copper	CL	2,00,000
4.	Bhilapar Manganese & Dolomite Block#	Pandurna	Manganese & Dolomite	CL	25,000
Pre-Embedded Blocks					
5.	Gudha Limestone and Dolomite Block#	Damoh	Limestone	ML	25,000
6.	Muariya Basemetal (Zn, Pb, Cu, Ag) Block	Betul	Basemetal (Zn, Pb, Cu,Ag)	ML	5,00,000
Second Attempt Blocks					
7.	Ramsthan Limestone Block	Satna	Limestone	ML	1,00,000
8.	Kuiyan Barwah Limestone Block	Rewa	Limestone	ML	2,00,000
9.	Birwa Bhitwan Limestone Block	Rewa	Limestone	ML	2,00,000
10.	Biskhan Extended Basemetal (Zn) Block	Betul	Basemetal (Zn)	ML	5,00,000
11.	Salaiya Phatak Basemetal (Cu, Ag, & Au) Block	Katni	Basemetal (Cu, Ag, & Au)	CL	5,00,000
12.	Kehalpur (East) Basemetal (Zn) Block	Betul	Basemetal (Zn)	CL	2,00,000

Note: * GST shall be payable by reverse charge mechanism # Mineral Blocks being put up for auction in accordance with section 10A2D of the Act

Notwithstanding anything to the contrary in the Tender Document for the blocks being auctioned in accordance with **Section 10A(2)(d)** of the Act, the State Government makes no representation whatsoever, express, implicit or otherwise, regarding the accuracy and/ or completeness of the information provided in the said geological report and the Bidder confirms that it shall have no claim whatsoever against the State Government in this regard. The Bidder acknowledges and hereby accepts the risk of inadequacy, mistake or error in or relating to said geological report and hereby acknowledges and agrees that the State Government shall not be liable for the same in any manner whatsoever to the Bidder and their associates or any person claiming through or under any of them. The Bidders agree and acknowledge that any mistake or error in or relating to the said geological report shall not vitiate the tender process, Mining Lease and/ or MDPA, or render the same voidable.

The block specific Tender documents are available for purchase on the e-auction portal of MSTC Limited (https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mlcln/index.jsp] from **Monday, 2 November, 2026.** Last date for purchase of Tender Document, on the e-auction platform is **Friday, 20 November, 2026** The payment is to be remitted and received before 17:00 hours(IST) and the last date for submission of the bid is **Wednesday, 25 November, 2026,** on or before 17:00 hours (IST).

Bidders may note that for composite licences, the Mineral (Auction) Amendment Rules, 2022 have dispensed with the requirement of indicating the division of the land into forest land, land owned by the State Government, and land not owned by the State Government and the requirement of demarcating the area using total station and differential global positioning system and has provided the flexibility of demarcating the concession area using global positioning system. However, the requisite demarcation in respect of certain blocks is nevertheless being provided [as and where available] as part of the information memorandum. Thus, the terms and conditions for auction of the said block remain unchanged.

Head of Office
Superintending
Geologist Directorate of Geology and Mining Madhya Pradesh

G-20902/26

"पॉक्सो है सुरक्षा का हथियार, बच्चों पर न करें अत्याचार"

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-22185)
GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office : Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003
Telangana, India CIN : U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-Chemistry, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 220/GATP/Chemistry/20018435 dated 02/11/2026**
"Procurement of Non-Ferric Alum required at GATP Site"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP). Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02/11/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note : Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
GATP-112/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16717

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website : www.pspcl.in

Office of the Superintending Engineer, DS Circle, PSPCL, Patiala, 66 KV Grid Sub Station Colony, DCW Road, Patiala -147001 (Punjab), 96461-01201, 96461-10963
E-mail : circlepatiala1@gmail.com

Tender Enquiry No. 41/SE/DS Circle, Patiala/2026-27 Dated : 02.11.2026

Superintending Engineer/DS Circle, PSPCL Patiala invites e-tender for Outsourcing of Labour Part for Erection, Testing & Commissioning of New 11KVLT/HTLines on Rail/PCC Poles, Distribution T/Fs, Augmentation/Sagging of ACSR of HT/LT Lines, Cables laying, Guarding, Stay Setfor Various Works such as Releasing of T/Well Connections, GSC/ISC Connections, Deloading of Overloaded T/Fs, Shifting of Meters Outside Consumer Premises, Preventive maintenance of HT/LT lines not involving conductor replacement or insertion of extra poles Earthing of DTs/Lines or any Development Works under DS Division Nabha under DS Circle Patiala for F.Y. 2027-28.

For detailed NIT and Tender Specifications please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02.11.2026, 06:00 PM onwards.

NOTE : Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in

C1043/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16721

KARNATAKA NEERAVARI NIGAM LIMITED

(A Government of Karnataka Enterprise)
Executive Engineer, KNNL, MRBCC Division No-3, Byahatti.
Tq: Hubli, Dist: Dharwad Pin- 580023 Phone: 0836-2315225 Fax:-2315226.
e-mail :- knnl@knnlindia.com e-mail :-eemrbcc3byt@gmail.com
Website:- www.knnlindia.com

No:KNNL/MRBCC-3/AE-1/KPPP-tender/2026-27/1397
Date:02/11/2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION 3rd Call

(Through KPPP- procurement only)

Tender are invited on behalf of the Managing Director, KNNL, Bangalore, by the Executive Engineer, KNNL,MRBCC No.3 Division, Byahatti from Eligible contractor for one work coming under Head of Account 4701 M& MI in Two cover system. The tenderer are required to submit tender only through KPPP-procurement portal of Govt of Karnataka

Work Indent No : KNNL/2025-26/LI/WORK_INDENT4153/ CALL-3 (Turnkey Basis Tender)
Estimated Amount of work : Rs. 1000.00 Lakhs
EMD Amount : Rs. 11.82 Lakhs

Last date & time for receipt of e- tenders through KPPP- portal is **on 02-12-2026 upto 4.00 pm**. Date of opening of tender i.e., (Technical bid, cover-I) is on **04-12-2026 at morning 11.00 am**. and Pre bid Meeting **Dtd:16-11-2026 at morning 11.00 am** onwards in the office of **Managing Director KNNL, 4th Floor, Coffee Board Building, No.1 Dr. Ambedkar Veedhi Bangaluru.** For more details visit KPPP-procurement portal website at **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** OR Undersigned in all working days during office hours on **telephone no-0836-2315225.**

DIPR/Dharwad/ 700/Manipal/2026-27
Sd/- Executive Engineer
KNNL MRBCC Div No.3 Byahatti

KARNATAKA HOUSING BOARD

3rd Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, Bengaluru.

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Karnataka Housing Board invite tender from the eligible Pre qualified contractors & willing to Pre qualify in Karnataka Housing Board through KPP portal for below mentioned work.

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Work Indent & IFT No.	Amount put to tender (in Rs.)	Last date of submission of bid
1.	Annual Maintenance of 2 MLD and 0.25 MLD STP at Suryanagara Phase-1, Anekal, Bengaluru for the year 2026-27.	Tender Reference No. KHB/ 2026-27/OW/ WORK_INDENT 818 & IFT No. 85/2026-27, Date: 31.10.2026	88,08,231/-	**16.11.2026 Upto 4.00 PM**
2.	Annual Maintenance of 4.00 MLD in Block-III in Sector-A, 3.00 MLD in Block-V in Sector-B and 2.00 MLD in Block-IX in Sector-C STP at Suryanagara Phase-II, Anekal Taluk, Bengaluru for the year 2026-27.	Tender Reference No. KHB/ 2026-27/OW/ WORK_INDENT 819 & IFT No. 86/2026-27, Date: 31.10.2026	1,35,90,014/-	

For further information, contact below mentioned Office Address:
Executive Engineer, Karnataka Housing Board, Head Office, Cauvery Bhavan, Bengaluru.
Telephone No.: 080-22273511 / 080-22100077. Website: https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in

DIPR/CP/HT/3486/2026-27 **Sd/- Executive Engineer, KHB, Head Office, Bengaluru**

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 & 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar,
Bengaluru - 560009. Phone No. 080-22265383 website:www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-44/3847/2026-27 Date:02.11.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER

(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

Item Rate Tender under two cover bid system is invited for the works mentioned below as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Class-III & above (Civil) issued by KPWD Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, state of the art technology, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the following work as per the schedule given below:

Name of the work: Jungle Clearing, Shoulder Maintenance & Pot Hole Filling at Harohalli Industrial Area 1st & 2nd Phase, Harohalli Taluk, Bengaluru South District. (SC Category)

- Last Date and Time for Receipt of Tenders: **19.11.2026** upto **4:00** pm.

Applicants May download bidding documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**

DIPR/CP/3488/CCL/2026-27 **Sd/- Engineer-In-Chief**

TUMAKURU MACHINE TOOL PARK

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar,
Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. TMPT/ENGG/ETND-EP-01/1955/2026-27 Date: 02.11.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER

(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

EPC Tender under two cover bid system is invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the work of :

Name of the Work: Design, Build and Commissioning of 1 MLD capacity civil units in two modules and EMI for 0.50 MLD for handling Sewage and Industrial Effluents as alternative design on EPC basis including Operation & Maintenance of entire plant for a period of 05 years at Tumakuru Machine Tool Park, Vasanthanarasapura Industrial Area 3rd Phase, Tumakuru District.

The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **20.11.2026** upto **4.00 pm.**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.**

DIPR/CP/3487/SMCL/2026-27 **Sd/- Chief Technical Officer, TMTP**

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-22185)
GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office : Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003
Telangana, India CIN : U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD C&I, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

1 **Tender Enquiry No. 224/GATP/IMD/BTG/20018429 dated 02/11/2026**
"Procurement of Modules for Max DNA DCS System at GATP, GOINDWAL SAHIB." Area of 2 x 270 MW Thermal Power Plant GATP, Goindwal Sahib at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02/11/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
GATP-111/26, DPR/Pb.: 1079/12/2026-27/16716

Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited

A Govt. of India (Ministry of Railways) Enterprise

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)
(E-Tendering via GeM Portal)

Bid No.: GEM/2026/B/8216851 **Dated:** 29.10.2026, Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited (DFCCIL) invites Open E-Bids (Two Packet System) on the Government e-Marketplace (GeM Portal) from IRDAI-registered General Insurance Companies for the following service: **1. Name of Work:** Procurement of Insurance Policies (Property All Risk, Electronic Equipment Insurance, Portable Equipment Insurance, Commercial General Liability, Commercial Crime, and D&O Liability) for DFCCIL Assets and Liabilities for FY 2026–27. **2. Mode of Bidding:** Custom Bid on GeM Portal **(https://gem.gov.in) 3. Contract Period:** 1 Year. **4. Bid Submission End Date & Time:** 07.12.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. **5. Technical Bid Opening Date & Time:** 08.12.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. Interested bidders may view and download the complete Bid Document and Scope of Work from the GeM Portal (Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8216851) or from the DFCCIL website **(www.dfccil.com).** Bids must be submitted strictly online through the GeM portal. Any corrigendum/addendum shall be published only on GeM and DFCCIL websites.

Executive Director/ Procurement & Contract
For & on behalf of DFCCIL / Noida

REVENUE COMMISSIONERATE, REVENUE DEPARTMENT

BHOOMI MONITORING CELL

1st floor SSLR Building, K.R. Circle, Bengaluru-560001.
E-mail: bhoomi.bmc01@gmail.com Phone: 080-22113255

No: BMC/2026-27/IND0037 Date: 02.11.2026

E-TENDER NOTIFICATION

Tender is invited for procurement of 300 sets of "IT Infrastructure for Revenue Courts", Revenue Department, Karnataka. The last date for uploading filled tender form in e-procurement portal is **16-11-2026 by 5.28 PM**. Details regarding terms and conditions are available at **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**

Sd/- Assistant Commissioner,
DIPR/CP/DISHA/3484/2026-27 **Bhoomi Monitoring Cell, Revenue Department.**

Office of the Director of Printing, Stationery Publications

R.V College Post, 8th Mile, Mysore Road, Bengaluru - 560059

Notification No.DPS/PURB/TDRC/02/2026-PUR/Artboard & Artpaper Dated:30.10.2026

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION

(through e-procurement)

Online Tenders are invited for the **Supply of Art Board & Art Printing Paper** Under rate contract. Traders/Tenderers Situated shall be of Karnataka and from the States sharing border with Karnataka. Whereas Manufacturers are allowed from across the Country & Limiting to India. Estimated total value of the Tender is about Rs. 114.94 lakhs & total EMD prescribed is Rs. 5.75 Lakhs. Pre-bid Meeting shall be on Date:**11-11-2026, 11.30 AM** & Last date for Submission of Tender on **18-11-2026, 17.30 hrs.** For details please visit Website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** For any further clarifications the above office may be contacted.

Sd/-
DIPR/CP/3476/CCL/2026-27 **Director (I/c)**

High and dry in Meghalaya, home to wettest place on earth

State Worst Hit As NE Logs Rainfall Deficits

Manosh Das | TNN

Shillong: Meghalaya, home to "wettest place on earth" Cherrapunji, Mawsynram and other spots known for some of the highest rainfalls, is grappling with a severe dry spell, leading Northeast's widening downpour deficit this season.

The region's post-monsoon dry spell deepened in Oct, with all seven states recording rainfall deficits. Four faced shortfalls of at least two-thirds their normal. According to IMD, Meghalaya was the worst affected, with an 85% deficit, followed by Arunachal Pradesh and Tripura, both of which recorded a 74% shortfall.

IMD classifies rainfall deficits of 20% to 59% as "deficient" and those of 60% to 99% as "large deficient". Four of the seven states — Meghalaya, Arunachal Pradesh, Tripura and Manipur — were in the large-deficient category, while the remaining three were classified as deficient.

Meghalaya's situation was particularly worrying. The state received only 38.3 mm of rainfall in Oct, against its monthly normal of around 255 mm. It recorded a 60% deficit between June and Sept, receiving 1,077.1 mm of rain against the normal of 2,695.3 mm during the Southwest Monsoon season. The highest deficits were recorded in East Jaintia Hills and North Garo Hills, at 92% each, followed by East Khasi Hills -- home to Cherrapunji -- at 91%, West Garo Hills at 86%, South West Khasi Hills and West Khasi Hills at 84% each, East Garo Hills at 81% and West Jaintia Hills at 80%.

CM Conrad K Sangma described the situation as an "existential crisis". "Climate change is no longer a future challenge. It is our present reality. While forecasts may change, preparedness cannot wait. We must strengthen our resilience through sustainable solutions like natural farming, water conservation, spring rejuvenation and community-led action," Sangma said. Several Jal Jeevan Mission projects in the state are facing water-supply shortages because of drying catchment areas and other natural water sources. Govt has identified 785 critical water sources for rejuvenation and mapped 55,000 springs for revival.

ANI

UNDER MURASU'S SPELL: Fishing boats float in rough seas near rocky shores as Cyclone Murasu approaches the Andhra Pradesh coast, in Visakhapatnam on Monday. The severe cyclonic storm is expected to cross the Andhra coast between Nellore and Narasapur on Monday night, and the landfall is expected to stretch until 4am on Nov 3, the IMD said. Under the influence of Murasu, the department forecast light to moderate rain or thundershowers across several places in the state

Karnataka sends 500 powermen, equipment to restore power in AP

Niranjan.Kaggere@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Karnataka has extended assistance to Andhra Pradesh to restore electricity infrastructure damaged by Cyclone Arnab, deploying 500 skilled powermen and specialised equipment to expedite the restoration of power supply in the affected areas.

Following a request from the neighbouring Andhra Pradesh govt for manpower and equipment to repair the damaged power infrastructure, Karnataka govt responded positively and mobilised personnel and machinery under the supervision of Energy minister KJ George. Sources in the energy department said chief minister DK Shivakumar spoke to Andhra Pradesh CM Chandrababu Naidu on the phone and assured him of Karnataka's full support during the crisis. "Electricity is an essential service, and restoring it quickly is critical for the well-being of people affected by the disaster. Karnataka stands firmly with the people of Andhra Pradesh in this challenging time," the CM said.

Energy minister KJ George said Karnataka would coordinate closely with officials in Andhra Pradesh to ensure that power supply is restored at the earliest. "We will work closely with electricity department officials in Andhra Pradesh, ensuring effective field-level coordination and the use of advanced equipment to resume power supply at the earliest," he said.

BJP, oppn in Odisha spar over min's 'piggyback ride' on PSO

Bhubaneswar: A purported video showing Odisha's panchayati raj minister Rabi Narayan Naik riding piggyback on his personal security officer (PSO) while visiting a flood-affected area in Kandhamal district has triggered a political storm, **reports Ashok Pradhan**. The video, shared on social media by BJD Rajya Sabha member Sulata Deo on Sunday, purportedly shows Naik riding on the back of a man on a slippery road as around 20 people accompany them.

BJD spokesperson Lenin Mohanty described the visuals as "astonishing and deeply disturbing", saying they raised a question mark about human dignity and the treatment of security personnel. Deo termed the video "disgusting" and "unacceptable in a civilised world", alleging that it reflected the "arrogance" of ruling party politicians. Odisha Congress president Bhakta Charan Das said, "The incident reflects the insensitivity of those in power. At a time when people in Ganjam, Gajapati and Kandhamal are facing immense hardship due to floods and landslides, such conduct has deeply hurt people across the state."

कार्यालय नगर पालिका परिषद, नैनीताला

E-mail: -nppnainital@gmail.com (दूरभाष 05042-235153)

पत्रांक- 1233/xv-18 — **ई-निविदा सूचना** — दिनांक :-31 Oct 2026

सर्वसाधारण / इच्छुक फर्म/व्यक्ति को सूचित किया जाता है कि नगर पालिका परिषद, नैनीताल सीमान्तर्गत निम्न कार्य की (दिनांक 01 दिसम्बर 2026 से 30 नवम्बर 2027 तक 01 वर्ष हेतु) निम्नानुसार ई-निविदा अमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा में प्रतिभाग करने हेतु **www.uktenders.gov.in** पर नियम व शर्तें देखी एवं अपलोड की जा सकती है।

क्रमांक	कार्य का विवरण	ई-निविदा संख्या	पोर्टल विवरण
01	नगर पालिका परिषद, नैनीताल अन्तर्गत समस्त 15 वार्डों में डोर टू डोर कूड़ा एकत्रीकरण, स्थानीय परिवहन एवं हल्द्वानी ट्रचिंग ग्राउण्ड तक कूडा परिवहन ठेका वर्ष दिनांक 01 दिसम्बर 2026 से 30 नवम्बर 2027 तक 01 वर्ष हेतु)	2026_NPNTL_101926_1	www.uktenders.gov.in

संशोधन सूचना/ CORRIGENDOM

01	पोर्टल पर निविदा दस्तावेजों की अंतिम तिथि स्थान 08.11.2026 की सायं 05:00 बजे अंकित है।	इसके पोर्टल पर निविदा दस्तावेजों की अंतिम तिथि 09.11.2026 की प्रात: 11:00 बजे तक है, पढ़ा व समझा जाय।
02	तकनीकि प्रपत्र संलग्न पैरा के क्रमांक 03 एवं तकनीकि निविदा के पैरा 05 पर अकित शर्त जिसमें जी0ए0एस0टी पंजीकरण (उत्तराखण्ड) दर्शाया गया है।	इसके स्थान पर जी0एस0टी0 पंजीकरण प्रमाण पत्र स्व प्रमाणित छायाप्रति संलग्न करना, पढ़ा व समझा जाय।

अत: इच्छुक फर्म/व्यक्ति / निविदादाता ऑनलाईन निविदा मे प्रतिभाग कर सकते हैं। जो कि निविदा फॉर्म में उल्लेखित विवरण के अनुसार शासन द्वारा गठित कमेटी के समक्ष निविदादाताओं की उपस्थिति में खोले जाऐंगे। तकनीकि निविदा खोले जाने के उपरान्त ही वित्तीय निविदा खोली जायेगी तथा तकनीकि निविदा में सफल हुए निविदादाताओं की ही वित्तीय निविदा खोली जायेगी। किसी भी निविदा को, स्वीकृत / अस्वीकृत करने का पूर्ण अधिकार अधोहस्ताक्षरिओं के पास सुरक्षित होगा।

अध्यक्ष, नगर पालिका परिषद, नैनीताल

अधिशासी अधिकारी, नगर पालिका परिषद, नैनीताल।

No decision on Siang dam, CM says as 36-hr bandh hits Arunachal

Kangkan.Kalita1
@timesofindia.com

Guwahati: The standoff over Arunachal Pradesh's proposed 11,200 MW Siang dam intensified Monday as a 36-hour bandh paralysed Upper Siang district, with protesters demanding the release of around 40 arrested people and withdrawal of CAPF personnel. CM Pema Khandu sought to defuse tensions, assuring the Adi community that no construction decision had been taken, either by the Centre or state govt.

"We are not talking about dam construction at this stage. I assure each and every one of you that no decision has been made regarding construction of the Siang UMP," Khandu said, promising that the project would not proceed without extensive public consultations and consent, as required by land acquisition and environmental laws.

He said govt was considering preparation of a pre-feasibility report to assess viability and alternatives, not approving construction. Khandu described his assurance as a "binding personal commitment" to residents of Siang and Upper Siang districts, the Adi community and people of Arunachal.

Citing China's 60,000 MW hydropower project on the Yarlung Tsangpo, the CM said the proposed study was necessary to assess water-security risks. Around 65% of the Siang's water originates in China, he said, warning of possible sudden surges and winter shortages.

Centre notifies three new FRROs

New Delhi: The Centre has notified three new foreigners regional registration offices (FRROs) — in Bhubaneswar, Kohima and Agartala – taking the total number of such offices in the country to 20.

Stating that the number of foreign visitors arriving for tourism, medical and educational purposes has witnessed a substantial rise, the home ministry, in a statement, said there is need to appoint FRROs in each state. "This will ensure service accessibility, enhance regulatory compliance and promote India as an attractive destination," it said. TNN

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that my client intends to purchase the immovable properties more fully described in the Schedule hereunder ("Schedule Property") from the persons mentioned below (hereinafter referred to as "Owners").The Owners have represented that they are the absolute owners of their respective portions of the Schedule Property and that the same is free from all encumbrances, mortgages, charges, liens, claims, litigations, acquisitions, attachments, and any other third-party rights or interests whatsoever. The Owners have further represented that they have not entered into any Agreement, Memorandum of Understanding, deed, arrangement, commitment, or any other instrument relating to the transfer, alienation, or creation of any right, title, or interest in respect of the Schedule Property. Any person(s) having any claim, objection, right, title, interest, demand, or concern whatsoever in respect of the Schedule Property or any part thereof, whether by way of sale, agreement to sell, gift, conveyance, acquisition, partition, exchange, mortgage, charge, lien, pledge, lease, tenancy, easement, inheritance, succession, trust, attachment, court order, decree, or otherwise, shall lodge such claim(s), objection(s), or demand(s) in writing with the undersigned, together with supporting documentary evidence, **within Fifteen (15) days** from the date of publication of this Notice. Failing receipt of any such claim, objection, or demand within the aforesaid period, my client shall proceed with the proposed transaction in respect of the Schedule Property, relying upon the representations of the Owners, and any claim(s), objection(s), or demand(s) received thereafter shall be deemed to have been waived and/or abandoned for the purpose of the proposed transaction.

SCHEDULE

All that piece and parcel of the below mentioned agricultural dry lands situated at **Bellihalli Village, Yelahanka Hobli, Yelahanka Taluk, Bengaluru Urban District:**

Sl. No.	Name of the Owners	Survey No.	Extent in Acres & Guntas	East by	West by	North by	South by
1.	**Smt. Najma Begum**, Wife of Late Syed Gulzar Ali	8	01-23	Land in Survey No. 13	Land in Survey No. 68	Meetaganahalli Village Border	Land in Survey No. 7.
2.	**Sri. Syed Manzoor Ali**, Son of Late Syed Gulzar Ali						
3.	**Sri. Mansoor Ali**, Son of Late Syed Gulzar Ali						
4.	**Smt. Adiba Noorani Fathima**, Daughter of Late Syed Gulzar Ali	9	05-13	Land in Survey No. 13	Land in Survey No. 8	Meetaganahalli Village Border	Land in Survey No. 7 and 10
5.	**Smt. Naseema Afroza Fathima**, Daughter of Late Syed Gulzar Ali						

Vinay K. S., Advocate,
Vinay Kademane & Associates
307, 3rd Floor, Prestige Centre Point, No.7/49, Edward Road, Bengaluru-560001
Ph.: 080 22863885/49763233 Email: vinay@vinaykademane.in

Place : Bengaluru
Date : 02-11-2026

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY

The undersigned, on behalf of the President of India, Invites E-Tenders for the following work:

E-Tender Notice No. HE-TRD-2025-26-OT-41-2 Dated: 28.10.2026

Description of work	Approx. Value
OHE Modification for Provision of Short Shunting neck at Castle Rock (CLR) Yard at Vasco-da-Gama (VSG) End.	Rs. 57,82,969.30

Last date for submission of bids for Tender: **Upto 15:00 Hrs. on 23.11.2026**

E-Tender Notice No. HE-TRD-2025-26-OT-27-4 Dated: 28.10.2026

Description of work	Approx. Value
OHE Modification for provision of 1 additional loop line at Ginigera (GIN) Station.	Rs. 1,18,39,957.40

Last date for submission of bids for Tender: **Upto 15:00 Hrs. on 23.11.2026**

For details log on: www.ireps.gov.in

Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer / Traction Distribution / Hubballi

PUB/578/AAMO/PRB/SWR/2026-27

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South Western Railway - SWR | SWRRLY | SWRAILWAYHQ | sw_railways

श्री चित्रा तिरुनाल आयुर्विज्ञान और प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान, त्रिवेंद्रम केरल- 695 011, भारत

SREE CHITRA TIRUNAL INSTITUTE FOR MEDICAL SCIENCES AND TECHNOLOGY, TRIVANDRUM, KERALA – 695 011, INDIA
(एक राष्ट्रीय महत्व का संस्थान, विज्ञान एवं प्रौद्योगिकी विभाग, भारत सरकार)
(An Institution of National Importance, Department of Science and Technology, Govt. of India)

No.DAA/SCTIMST/Admission (January 2027)/2026 Dated: 03.11.2026

ADMISSION NOTICE FOR ACADEMIC SESSION – JANUARY 2027

Applications are invited for admission to
1. Postdoctoral Fellowship in Bioastronautics
2. PDCC in Transfusion Transmitted Disease Testing

Apply online. Please visit our website for more details **(www.sctimst.ac.in)**. PDF in other programs are also available. Online application will be available from **01.09.2026 to 30.11.2026.** Reservation will be followed as per Govt. of India policy. Application fee payable only through online. For more details contact: **Registrar, SCTIMST (email: regoffice@sctimst.ac.in), Tel: 0471 – 2524269/ 289/649.** Sd/- DIRECTOR

Government of India, Ministry of Railways

Railway Recruitment Boards (RRBs)

CENTRALISED EMPLOYMENT NOTIFICATION (CEN) No. 09/2026

Recruitment to various posts of Isolated Categories (Indicative Notice)

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for various posts of Isolated Categories. Applications, complete in all respects, must be submitted **THROUGH ONLINE MODE ONLY (https://www.rrbapply.gov.in).**

Opening date of Application : **05/11/2026** (Tentative)
Closing date for submission of Application : **04/12/2026 23:59 hours** (Tentative)

Name of the post	Pay Level as per 7th CPC	Medical Standard	Age (as on 01.01.2027)	Tentative Vacancies (All RRBs)
Various posts of Isolated	Level 2 to Level 7	As per Detailed CEN	As per Detailed CEN	195 (approx.)

Note:
1. Candidates are advised to verify their primary details using Aadhaar, during filling of online application, in order to avoid inconvenience and delays due to detailed scrutiny at every stage of recruitment process for Non-Aadhaar Verified applications.
2. In order to achieve successful verification using Aadhaar, Name and Date of Birth in Aadhaar shall be updated to match 100% with the Full Name and Date of Birth available in 10th class pass certificate. Similarly, Aadhaar needs to be updated with latest photo and latest biometrics (Fingerprint & Iris) before filling the online application.
3. This Notice is purely indicative in nature, issued solely for the purpose of keeping prospective candidates informed about the forthcoming detailed CEN and to be in readiness with necessary certificates or documents required for applying. It is also clarified that all terms, conditions, eligibility criteria, procedures, and other requirements governing the recruitment shall be strictly as per the detailed CEN No. 09/2026 (along with any corrigendum, which may be issued from time to time) that will be published exclusively on common website of all RRBs i.e. https://rrb.indianrailways.gov.in. Candidates can navigate to webpages of individual RRBs from this common website.

No.: RRB/GHY/Advt./CEN/09/2026
Date : 03/11/2026

Chairpersons
Railway Recruitment Board

"BEWARE OF TOUTS, BROKERS AND JOB RACKETEERS"

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website : www.pspcl.in
Contact No.: 96461-18773

TENDER ENQUIRY No.: QQ-1354/PO-C&S

Chief Purchase Officer/MM, Central Purchase Organization, PSPCL, 2nd floor, Multistorey Building, The Mall, Patiala, invites e-Tender for procurement of LINEMAN/ALM TOOL KITS (HAND TOOL & SAFETY TOOL KIT) as per tender specification no. QQ-1354/PO/C&S. For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 03.11.2026 (11.00 AM) onwards.

NOTE : Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C1046/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16730

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 96461-10021)

Tender Inquiry No. 27/Dy. CE/DS/Circle Sangrur/2026-27 | Date : 02.11.2026

Dy. CE, DS Circle, Sangrur invites e-tender for the execution of works comprising only labour component for execution of various works such as releasing of T/well connection, de-loading of overloaded T/Fs, bifurcation of feeders/Erection of new Links, releasing ISC/GSC Connections or any other development work to be executed on labour rates during the year 2027-28 Under DS Division PSPCL Dirba. For detailed NIT & tender Specification please refer to **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02.11.2026 from 12:00 PM onwards.

Note : Corrigendum and amendments, if any will be published online at **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C1040/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16715

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA, MINISTRY OF MINES
INDIAN BUREAU OF MINES

Nagpur, Maharashtra- 440001. Phone: 0712-2560041 Website: www.ibm.gov.in

T-45/5/2026-TS-IBM_HQ Date : 02/11/2026

EXTENSION OF THE LAST DATE FOR SUBMISSION OF APPLICATION FOR REGISTRATION AS MINERAL EXCHANGE

Indian Bureau of Mines (IBM) had invited sealed applications for the registration as Mineral Exchange from companies meeting the Eligibility Criteria under Rule-6 of the Mineral Exchange Rules, 2026. The last date for submission of application was **2nd November, 2026.** It is hereby notified that with the approval of Competent Authority, the last date for submission of application for registration as Mineral Exchange has been extended up to 1500 hrs on 17th December 2026. Further, **all the applicants are additionally requested to submit the soft copy of the entire application on email : merd@ibm.gov.in as well.** All other terms and conditions regarding the above mentioned "Notice Inviting Application" issued vide advertisement of even number dated **1/10/2026** shall remain unchanged. **Please visit www.ibm.gov.in for further details/updates.**

Sd
Controller of Mines,
Mineral Exchange Cell, IBM

Gujarat Sports Infrastructure Development Company Limited (GSID)

Place : GSID, Administrative Building, Sector-13/B, KH-3 Circle, Near Vavol Railway Crossing, Near EVM Ware House Office, Gandhinagar - 382016.

Tenders are invited by Gujarat Sports Infrastructure Development Company Limited (GSID) for 2 tender documents namely **"The Appointment of Project Management Consultancy (PMC) for Development of Karai Sports Academy" and for "Appointment of Project Management Consultancy (PMC) for Development of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Sports Enclave (Package 1 – Aquatics Arena & Site Infrastructure)"**. Last date for submission of Pre-bid queries is **Date : 08.11.2026, up to 18:00 hrs**. via email on **office.gsid@gmail.com** & last date for submission of bids along with Tender Fees and EMD by **07.12.2026 up to 17:00 hrs.**

The tender documents will be available on **02.11.2026** on the nProcure Portal.

General Manager - Planning & Coordination, GSID

Date : 03.11.2026

PFC CONSULTING LIMITED

(A wholly owned subsidiary of PFC Limited)
Regd. Office: First Floor, "Urjanidhi", 1, Barakhamba Lane, Connaught Place, New Delhi – 110001, (India) Fax : 011-23443990

GLOBAL INVITATION (THROUGH E-BIDDING ONLY)

FOR SELECTION OF TRANSMISSION SERVICE PROVIDER ON BUILD, OWN, OPERATE AND TRANSFER (BOOT) BASIS FOR INTER-STATE TRANSMISSION PROJECTS

PFC Consulting Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Power Finance Corporation Limited (A Government of India Undertaking), invites proposals for setting up of transmission projects on Build, Own, Operate and Transfer (BOOT) basis following single stage two envelope process of "Request for Proposal" (RFP).

Interested bidders may refer to the RFP notification and RFP documents available on the website **https://www.mstcecommerce.com** and **https://www.pfcclindia.com.**

The Bidders may obtain the RFP documents on all working days between 10:30 hrs (IST) and 16:00 hrs (IST) **from 03.11.2026 to one working day prior to bid submission for the projects mentioned below** on payment of a non-refundable fee of Rs. 5,00,000/- or USD 7,000 plus applicable GST @18% from 9th Floor, Wing – A, Statesman House, Connaught Place, New Delhi - 110001, Tel.: 91-11-23443912; Fax: 91-11-23443990; **e-mail: pfccl.itp@pfcindia.com.** The RFP documents can also be downloaded from **https://www.mstcecommerce.com** and **https://www.pfcclindia.com**, however, in such case, interested party can submit Response to RFP only on submission of non-refundable fee of Rs. 5,00,000/- or USD 7,000 plus applicable GST @18% separately. The survey report and clarification to RFP documents shall be issued to those bidders, who have obtained/ purchased RFP documents by paying requisite fee at least one working day prior to bid submission date. Bidders should regularly visit website to keep themselves updated regarding clarifications/ amendments/ time extensions etc., if any. The important timelines in this regard are as follows:

S. No.	Name of Transmission Scheme	Last Date for seeking clarifications (dd/mm/yyyy)	Last Date for submission of response to RFP (dd/mm/yyyy)	Date of opening of Response to RFP (dd/mm/yyyy)
1	CREATION OF 400/220 kV, 2x315 MVA S/S AT SIOT, JAMMU AND KASHMIR	10/11/2026	02/12/2026 up to 15:00 hrs (IST)	02/12/2026 up to 15:30 hrs (IST)

Note: PFC Consulting Limited reserves the right to cancel or modify the process without assigning any reason and without any liability. This is not an offer.

Bid Process Coordinator
PFC CONSULTING LTD.
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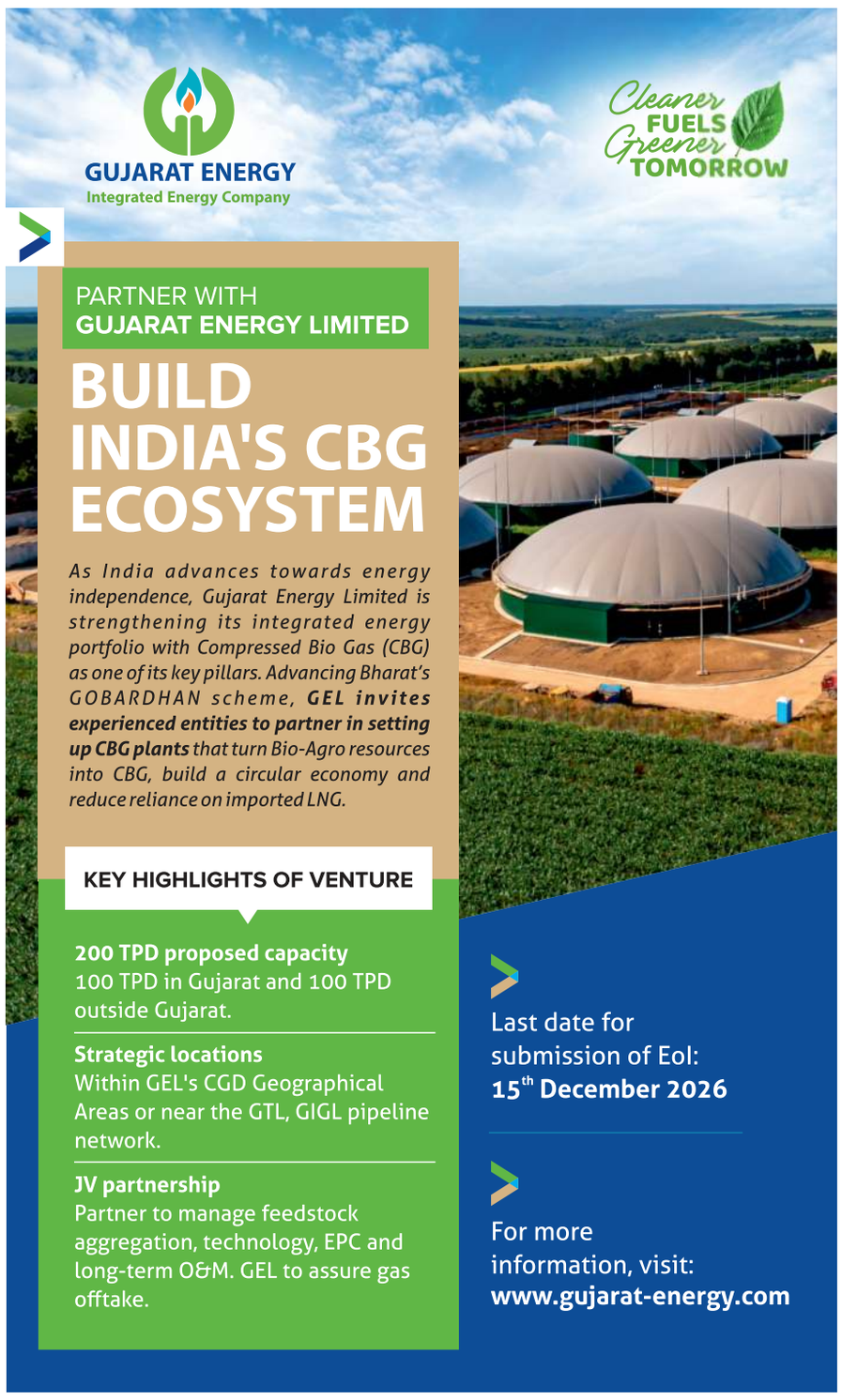
An Initiative of
Ministry of Power Government of India

Initiative Partner
Central Electricity Authority



Mehbooba accuses NC of widening Kashmir divide

Naseer.Ganai
@timesofindia.com

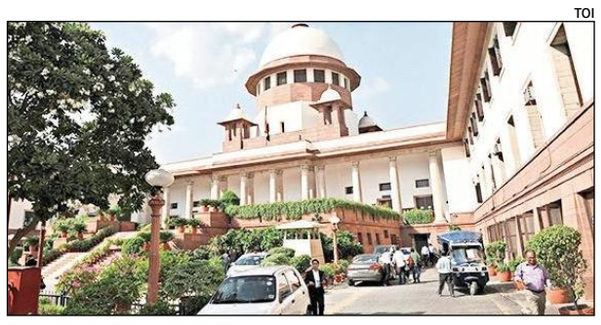
Srinagar: Days after National Conference president Farooq Abdullah made a controversial statement hailing Pakistan's diplomatic efforts on Kashmir, PDP chief Mehbooba Mufti Monday launched an attack on the NC leadership, accusing it of creating distrust between Kashmir and the rest of the country.

Addressing party workers in Srinagar on PDP's foundation day, she said: "NC's policies, dating back to the days of Sheikh Mohammad Abdullah, have created a wedge between Kashmir and the rest of the country. Unlike them, my father, Mufti Mohammad Sayeed, tried everything to bridge this gap. If there is any party that has betrayed Kashmiris, it is NC. As long as it remains in power, there will be no peace in Jammu & Kashmir."

EC can't monopolise voter awareness campaigns: SC

Gives Raj Poll Panel 48 Hrs To Reconsider Plea

TIMES NEWS NETWORK



TOI

BRINGING LEGAL CLARITY

New Delhi: Supreme Court on Monday said Election Commission did not have a monopoly over conducting 'voter awareness campaigns" while disapproving EC's refusal to permit a civil society group led by Aruna Roy from running a campaign to educate voters to choose representatives carefully and not barter their votes for bribes.

Setting aside Rajasthan State Election Commission's Oct 9 order refusing permission in this regard, a bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant, and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana gave 48 hours to the SEC to consider civil society's representation to run voter awareness campaigns for the final phase of zila parishad and panchayat samiti elections scheduled for Nov 14.

SEC, through advocate Amit Kuri, said permission was refused keeping in mind the imposition of prohibitory orders for maintenance of law and order situation before the elections to keep at bay unwanted and anti-social elements.

Roy's counsel Prashant Bhushan said it is a voter awareness campaign and not political activity and questioned the legitimacy of blanket imposition of prohibitory orders under Section 163 of BNSS to prohibit congregation for any political purpose.

The bench told SEC that EC conducting voter awareness programmes does not mean others are prohibited from doing similar exercises. "In the event they do or indulge in any corrupt practices, you are there to rectify it. But you cannot monopolise voter awareness campaigns. Everyone has a right to do so."

SC turned to Bhushan and said civil society cannot give a general application seeking permission to carry out voter awareness campaigns and said it must specify the place and time for conducting such exercise to the authorities concerned for permission.

SC issued notice to Rajasthan SEC, set aside its Oct 9 order refusing permission and directed it "to reconsider the petitioners' request for permitting them to conduct voter awareness campaign during the phase 3 of the Panchayati raj elections."

While the final phase of voting would end on Nov 14, the election of 'sarpanchs' and 'panchs' is scheduled for Nov 16. The three-phase elections covered 41 Zila Parishads, 457 panchayat samitis and 14,403 gram panchayats.

After resigning as MLAs, three AAP netas join BJP

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: A day after resigning as AAP MLAs in Punjab, three party members joined BJP here on Monday, coming as a boost to the latter in the state, where it is making an all-out push to emerge as a serious contender for power after languishing on the margins so far.

Chetan Singh Jouramajra, a former cabinet minister elected from Samana, former IPS officer Kunwar Vijay Pratap Singh, who won from Amritsar North and Harmeet Singh Pathanmajra, who represented Sanaur in the assembly, decried the "rising" gangsterism and drug abuse in the state and expressed confidence in BJP's ability to turn things around as they joined the party. BJP has combined the push to bolster its ranks, a strategy which fetched the party its highest-ever vote share of over 18% in Lok Sabha polls without translating into any seat, with an aggressive ground campaign, especially over the drug menace, to corner AAP and deepen its mass connect in Punjab where Congress is the main opposition party.

Punjab BJP president Kewal Singh Dhillon projected the exodus of AAP leaders as an indication of the party being a "sinking ship", while his party grows by the day.

In his remarks, Vijay Pratap Singh said, "Crime, drugs, corruption and gangsterism are rampant in Punjab. Bhagwant Mann and Arvind Kejriwal have completely uprooted and destroyed AAP, which was born from a revolutionary mindset."

Singh, who enjoyed a good image as a cop, had quit IPS to join AAP during the previous assembly polls.

Pathanmajra called upon voters in Punjab to rally behind BJP to pull the state out of the crisis brewing under the AAP govt.

'Visa doesn't mean foreigners have rights to enter India'

▶ Continued from page 1

Dhond said they were not getting into the legality of the constitutional rights but under Article 21—right to life and liberty available to non-citizens—principles of natural justice do accrue.

The CJ asked what **Khan** was doing at the protest site and how he was connected. "What were you there for? There is a complete difference between rights of an OCI card holder and a citizen of India. You will have to categorically make a statement that you have no association with the protest… you had no remote cause… If an Indian was doing this in another country, would it have been permissible or tolerated…?" the bench orally questioned.

Dhond said Khan's case is he has no affiliation with the protest organisers and was merely passing by and curious on seeing the protestors.

FRRO's counsel Singh, citing a compilation and judgments, argued that it was not an isolated instance and that Khan "instigated" people on social media. "It is a misleading statement that out of curiosity he went there to check… He is part of the protest," submitted Singh.

Khan has been in India since he was two years old, for the past 42 years, and should have been heard, said Dhond. Public Prosecutor Anjali Helekar pointed to the FIR against Khan. Dhond submitted that all offences are bailable and the actor was not summoned for any probe.

Singh said the actor is a US citizen and Centre is empowered to expel him. He argued, "It is the Centre's discretion. A visa too doesn't mean a foreigner has rights to enter India."

The bench remarked, "This case is purely distinguishable… He has on his OCI registration said he is unemployed." The judges said to Khan, "Why don't you accept India citizenship? You work and live here. You make films here. You are a celebrity. Why don't you apply for Indian citizenship… You have to give a categorical undertaking that you will not participate in any such protest as you are an OCI and these are not available to OCI card holders…"

EC officials wind up pre-poll reviews in 3 states

Bharti.Jain@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: Election Commission officials have completed review of poll preparedness and arrangements in three of the five states due for assembly elections early next year, and are likely to wind up their on-the-spot assessment visits to the remaining two states by Nov 20.

After these deputy election commissioner-level (DEC-level) visits conclude, the Election Commission will start visiting the poll-bound states — Goa, Manipur, Punjab, Uttarakhand and Uttar Pradesh — one by one to assess the poll preparedness at its level and hold the usual pre-election interactions with various stakeholders including the chief electoral officer concerned, administrative and police heads as well as the political parties.

"The schedule for the full commission's visits is likely to be finalised after Nov 20," an EC official told TOI on Monday.

While the official-level review visits and meetings with regard to Manipur, Uttarakhand and Punjab were conducted in the month of October, those for Uttar Pradesh and Goa are currently underway or likely soon.

Given that UP is a big state, it may take the officials 4-5 visits to complete the assessment of poll preparedness and conduct a thorough review of the arrangements and other logistics. On Monday, the EC team led by senior DEC Maneesh Garg toured Meerut and held review meetings with regard to 18 districts in the Meerut, Saharanpur, Moradabad and Aligarh divisions.

35 staffers skip BLO duty, UP withholds pay for absent days

Rahul.Singh1
@timesofindia.com

Meerut: The basic shiksha department in UP's Bulandshahr district has withheld salaries of 35 assistant teachers, shikshamitras and instructors for the days they allegedly remained absent from their assigned booth-level officer (BLO) duties during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, officials said on Monday.

The action followed complaints from tehsil officials about the employees' failure to report for their assigned election-related duties. District basic shiksha adhikari (BSA) Virendra Kumar Singh subsequently directed the department to withhold payment for the days of alleged absence.

"Thirty-five employees across different blocks had failed to discharge their SIR-related duties. Payment for the days they remained absent has been withheld until further orders. Their cases are being examined," Singh told TOI. He added, "The SIR exercise is an important democratic process and participation in electoral duties is a responsibility of govt employees, including teachers. Negligence will not be tolerated and those who fail to discharge their assigned duties will face strict action."

The action has brought the deployment of teachers for election-related work into focus., amid concerns over its impact on classroom teaching in govt schools across the state, many of which are already grappling with staff shortages.

"Shikshamitras and instructors earn around Rs 18,000-20,000 a month. Withholding their payment for the days they are alleged to have been absent from their assigned duties is unfair, particularly when they are being asked to shoulder responsibilities beyond their regular teaching work," a teacher said on the condition of anonymity.

The teacher added, "Govt schools are already struggling with staff shortages."

Rahul challenges Modi to debate over 'foreign help'

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Congress neta Rahul Gandhi on Monday lashed out at Prime Minister Narendra Modi for accusing the opposition of taking foreign help to destabilise the country. The leader of opposition in Lok Sabha challenged the PM to an open debate on the issue. "Mr Modi, stop lying to this nation. You became PM because of foreign help. You remain PM because of foreign help," Gandhi said in a post on X.

"Your financial system is fully controlled and supported by foreigners. Foreign social media fully backs you," he alleged. "I challenge you to an open debate about this. Any stage, any time. Come if you have the guts. You won't dare, because you are terrified of what I know about you," Gandhi claimed.

During his Gujarat visit on Saturday, Modi said, "When the country was seeking solutions to external challenges, some forces within the country were creating instability by spreading lies and rumours. But the countrymen stood shoulder to shoulder with the nation."

TIMES *Special*

Garibi hatao

SLOGAN TO REALITY IN 55 YRS

The 1971 slogan finally has numbers behind it: nearly 50 crore Indians crossed the poverty line in just 12 years, one of the fastest falls anywhere. Crossing a line, though, isn't the same as leaving poverty behind

For most of the first 50 years after Independence, the race to end poverty in India was mostly a race to stand still. The share of the poor in population kept falling, but the population grew faster, so the number of poor kept rising. At the $4.20-a-day line (see graphic 3 Lines, 3 Indias) it peaked at about 85 crore in 2004. 'Garibi hatao' was a slogan, but the numbers didn't follow it for over five decades.

What changed after 2009 was the actual number of poor people, not just their share, started falling first slowly and then steeply. According to the World Bank's latest 'Poverty & Equity Brief' on India, three forces worked together: 1. Households spent more. 2. More people, especially rural women, found work. 3. Welfare that once lost 85 paise of every rupee on the way began reaching bank accounts and ration cards.

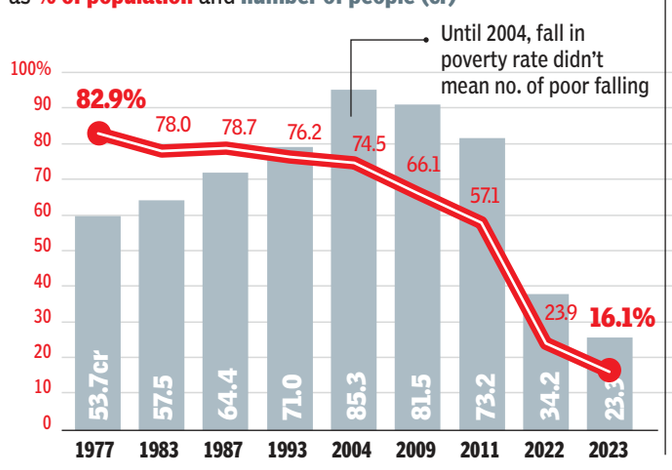
Few countries have moved this many people out of poverty this fast. This is a success that should rank alongside the Green Revolution and perseverance of democracy in the country.

But a poverty line is a line, not a destination. A family on purchasing power parity (PPP) adjusted $4.21 a day (roughly Rs 85 a day) is officially not poor, and in practice one hospital bill away from being poor again. Judging by the bar used for upper-middle-income countries, the club India wants to join, 80% Indians would still be officially poor. About 81 crore still get free foodgrain every day. More than half of those still poor live in one belt running from Uttar Pradesh to Bengal. The World Bank itself cautions that part of the recent fall may reflect better measurement, not only better lives. Then there is multidimensional poverty that measures 12 indicators across health, education and amenities to provide a complete picture of poverty. A little over 15% Indians are multidimensionally poor, though this poverty has been falling too.

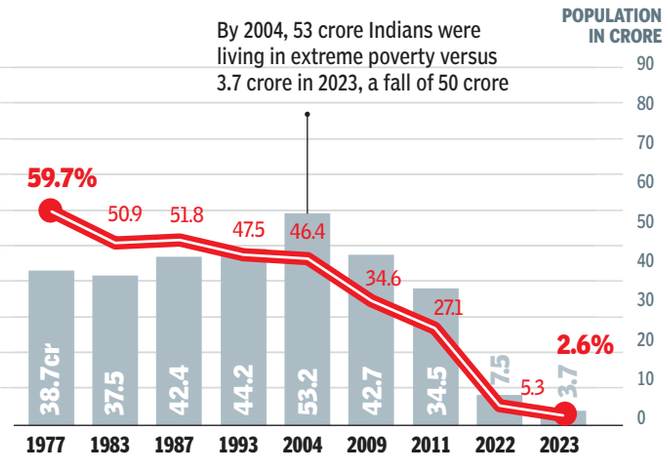
The challenge for the coming years is ensuring that the crores who have escaped the poverty trap don't merely hover above it, but find a clear, irreversible pathway to the true middle class.

1 IN THE PAST POVERTY RATE FELL, BUT NUMBER OF POOR GREW

Population below poverty line at **$4.2 a day** (1977-2023) as **% of population** and **number of people (cr)**



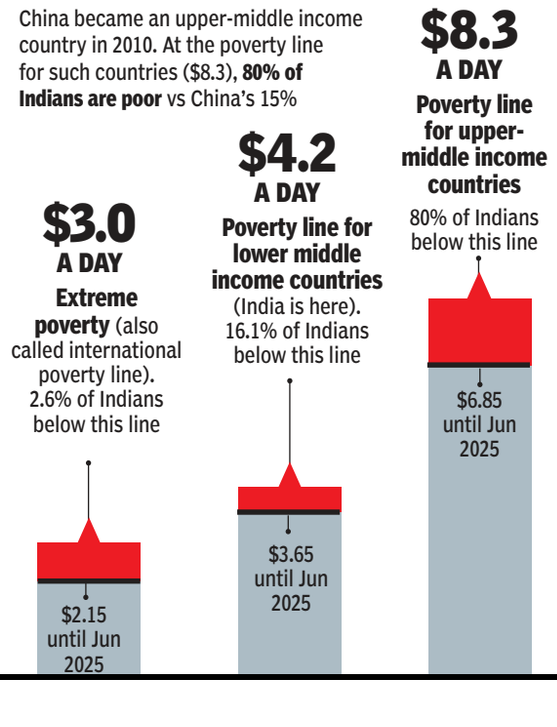
Population below poverty line at **$3.0 a day** (1977-2023)



2 3 LINES, 3 INDIAS

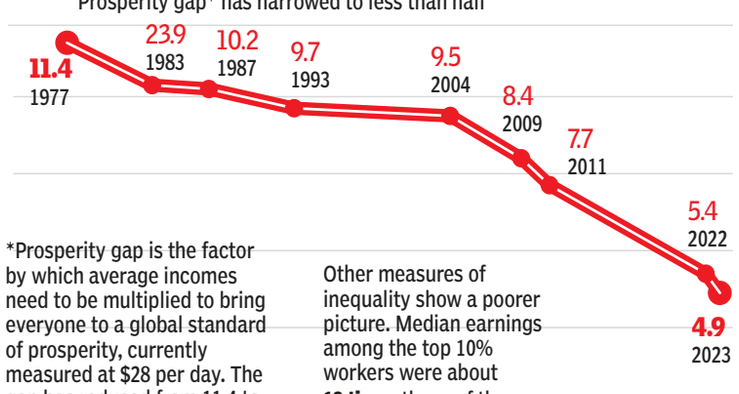
India ceased to be a low-income country in 2007-08, which is when its poverty measure moved up from international poverty line ($3) to one that applies to lower middle income countries ($4.2).

China became an upper-middle income country in 2010. At the poverty line for such countries ($8.3), **80% of Indians are poor** vs China's 15%



3 LESS POOR & MORE EQUAL

Prosperity gap* has narrowed to less than half



*Prosperity gap is the factor by which average incomes need to be multiplied to bring everyone to a global standard of prosperity, currently measured at $28 per day. The gap has reduced from 11.4 to 4.9 — **a 57% drop**

Other measures of inequality show a poorer picture. Median earnings among the top 10% workers were about **13 times** those of the bottom 10% in 2023

4 MORE FACES OF POVERTY

Education remains the biggest barrier to escaping the poverty —uneducated people are nearly 3 times more likely to be poor than even post-secondary educated ones

Population below poverty lines (2023)

Multidimensional poverty	**15.5%**
Urban poverty	**8.6%**
Rural poverty	**19.3%**
Without education	**21.3%**
Post-secondary education	**7.4%**

RK Laxman, mid-1980s

On the 26th of Jan 1950, we are going to enter into a life of contradictions. In politics we will have equality and in social and economic life we will have inequality
—Dr BR Ambedkar
CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY (1949)

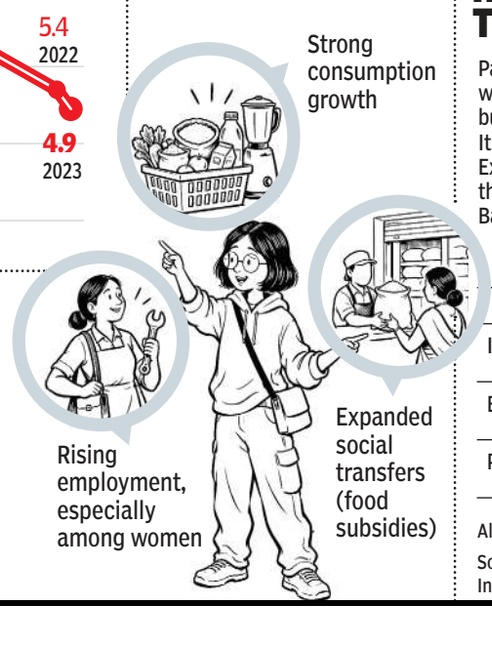
***Woh kehte hain Indira hatao, main kehti hoon garibi hatao* (They say remove Indira. I say remove poverty)**
— Indira Gandhi | 1971

Out of every rupee spent on development, only 15 paise actually reaches the beneficiary
— Rajiv Gandhi | 1985

India has made remarkable progress in reducing poverty across both monetary and non-monetary dimensions, recording one of the fastest poverty declines in the world
World Bank | OCT 2026

5 WHAT HELPED REDUCE POVERTY

(World Bank assessment)



6 HOW MUCH BETTER THAN NEIGHBOURS

Pakistan is one of few countries where poverty is not only high, but has been rising after Covid. Its prosperity gap is widening too. Extreme poverty is 9 times higher than India and almost 4 times Bangladesh's

Population below poverty lines

	$3.0	$4.2
India	**2.6%**	**16.1%**
Bangladesh	**5.9%**	**20.5%**
Pakistan	**23.0%**	**47.9%**

All poverty estimates are in $ PPP

Source: World Bank's Poverty and Inequality Platform, Poverty & Equity Brief

They used 'Diwali clean-up' to part pre-pay home loan

Preeti.Kulkarni@timesofindia.com

Diwali is nearly here, as is the annual ritual of tidying up homes, clearing out clutter and making room for new purchases and fresh beginnings. But the festive clean-up need not stop at one's home. Investment portfolios, too, need a periodic review.

Take the case of Navi Mumbai-based engineer Vaibhav Wandre. When the 42-year-old reviewed his portfolio recently, he realised that some of his life insurance-cum-investment policies were yielding annual returns of just 5-6%. "I was paying a combined annual premium of Rs 1.2 lakh for policies that did not even provide adequate life insurance cover. I surrendered them and used the proceeds of Rs 3 lakh to prepay my top-up home loan," he says.

Mumbai-based software engineer Tanushri Bhatkar, 37, has a similar story. "As part of my annual portfolio review, I discovered that it had a couple of poor-performing flexi-cap schemes, yielding returns of around 6%. I redeemed them and used the proceeds to prepay my home loan," she recollects.

A thorough portfolio review can, thus, be rewarding: it can uncover low-yielding investments and give you an opportunity to correct past mistakes.

Checklist for tidying up your investments

Do's

- **Align investments to goals** — Ensure your investments are mapped to your goals, investment horizon
- **Review insurance first** — Ensure adequate term and health cover before investing
- **Exit laggards and duplicates** — Weed out persistently weak and overlapping funds
- **Focus on asset allocation** — Keep the right mix of equity, debt and other assets
- **Review and rebalance regularly** — Reassess every 6-12 months and rebalance if needed

Dont's

- **Chase NFOs blindly** — Proven track record scores over novelty
- **Be blind to recency bias** — Avoid reacting to recent returns or market noise
- **Over-diversify** — Declutter portfolio, avoid multiple overlapping funds
- **Overlook taxes and costs** — Account for taxes, exit loads while rebalancing
- **Let emotions drive decisions** — Ignore FOMO, peer pressure and market hype

Vaibhav Wandre
Navi Mumbai, engineer

- Portfolio review revealed low-yielding endowment policies
- Amount freed up **Rs 3 lakh**
- Utilised for prepaying a top-up home loan

Tanushri Bhatkar
Mumbai, software professional

- Portfolio review revealed underperforming flexi-cap mutual funds
- Amount freed up **Rs 4 lakh**
- Utilised for prepaying home loan

Identify, Liquidate, Redirect

Buying insurance-cum-investment policies that have long lock-in periods without assessing their suitability is a common mistake investors make early in their careers.

Your clean-up can begin with a review of your insurance portfolio. For individuals with dependents — those who rely on the policyholder's income for their requirements, adequate term insurance is essential. "It should be the foundation of your protection portfolio," says Preeti Zende, founder, ApnaDhan Financial Services.

But endowment and money-back plans deserve close scrutiny. "These typically give returns of around 4-6%, and the cover is small. Before surrendering one, check the surrender value, how many premium payments are left and any bonuses you would forfeit. Never surrender blindly and never do so before term cover is in place," says Nisreen Mamaji, founder of MoneyWorks Financial Services.

Check Bloated Portfolios

Many investors start systematic investment plans (SIPs) in mutual fund schemes based on recent performance but lack the patience to ride out periods of volatility.

"If a scheme fares poorly in the interim, they stop the SIP and start another in a different scheme from the same fund category," explains Pankaj Mathpal, founder of Optima Money Managers.

However, they often retain existing investments due to exit loads or potential tax implications of redemption. Over time, this can result in multiple schemes within the same category, creating unnecessary duplication and portfolio clutter, Mathpal cautions.

But any switch should also take exit loads and short- and long-term capital gains tax into account. Mamaji says, "Judge a fund against its benchmark and category peers over three-to-five years, not against the last quarter. Check for style drift, a change of fund manager, promoter changes, etc. Sell only on genuine underperformance, not on the basis of a bad year."

Trend-Chasing Can Hurt Portfolio

Financial planners say the rush to own a piece of the latest new fund offer (NFO) is a common pattern. Investors may end up investing in schemes similar to those already in their portfolios.

"At the heart of these decisions are often FOMO (fear of missing out) and the desire to earn higher returns. Investors fear missing out on the latest investment theme or a newly launched fund being promoted as a must-have for their portfolio," says Zende. The result? An unwieldy portfolio with multiple schemes serving similar purposes. "Such investments offer limited diversification and greater complexity in monitoring. They can also lead to unsuitable risk exposure, unnecessary transaction costs and avoidable tax outgo," she adds.

Over-Diversification Can Backfire

Diversification across asset classes and mutual fund categories is essential for managing risk, but spreading investments too thin is avoidable.

"For instance, a well-chosen flexi-cap fund can invest across multiple sectors, reducing the need to purchase a separate sectoral fund for every investment theme," explains Mayank Gosar, CEO of financial advisory firm Softcon Capital. He recommends holding five-to-seven funds in a portfolio, provided each scheme serves a distinct purpose.

Buying On Recency Bias

Many investors rank mutual funds and asset classes by returns over the past six months to one year, and keep adding them to their portfolios. This recency bias often leads to an imbalanced portfolio, and an asset allocation mix that may not align with their goals, investment horizon or risk appetite.

"Most investors start their investment journey with the right intentions but tend to get derailed along the way because of behavioural biases," points out Mathpal. Mamaji says investors are often swayed by recommendations from friends or relatives, 'top five' fund lists or 'star fund' headlines. "However, portfolios should start with asset allocation — equity, debt and gold, and how much to allocate to each — and only then move to fund selection," she adds.

Map Investments To Goals

Take into account your age, investment horizon and risk profile before framing an asset allocation plan. Also, devise your investment plan only after ascertaining your existing investments, risk appetite, goals and income stability.

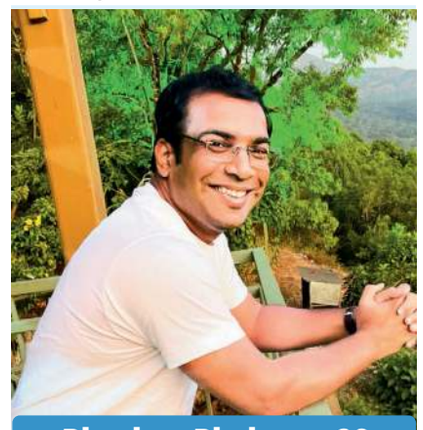
Financial plans must evolve with changing personal circumstances and market conditions. As a goal approaches, gradually shift investments from equity to debt to reduce exposure to market volatility. Finally, review your portfolio every six months to a year to ensure your investments remain on track to meet your financial goals.

How to make a habit of giving every month

Kayezad.E.Adajania@timesofindia.com

Bhushan Bhalerao started with Rs 600 a month. Today, the 36-year-old assistant manager at the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) gives Rs 5,250 every month on standing instructions, most of it towards girls' education. He was moved by his three college roommates, who came from financially difficult homes and are all doing well today. "Whenever my salary increased, I increased my SIP (systematic investment plan), and similarly, I increased the amount I donate," says Bhalerao.

Bengaluru-based retailer Faraz Adil Fazal, 40, gives by the book. A practising Muslim, he pays *zakat* every year: 2.5% of his liquid wealth, after the year's expenses. Yet, Fazal leaves room for the moment. Once, an auto-rickshaw driver stopped him outside one of his shops and asked for help with his daughter's school fees. The next year, the man came back with his daughter's results and the next year's fees. Fazal paid again. "Whenever you get approached, do something. It doesn't matter whether it is Rs 2,000 or Rs 5,000 or Rs 10,000," he says.



Bhushan Bhalerao, 36
Assistant manager, RBI

- Gives **Rs 5,250** a month, about **Rs 63,000** a year
- **Main causes:** Girls' education and orphaned children, through Give.do; also gives to Unicef
- Started at **Rs 600** a month and raised the amount with his salary
- Treats donations like an SIP, through a bank auto-debit

It's The Habit, Not The Size

Vishal Dhawan, founder of Plan Ahead Wealth Advisors, a Sebi-registered investment advisory firm, sees money largely going out on three fronts: helping one's own domestic staff; religious giving; and structured giving, such as giving money or time for a specific cause. Data from the Bain-Dasra India Philanthropy Report 2026 shows that India spends about Rs 27 trillion a year on the social sector, 8.2% of GDP. Roughly 95% of it is govt spending. Only Rs 1.43 trillion, or about 5%, comes from private funding. The good news: retail giving is expected to grow 9-11% a year, which the report credits to the spread of UPI (Unified Payments Interface) and digital giving platforms such as crowdfunding.

How much should you give? There is no single number. Dhawan says many of his clients contribute 2-3%, which can go up to around 10%. Bhalerao gives Rs 4,500 a month to a platform called Give.do for education through a credit card mandate, and the remaining Rs 750 to Unicef through a standing instruction on his bank account.

Bring In Your Planner

Giving is increasingly becoming a financial goal. Srikanth Bhagavat, managing director, Hexagon Capital Advisors, includes it in clients' financial planning questionnaires. Vishal Dhawan says that after age 50, clients with surplus wealth are encouraged to consider charitable giving.

Dhawan says short-term giving needs are met with investments in money market funds; the longer-term giving corpus goes into equity and hybrid funds. Bhagavat treats a philanthropy corpus like a retirement corpus.

Is giving negotiable? "In the earning years, giving is still discretionary because you are still building your corpus. But the idea of sharing is to give from what you have, so cut your giving only if other critical goals can't be met," says Bhagavat.

Time, Skills Or Money?

Meet Khushi Desai, 24, a Surat-based financial educator. She could have written a cheque, but chose to give her time instead. From a finance-oriented family, she conducts workshops on investments, mutual funds, and finance.

She began with flower pickers at an ashram near Palghar, Maharashtra. They kept cash in rice boxes and red chilli powder tins "because no one will steal it from there," she said, quoting them. After her session, all 20-odd participants started investing, for the first time. Over the last year, she has conducted 177 sessions, reaching over 2,000. People confuse savings and investing, she says. "I have seen too many people calling me and asking me, I've been investing for three months, and this is not increasing.... We are talking about 10 years, 15 years."

Light The First Lamp

Bhalerao began with Rs 600 a month. Fazal gives his 2.5% and still stops when someone asks. Khushi gives her time. Pick a cause, fix an amount, automate it and check where it goes.

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ASK THE EXPERTS

I am 77 and have Rs 30 lakh in the Senior Citizens' Savings Scheme and PM Vaya Vandana Yojana. After my demise, these schemes will end. My son, 46, my inheritor, is unmarried and has no income. Should I exit these schemes now and invest in suitable long-term instruments for him? — *Vishwas Bendale*

It may be prudent to exit these two schemes (subject to any applicable lock-in period) and reinvest the proceeds to create a regular monthly income for your son. If the sum is invested today in a moderate risk portfolio of mutual funds that delivers a return of 10% CAGR, the corpus could grow to approximately Rs 53 lakh over the next five years. By the time your son turns 51, a systematic withdrawal of Rs 20,000 per month could be initiated, which could continue for the next 30 years. For this 30-year period, we have assumed 9% CAGR on the corpus, with withdrawals increasing by 6% annually. This means the monthly withdrawal would be Rs 20,000 in the first year, Rs 21,200 in the second year, and so on. The monthly withdrawal would increase to around Rs 60,500 by the time your son reaches the age of 70.

Prableen Bajpai
Founder, FinFix Research and Analytics

If I raise Rs 15 lakh through social media crowdfunding for the medical treatment or surgery of my parents or relatives, and the entire amount is used for their treatment, do I need to disclose this amount in my ITR and pay tax on it, or is it exempt from income tax? — *Bidish Das*

Crowdfunded amounts for medical treatment do not enjoy a blanket tax exemption under the Income Tax Act, 1961. Under Section 56(2)(x), money from specific kin is fully exempt. However, contributions from friends, well-wishers or strangers are treated differently. If the aggregate amount from such sources exceeds Rs 50,000 in a financial year, the entire sum may become taxable as 'Income from Other Sources'. Using the amount for medical treatment does not qualify it for exemption. The only illness-specific exemption applies to Covid-19 treatment. Several crowdfunding intermediaries offer direct-to-hospital disbursement, paying the treatment provider straight from the campaign. Since the individual never receives the money, this structure can avoid possible personal tax liability altogether.

Shubham Agrawal
Senior taxation adviser, TaxFile.in

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A thought for today

Popularity should be no scale for the election of politicians. If it would depend on popularity, Donald Duck and The Muppets would take seats in Senate

ORSON WELLES

Back To Front?

Betting mkts reckon Trump will resume war against Iran after midterms. He has good reasons not to

Last month, Trump promised he wouldn't hit Iran "at any time prior to midterm elections," and he's kept his word, but what will he do after polls end? Nobody knows. Prediction markets are the closest thing to a crystal ball these days, and last evening Polymarket showed 94% chances of the ceasefire holding into Wednesday, but by Sunday that confidence dips to 76%. Is Trump really going to take a swing at Iran? Nothing really stops him once the votes are cast. Don't forget he's got three aircraft carriers in Arabian Sea, and is nursing a bruised ego.

That could make things ugly for everyone. Iran won't take a strike lying down. Mojtaba Khamenei's response will be "without geographical limitations". So, we'll expect a rerun of attacks on oil and gas infra across West Asia. Analysts see oil exceeding $140 a barrel in the worst-case scenario, and staying there because winter is starting, Europe and America need oil to heat homes, and their stockpiles have been depleted. For India, oil at that rate would mean higher inflation, rate hikes, slimmer forex buffer, weaker rupee, and yet another bear run in the stock markets. It'll be harder to keep up 7% growth.

But this isn't inevitable. Monday morning, oil futures actually slipped on talks between Iran and Qatari officials, who are mediating to end the war. Also, at his Halloween party, Trump didn't rule out peace when reporters asked him about Iran war. He said negotiations "are going fine". Then there's the prospect of a Democratic majority in both chambers of US Congress, which, while it can't stop Trump from waging war, can certainly limit funds available for it. Per Polymarket, Democrats will almost certainly control the House, and there's a 73% chance of their getting a Senate majority as well.

Trump doesn't care for voters' suffering, but he's thin-skinned about his image, and brags about how well the US economy has fared under him. Democrats have blamed inflation on Iran war, and question is, does Trump want to be held responsible for costly heating oil this winter? US stocks have done well, thanks to AI, but higher energy prices could finally pull the rug from under them. High inflation and rate hikes after Russia's invasion of Ukraine in 2022 had broken crypto's bull run. Iran war can do it to AI, and trigger a US slowdown to boot. Trump might not want it on his CV. Let's just hope he doesn't.

Age Of Play

A 20-year-old is F1 World Champion. The generational queue is crumbling across societies

Italy is overjoyed. After 73 years, one of their own has become a Formula 1 World Champion. It's a bit complicated, because Kimi Antonelli is a Mercedes man, in a country where F1 equals religion, but also Ferrari. But even the Ferraristas have packed the streets with celebration. The second most notable thing about Antonelli is that he is just 20 years old, beating the last youngest F1 World Champion, Sebastian Vettel, by 3 years. Over at the Ascot, another 20-year-old, Billy Loughnane, has become the youngest rider to be crowned Britain's champion jockey, in over a century. And our own Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, is the youngest player to score a fifty in men's international cricket, at age 15.

Sports have traditionally run on age segregation between juniors and seniors. Of course, different sports demand different things, and the sporting prime depends on what one is playing. But generally, youngsters were expected to wait their turn, while older players were expected to retire gracefully. Those boundaries are increasingly porous. At the opposite end of the Antonelli-Loughnane-Sooryavanshi spectrum are Virat Kohli at 37 and Djokovic at 39. Nutrition, recovery, biomechanics, fitness monitoring, sports psychology, data analytics, and specialised coaching, are transforming what athletes can do with their bodies. And, as a result, the generational queue is collapsing. Excellence has increasingly individual timelines. You are less and less a cohort, and more and more you.

If age is becoming a less powerful organising principle, this is not in sports alone. The implicit social contract where everyone has to wait their turn – you learn from your elders, pay your dues, accumulate experience, and eventually get your opportunity – is weakening across society. It's not just that a 15-year-old can become a global sporting sensation, but also that a 25-year-old can run a major company, and a 70-year-old can begin an entirely new career. Life now runs less and less linear.

In Protest Season

Ferrying curry leaves takes longer than usual

Anil Abraham

Kamala had sent me to buy some curry leaves, as she began seasoning the sambar, forgetting that it's the season of protests. Some neighbours had gathered near the park, emanating an angry buzz. I joined out of curiosity – and a misplaced sense of community. "We are protesting!" Senior Shanthamma informed me passionately. She has the unique distinction of having voted in every election since Independence. In the last local election, her photo had been featured on the city newspaper's front page. I assumed she was protesting because SIR had removed her name from the voter list. I was wrong. She informed me firmly that no sir could remove this madam.

By now I was distracted by voices raised on the other side of the crowd. Protest Prabhakara was arguing vehemently. Had Boomer Uncles with FOMO decided to participate in their first protest after the Partition? I moved closer, hoping to find the actual cause of the agitation. It turned out to be the price of milk. Apparently, steep hikes in the price of common household essentials are making domestic budgets untenable.

At the epicentre of another disturbance, Angry Arnab was raising a cyclonic storm. He and the nation were demanding to know why Tiger had been shot. He was upset that this young cub could be in danger, while we were importing cheetahs from other countries. Dimagi Damodar desperately tried to explain the difference between a nepo kid and a national animal, but as usual, Arnab was not listening to anyone else. Meanwhile, Frivolous Fatima asked the men a hundred times, to focus on things that really mattered. Like the National Crush and her *Koffee With Karan* and *Arjun Reddy*. Or, scouting for true love on *Bigg Boss* and finding sibling rivalry instead.

Keralam Kunjunni was seething too, over several important issues. He held a banner about those who ought to be in jail because *Jailer 2* has a Malayalam song, without one word from God's Own Country. He also had a beef with a travel blogger who had dissed both the menu and the artwork in Kochi's iconic Kashi café. Another legendary Bengaluru restaurant had customers protesting, because a cockroach had been found defending democracy in a dosa. 'No place to protest' was the excuse offered by the delinquent insect. "What took you so long?" Kamala asked with irritation as I finally handed over the groceries. The lady doth protest too much, methinks!

Midterms, Not Middle Path

Even if Democrats win both Houses, many of their likely winners will be fringe left. That'll be true, on the right, for Republicans. So, Congress will likely be dysfunctional, with moderates unable to control extremists

Dan Cassino

Professor of Govt & Politics

In these US midterm elections, candidates are campaigning not around ideology or issue positions, but fervent opposition or kowtowing obeisance to Trump. These approaches might have helped them win primary elections, but they're making it hard to appeal to mainstream voters, and neither one is very useful in the actual work of governance, or well suited to the fast-approaching post-Trump era.

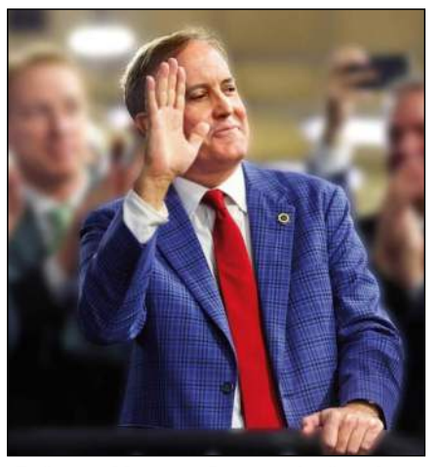
There has never been this big of a gap between the rank-and-file members of Democratic Party and candidates seeking their votes. Earlier this year, Democratic-leaning districts and states around the country saw candidates coming out of the woodwork to run in hotly contested primaries, hoping to take advantage of what was expected to be a blue wave in Nov.

While traditional party power brokers and organised interests tried to push moderate candidates, voters had different ideas. Turnout in US primary elections is generally much, much lower than in general elections, and the relatively small number of voters who show up in these elections tend to come from the fringes of the party. As a result, candidates who won in many of these primaries weren't those thought to be most electable, or most appealing to voters in the broader electorate, but those who best channelled the anger of progressives towards Trump.

In Senate, this has led to candidates like Abdul El-Sayed in Michigan, or Angie Nixon in Florida, who appealed to Democratic primary voters but have struggled in the general.

This has put Democratic leadership and more moderate candidates in a tough spot: they don't want to criticise their colleagues, but they also don't want to be associated with their progressive or socialist views. It's also led to real concerns about the ability of Democrats to control the House or Senate if they were to win majorities in one or both, as seems likely. A Democratic Speaker of the House is likely to face the same problems that have faced the current Republican Speaker, Mike Johnson: unable to wrangle fringes of his party, he's basically given up on trying to pass bills.

Republicans are facing the opposite problem. Ten years into the Trump era, anti-Trump Republicans who had been holding on, hoping to take the party back from its populist foray, have largely given up. Republican Party is, now, very much the Party of Trump, and with Trump's approval at record low levels – he's less popular than Nixon was just before his resignation – moderate voters have been fleeing the party, identifying instead as independents, or just opting out of politics altogether.



LEFT AND RIGHT, BUT NO CENTRE: (L) Abdul El-Sayed, Michigan Democratic Senate candidate; (R) Ken Paxton, Texas Republican Senate candidate

But that means that the most active members of Republican Party, the ones picking candidates in primaries, are the most fervent Trump supporters, and they've been nominating candidates who share their adoration. In Texas, Republicans kicked out popular incumbent Senator John Cornyn, replacing him with the Trump-endorsed former Attorney General of the State, Ken Paxton. Cornyn was a solid Republican, and voted with Trump on every major issue, but Trump objected to him on the grounds that he hadn't endorsed Trump quickly enough in 2024.

Were Cornyn on the ballot in Texas, he'd be well ahead of Democrat James Talarico. But the nomination of the scandal-scarred Paxton, who was once impeached by his own party for corruption, means that the race turned from a safe Republican win to a toss-up.

A similar dynamic is facing Republicans in ruby red South Carolina, where Trump's choice for the Senate nominee, Darline Graham, has no qualifications other than being the sister of the late Senator Lindsey Graham, and her utter devotion to Trump. That choice means that the South Carolina race, which in most years would be a blowout victory for Republicans, is in danger of going to the Democratic nominee, a pediatrician focused on healthcare issues.

But even aside from electoral challenges these candidates represent for both sides, they present bigger problems for governance. The constitutional system is designed to force some degree of conflict between the branches, as they fight to retain their power, and some degree of cooperation, as they have to work together to pass laws and shape policy. It simply doesn't function when one party refuses to check the powers of the president, and the other refuses on principle to work with him at all.

We've seen both extremes in the past few years, with Republicans in Congress refusing to work with Obama or Biden on anything, then letting Trump trample on the traditional separation of powers, and neither makes for effective governance.

But parties run by extremists are also parties that alienate voters. Support for democracy in US is at record lows: in a recent Gallup poll, only about 30% of voters are happy with how democracy is going, and perhaps for good reason. Major issues like immigration, social security, and healthcare are in need of difficult, creative solutions, and require serious, thoughtful legislators who can forge compromises. Voters are right to expect that their representatives will address issues facing the country. But legislators – of either party – who have built their politics around Trump, aren't in a position to do that.

While there are doomsayers devoted to the idea that Trump will be the end of democracy in US, it's so far struggled along, battered as it may be, through the better part of two terms with him in charge. The bigger danger now isn't Trump himself, but candidates who can't see past him.

The writer teaches at Fairleigh Dickinson University, US

NavICating: Charting India's Course Through Space

Launch of NVS-03 is a meaningful step towards India's goal for navigation sovereignty. But, ageing satellites and component dependence remain a challenge to sustaining the self-made satellite system

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The satellite launched on Oct 30 marked an important milestone for India's Navigation with Indian Constellation (NavIC). The satellite, NVS-03, is the latest addition to a system conceived to give India independent access to positioning, navigation and timing (PNT) services, without having to rely on foreign-controlled satellite navigation networks.

It comes at a time when NavIC has been struggling to maintain its core positioning capability. In July, GOI acknowledged that only three satellites were providing PNT services. Since at least four operational satellites are required for basic positioning, NavIC could no longer provide standalone positioning, although its timing service remained functional. NVS-03 has helped move towards the minimum threshold required to restore this capability. Reaching the minimum number is one thing, but it's key to ensure long-term reliability.

NavIC's origins lie in a strategic vulnerability exposed during the 1999 Kargil conflict. India recognised risks of depending on foreign navigation systems for critical military ops, particularly when access to satnav information could be restricted by the state controlling the system.

Cabinet approved Indian Regional Navigation Satellite System (IRNSS) in 2006. Unlike GPS, Russia's Glonass, EU's Galileo and China's BeiDou, which offer global coverage, IRNSS was designed as a regional system covering India, and an area extending about 1,500km beyond its boundaries.

Isro developed a seven-satellite architecture combining geostationary and inclined geosynchronous satellites. The first, IRNSS-1A, was launched in July 2013, the first-generation constellation was completed with IRNSS-1G, and PM renamed the programme NavIC. The design's high-elevation visibility allowed New Delhi to establish an independent system without the expense of building a global constellation. It also provided for a restricted service for authorised strategic users, alongside civilian positioning services.

The agenda was straightforward: India needed to control a critical infra capability, whose availability shouldn't depend entirely on decisions of another country. That ambition, however, encountered a significant technical vulnerability. Navigation satellites depend on extremely accurate timekeeping. Receivers calculate their distance from satellites by measuring how long radio signals take to travel to Earth. Even tiny timing errors can translate into significant ranging errors, affecting the accuracy of the position calculated.

Three rubidium atomic clocks aboard IRNSS-1A, procured from Swiss manufacturer SpectraTime, failed in 2016. Similar failures were reported in Europe's Galileo constellation.

Isro incorporated corrective measures in the clocks aboard IRNSS-1I, launched in 2018 to replace IRNSS-1A. But the incident exposed a larger weakness: a system could be designed and controlled domestically, while remaining dependent on foreign suppliers for components critical to its operation. Multiple atomic clock malfunctions in more than one satellite prompted Isro to switch to indigenous clocks.

Other setbacks included IRNSS-1H failing to reach orbit in 2017. NVS-02, launched in Jan 2025, reached its initial orbit, but could not be manoeuvred into its intended geosynchronous orbit due to pyro valve issues. IRNSS-1F completed its 10-year design life in March 2026, with its onboard atomic clock also ceasing to function. By July, the system had fallen below the minimum satellite strength required for standalone positioning.

The second-gen NVS satellites represent Isro's attempt to address these challenges. NVS-01, launched in May 2023, carried an indigenous atomic clock. NVS-02 and NVS-03 were also designed with indigenous clocks alongside procured ones. NVS

satellites introduce another major improvement: an L1-band navigation signal in addition to existing L5 and S-band signals. L1 is widely supported by commercially available navigation receivers, including those used in smartphones. Thus, its addition could improve NavIC's compatibility with civilian devices, encouraging wider adoption. Compatible receivers can also combine signals across frequencies to improve positioning performance.

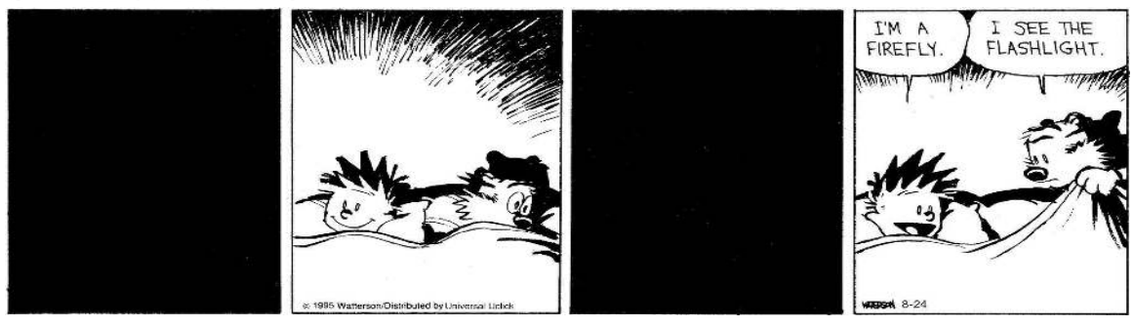
But the transition is not complete. NVS-03 still carries procured clocks, indigenous tech still being integrated. The planned NVS-04 and NVS-05 satellites will be important to rebuild the constellation, and provide the redundancy a reliable navigation system requires. Isro has set itself a 10-month deadline to launch these two satellites. This is where the distinction between technological sovereignty and operational sovereignty becomes important. Developing an indigenous atomic clock is significant. But a navigation system cannot depend on a handful of satellites operating at minimum threshold. It needs sufficient redundancy, to withstand component failures, ageing and launch setbacks without losing essential services.

Moreover, NavIC's strategic value cannot be measured only by number of satellites in orbit. Its civilian and economic potential depends on its integration into transport, aviation, maritime navigation, telecom, surveying etc. Wider adoption will require compatible receivers, industry participation, and confidence the service will continue.

GOI says most users operate in a multi-constellation environment, drawing signals from systems such as GPS and Galileo, alongside NavIC, wherever it is used. So, no standalone positioning doesn't necessarily mean loss of navigation services for users. But it leaves unsolved the original strategic problem – the independent alternative system has to deliver positioning on its own.

NVS-03 is therefore a major step, one of many more required, to realise NavIC's potential. India has the critical navigation tech, and must also maintain a dependable constellation, replace ageing satellites on time, and build an ecosystem that uses its signals.

Calvin & Hobbes



Sacred*space*

Acceptance looks like a passive state, but in reality it brings something entirely new into this world. That peace, a subtle energy vibration, is consciousness.

Eckhart Tolle

Mukesh...For Whom The Bells Chime

Preeti Mehta

We spend a lifetime building our net worth. But what is our human worth? A video clip of a man with one of the world's largest fortunes has travelled far this week. The billionaire, accustomed to commanding boardrooms, making consequential decisions and carrying the weight of an enormous empire, is seen listening to his children speak. His expression changes. His eyes well up. He tries to hold back his tears, briefly covers his face, and eventually breaks into a smile as though he has earned the biggest dividend of his life before the closing bell. The frame captures an overwhelming realisation: his legacy is safe in the hands of his children, mentees.

The moment was precious. It touched the hearts of countless viewers because there is something disarmingly human about watching a powerful man unable to contain his emotions in public. And it brings up an intriguing question: We spend a lifetime building our net worth, but what is our human worth? Our net worth tells the world what we have accumulated. Our worth as humans is reflected in what we have given, nurtured, and left behind in others. Not many of us will leave towering companies or immense fortunes. But every one of us leaves behind children, students, colleagues, friends and family. Each carries some part of us – what they learnt, absorbed, how we treated them and how our presence shaped their lives.

THE SPEAKING TREE

Sometimes, we may even have touched an unknown life in ways we will never know. That is the legacy that speaks for us when we are no longer in the room. In a sense, our own lives continue to be reflected in theirs. The Upanishads remind us: *Matru Devo Bhava, Pitru Devo Bhava, Acharya Devo Bhava* – revere your mother, father and teacher as divine. The Gita, meanwhile, reminds us that our right is to action, never to its fruits. Here, perhaps, was a rare glimpse of those fruits. What might those tears have been saying? 'I worked. I built. I tried. I gave. And now I see.' As life progresses, our definition of success changes. The milestones that once consumed us give way to simpler, more enduring pleasures: meaningful conversations, shared memories, the affection of those closest to us, and the desire to do good and touch as many lives as we can. Our net worth may tell the world what we have accumulated. Our human worth tells the story of what we have given. And if, after a lifetime of building an empire, a few heartfelt words from one's children, reflecting the values one has instilled in them, can bring tears of joy, pride and humility, one has already acquired the greatest wealth of all.

The richest moment of a billionaire's life, it turns out, cost nothing at all. He simply listened. And the sound of the bell that later chimed, setting off one of the biggest scrambles for an opportunity to create wealth, suddenly seemed to mean very little.

The writer is an anaesthesiologist

Border checks for vehicle emission choke Delhi, NCR

Ghaziabad: Border checks to implement bar on non-BS VI vehicles in the national capital gridlocked Delhi-Meerut Expressway and NH-9 at UP Gate and led to massive tailbacks Monday morning as the week began with a traffic nightmare for lakhs of daily commuters living in NCR, **reports Avishek Kumar**. The scenes were similar to the congestion seen at Delhi-Gurgaon border Sunday, the first day of checks, only much worse because this was a working day

Vehicles moved at a snail's pace as police set up layers of barricades on both sides of the border to screen vehicles for compliance with Delhi govt's order. The gridlock was worsened by vehicles found ineligible to enter Delhi being turned back.

Of the 123 vehicles checked on Monday, 39 were denied entry into Delhi, police said. For commuters, the checks translated into missed meetings, delayed appointments and disrupted personal plans. Varun Singh, ADCP (traffic), said the checks "will continue until AQI returns to normal levels".

Mumbai civic body deletes clip by actor for cracker-free festival

Retains Similar Clips By Other Celebrities

Richa.Pinto@timesofindia.com

Mumbai: A political storm erupted after BJP-led Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) deleted from its social media pages a clip of actor **Dia Mirza** urging citizens to shun firecrackers as part of its anti-pollution campaign for Diwali involving celebrities, following objections by city BJP chief Ameet Satam.

The move drew flak from the opposition as appeals by other celebrities, including actors Madhuri Dixit and Swapnil Joshi and cricketer Ajinkya Rahane, remained online, and prompted even BJP's ally Shiv Sena to question the selective outrage.

The row escalated after Mumbai mayor Ritu Tawde of BJP labelled Mirza "anti-Hindu"; questioned the choice of naming her a campaign ambassador; cited her purported opposition in the past to Narmada dam project, Uniform Civil Code and a statement by PM Narendra Modi. The mayor said she would be blacklisted from everything associated with BJP or Mahayuti. She said Satam's post reflected the position of all BJP corporators.

In a social media post later, Mirza said, "*Koi paise nahi liye hain. Bhalai ka zamana hee nahi raha* (I did not charge any fee for the campaign. There is no goodness left in this era)." **TOI** reached out to her, but she did not response. BMC did not issue any public statement on the issue. Celebrities were roped in for civic Diwali campaign amid rising pollution levels on Bombay HC's nudge. Mirza is learnt to have recorded and sent a video to BMC herself, at no cost to the civic body, after being officially requested to do so.

BMC posted her clip Sunday morning. "While celebrating Diwali we should take care of the environment & health. The pollution being caused owing to firecrackers is harmful to all of us. My appeal to all of you is that celebrate Diwali not with noise but happiness," she said in the video.

Satam told **TOI** that Mirza has been associated with anti-India forces and has sympathised with those who are trying to spread anarchy. Asked why he hadn't objected to the involvement of other actors and cricketers in the campaign, he said, to him, they represent the fields of arts and sports.

SC allows green firecrackers in Delhi, NCR

Days ahead of Diwali, Supreme Court has allowed the bursting of green firecrackers in Delhi-NCR from 6-7am and from 8-10pm on Nov 7 and 8. SC rued non-implementation of its earlier directions and measures undertaken by authorities to curb bursting of firecrackers in Delhi-NCR. SC said the right of an individual to engage in a particular practice, which may have a religious colour, is only a qualified one and can't go beyond constitutional curbs.

"Though imposition of a blanket ban seems to be the ideal solution, we are of the opinion that this court, at this point in time, is short of adequate data to decide whether or not a complete ban would be the best solution to solve the problem of environmental pollution, caused by bursting firecrackers," SC said in its Oct 29 order which was made available on Monday. Grap II was imposed in Delhi Monday, as AQI settled at 324 in the 'very poor' category, the highest since Feb 4 this year, when it stood at 339. This marks the highest pollution level in nine months, after 271 days. PTI

Swimmer jumbo E-5 returns to Maihar via 5km backwaters

Amarjeet.Singh1
@timesofindia.com

E-5's repeated crossings through the still backwaters of Bansagar dam have made it an unusual subject of interest for forest officers

Bhopal: Unlike other jumbos, for radio-collared elephant E-5, the deep, still waters of Bansagar dam in Madhya Pradesh's Shahdol district seem to be a familiar passage rather than a barrier.

Exactly a month after swimming back to Bandhavgarh from Maihar, the tusker returned to the district, once again crossing over 5km of the reservoir's backwaters from Beohari in Shahdol, the same route it took on Sept 7.

This time, though, E-5 has been exploring Maihar landscape for days. After entering compartment 633 in Semariya village, it stayed there for two days before moving through Harrai and Marwari villages. It then climbed a hill near Gorsari, stayed for a day, descended near Kharamkheda village and climbed the hill again.

After coming down, it crossed Amarpatan town along the highway and reached Bareh village. On Monday morning, it returned to the same hill. "E-5 has again returned to Maihar and taken the same route. Its movement is being constantly monitored and local villagers are being alerted," Prafull Tripathi, Maihar forest ranger, told **TOI**. "Elephants generally have a very sharp memory. Once they find a route, they remember it," he said.

E-5's repeated crossings have made it an unusual subject of interest for forest officers. Its return to Maihar also revives concerns over human-elephant conflict. On the night of Sept 7, E-5 entered Singpur Mohari village and trampled a farmer, Kanchhedi Yadav (50), to death. Forest officers are keeping a close watch on its movements and alerting residents.

'Salman Khan' Insta grp banter ends in murder of 2 Surat teens

Surat: A fight that erupted between members of an Instagram group named 'Salman Khan' after a joke over a horse-riding video prompted a midnight meeting to settle the matter, but eventually culminated in the brutal murder of two teenagers, in Gujarat's Surat Sunday night.

Mohammed Faizan (16) and Ajmal Sheikh (17) and their friend, whose comment on the video post triggered the confrontation, arrived near Fatima Kabrastan around 11.45pm to resolve the dispute. However, another argument broke out. "When Faizan and Sheikh tried to calm down the main accused by lightly tapping him on the head, he pulled out a butcher's knife from his pocket and stabbed both of them," ACP V R Malhotra said.

The victims' families alleged the dispute had stemmed from gaming-related issues, but police ruled that out. TNN

Keralam to bring spl law against online attacks on women

Thiruvananthapuram: Keralam govt is examining legal aspects of introducing a special law to prevent insults and attacks against women on social media, chief minister **V D Satheesan** said Monday. He said the existing legislation offered very little protection against such attacks.

"Govt is thinking of sending those who attack women on social media to prison by bringing in a special Act," Satheesan said while inaugurating 'Makalkoppam', a seminar organised by women and child development department to formulate a women's policy after discussions with stakeholders.

He also said that ministers, MLAs and other political leaders knew how to defend themselves against attacks on social media. "But what can an ordinary woman, who does not know how to defend herself against such attacks, do? It is for them that we are planning this special Act," Satheesan said.

He said govt was also working to ensure the financial independence of women and that several projects were in the pipeline. A major project to ensure the financial independence of every Kudumbashree member would be launched soon, he said.

"Usually, govts formulate a policy and ask others to follow it. Here, we are seeking suggestions and opinions from all stakeholders, and the policy will be formulated by you. I assure you govt will implement this policy with strong commitment." PTI

IISc builds 3D model to study cancer drugs' response in tumours

Chethan.Kumar
@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Researchers from Indian Institute of Science (IISc) have developed a low-cost, 3D-printed device that could help scientists understand why cancer drugs are less effective in deeper regions of solid tumours.

The device recreates nutrient- and oxygen-deprived conditions found inside tumours, which allows researchers to examine cancer cells' response to drugs at different depths.

The platform, developed by researchers from IISc's department of chemical engineering, addresses a longstanding challenge in cancer research: reproducing the complex microenvironment of solid tumours in laboratory conditions while retaining access to cells from different regions for analysis.

In solid tumours, blood vessels are often poorly developed and unevenly distributed. Consequently, cells closer to blood vessels receive more oxygen and nutrients, while those farther away experience shortages. These differences can influence how cancer cells grow and respond to treatment.

Published in Analytical Methods in 2026, the study was led by Toley, with Kumar and Shweta Kumar as co-authors. The researchers have made the device's design files publicly available to facilitate reproduction. They believe the approach could make paper-supported 3D tumour models more accessible for drug screening and studies of treatment response.

Uttarkashi bans trekking above 4,000m after heavy snowfall

Uttarkashi: Authorities have prohibited trekking on routes above 4,000 metres in reserved forest areas of Uttarkashi district, including the popular Gaumukh-Tapovan trail in Gangotri National Park, following heavy snowfall in the higher Himalayan reaches, **reports Ashish Mishra**. The forest department has stopped issuing permits for these routes, citing hazardous conditions caused by snow accumulation.

Uttarkashi divisional forest officer Jeevan Mohan Dagade said, "Persistent snowfall in high-altitude areas had made trekking routes unsafe. The department won't issue permits for trails above 4,000 metres until conditions improved." .

Gangotri National Park deputy director Mayank Garg said heavy snowfall on Oct 29 had left substantial snow accumulation along Gaumukh-Tapovan trail. However, Nelang Valley and Gartang Gali would remain open to tourists, Garg said.

No trace of 8 missing on Kedartal trek for 5 days; tents found

Gaurav Talwar & Ashish Mishra | TNN

Guides and porters were sent to locate the group, which was scheduled to return on Oct 29

Dehradun/Uttarkashi: Search teams found tents and bags near the suspected location of eight people missing on Kedartal trekking route in Uttarakhand's Uttarkashi district Monday, but there was no trace of the seven trekkers and their local guide, five days after they were scheduled to return.

Five helicopter sorties were conducted, while ground teams searched the snowbound terrain at an altitude of around 4,000 metres. But, deteriorating weather forced rescuers to suspend aerial operations and retreat to their base camps.

Uttarkashi district magistrate Prashant Arya said several teams, including personnel from Nehru Institute of Mountaineering, State Disaster Response Force, forest department and the trekking agency, had been deployed.

Meanwhile, a nine-member team comprising forest department personnel and trekking agency representatives, reached the suspected location of the missing group Monday.

The eight missing people were part of a 12-member group that left Gangotri for Kedartal on Oct 27 and was scheduled to return on Oct 29. Four other members were rescued on Oct 31.

34001/1083/2627

e-mail ID - sepwd_rgda@yahoo.com
Phone/Fax No - 06856 - 223049

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, RAYAGADA (R&B) CIRCLE, RAYAGADA

e-Procurement Notice

Bid Identification No. C.C.E (RANDB) RGDA- 07/2026-27 (Online) Dt. 28.10.2026
No.1576 Date. 28.10.2026

INVITATION FOR BIDS

1.	The **Chief Construction Engineer, Rayagada (R&B) Circle, Rayagada** on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites **percentage rate** bids in **double cover** mode to be received in **online mode** only for the construction of works as detailed in the table below:		
2.	Nature of work	:	**Bridge & Building work**
3.	No. of works	:	**05 (Five) Nos. of work**
4.	Estimated Cost. (Approximately)	:	**Rs. 564.89 Lakh, Rs. 458.07 Lakh, Rs. 155.09 Lakh, Rs. 150.61 Lakh, Rs. 586.66 Lakh,**
5.	Bid Cost (Online)	:	**Rs. 10,000/-**
6.	**EMD/ Bid Security Amount (Online)**	:	**One Percentage of the Estimated Cost.**
7.	Class of Contractor	:	**B, & A Class only as per Financial Eligibility.**
8.	Availability of Bid Documents in the website	:	**11.00 Hours of Dt.05.11.2026 to 17.00 Hours of Dt. 20.11.2026**
9.	Date of opening of Bid	:	**11.00 Hrs of Dt. 21.11.2026**
10	The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website: **https://tendersorissa.gov.in**. Any Addendum/ Corrigendum/ cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website. The authority reserves the right to reject any or all bids without assigning any reason thereof.		

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Rayagada (R&B)Circle, Rayagada
OIPR-34001/34154/1/26-27/0007

32001/1206/2627

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
POTTERU IRRIGATION PROJECT, BALIMELA
e-mail Id : ccepotteru123@gmail.com
e-Procurement Notice No:- CCE-PIP-BML-16/2026-27

1. Type of Works : System Improvement Works.
2. Total No. of Works : Four (4) Nos.
3. Estimated Cost : Rs. 462.19 Lakh to Rs. 462.19 Lakh
4. Period of Completion : Twelve (12) Calendar Months

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Bid Amount (Rs. In Lakh)	Availability & Submission of Bids-on line.
Chief Construction Engineer, Potteru Irrigation Project, Balimela, Malkangiri	CCE-PIP-BML-16(1)/2026-27 to CCE-PIP-BML-16(4)/2026-27	Rs 462.19 Lakh to Rs 462.19 Lakh	From 02.11.2026 10.00 A.M. to 16.11.2026 5.00 P.M.

Date of opening of the Tender / Bid: - 17.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M
Further details can be seen from the Govt. Website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Potteru Irrigation Project, Balimela
OIPR-32001/32052/1/26-27/0029

32001/1217/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
UPPER INDRAVATI PROJECT
AT/PO: MUKHIGUDA, DIST : KALAHANDI, ODISHA, PIN: 766026
e-mail address: cceuip1987@gmail.com/louiipbbsr@gmail.com

1. Type of Work : Road Works
2. Total No. of Works : 02 nos.
3. Approximate value of work : Rs. 843.21 lakhs to Rs.844.80 lakhs (Excluding GST)
4. Tender Paper Cost : Rs. 10,000/-(online)
5. Bid Security/E.M.D : Rs.8,43,300/- to Rs.8,44,900/-(Online)
6. Period of Completion : 18 (Eighteen Calendar months).
7. Class of Contractor : "A" & Special Class.

Procurement Officer	e-procurement Notice No.	Bid Amount	Availability of online viewing of Tender prior to Bidding		Period for seeking tender clarification	Submission & Availability of bid on-line	Date & time of opening of Technical Bid
			From	To			
1	2		3	4	5	6	7
CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, UPPER INDRAVATI PROJECT, AT/PO- MUKHIGUDA, DIST-KALAHANDI, ODISHA, PIN- 766026.	CCE, UIP-17(02)/2026-27, Dt. 28.10.2026	Rs 84320679/- to Rs 84480319/- (Excluding GST)	03.11.2026 (10.00 AM)	19.11.2026 (up to 5.30 PM)	03.11.2026 to 09.11.2026 during office hours.	03.11.2026 (10.00 AM) to 19.11.2026 (up to 5.30 PM)	20.11.2026 at 11:00 AM

Date of opening of technical bid - **Dt-20.11.2026 at 11.00 AM** in the O/O the Chief Construction Engineer, UIP, Mukhiguda, Kalahandi, Odisha, PIN-766026
Date of opening of financial bid - To be decided after finalization of Technical Bid.
Further details can be seen from the Govt. Website - **www.tendersorissa.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Upper Indravati Project, Mukhiguda
OIPR-32001/32352/1/26-27/0018

32001/1211/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER & BASIN MANAGER
TEL BASIN, BHABANIPATANA

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

"e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE NO.- CE&BM, TEL -P1-07/2026-27
Bid Identification No: CETEL-KLID-02/2026-27

The Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana (WR Department) on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites Percentage rate bid in Double Cover system to be received in on ONLINE MODE only for the construction of works as detailed in the table below:-

1	Nature of work	Civil Works
2	Number of works	01 (One)
3	Approximate amount put to tender.	Rs. 9,44,74,172/-
4	Class of Contractor	**'A' & 'Special'** Class
5	Period of completion	9 (Nine) Calendar months.
6	Date & time of availability of Bid document in the portal	Dt. 05.11.2026 -10.00 hours to 26.11.2026 up to 17.00 hours
7	Last date & time of seeking Tender clarification.	Dt. 20.11.2026 up to 17.30 hours
8	Last date & time of Receipt of Bids in the portal.	Dt. 26.11.2026 - up to 17.00 hours
9	Date, time & place of opening of Technical bids of Double Cover.	Dt. 27.11.2026 at 11.00 hours- in the office of the Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana

The bidders have to participate in online bidding only. The website for online bidding is **htpp://www.tendersodisha.gov.in.**

Sd/-
Chief Engineer & Basin Manager,
Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana
OIPR-32001/32317/1/26-27/0013

BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION
Office of te Executive Engineer, (Lakes Division), 3rd Floor,
Mini Vidhana Soudha, N.E.S Road, Yelahanka, Bengaluru-560 064

No: BNCC/EE(Lakes)/Tend-02/2026-27 **Date: 02-11-2026**

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Two Cover System and through GoK e-Procurement Portal only)

Tenders on item rate basis are invited by the undersigned for the works mentioned below from the registered Contractors of Bangalore North City Corporation or equivalent registration with CPWD/KPWD/ Railways/MES or any State Government Organizations.

The Tender Document Shall be downloaded from the GoK e-Procurement Website (https://kPpp.karnataka.gov.in) on payment of prescribed fee noted against each item of work (non refundable) in the form of e-Payment. The Tenderer should accompany a copy of the Registration Certificate valid up to the year of 2026 and shall be submitted through e-Procurement Portal (Standard Tender Bid Document)

S.No	Name of the Work	Approx. Value of work (Rs.in Lakhs)	EMD (in Rupees)	Stipulated Period of Completion (including rainy season)	Eligibility of Contractor and Category
1	Annual Maintenance of Dodda bommasandra lake, Singapura Lake, Narasipura Lake (Sy.No.20) & Narasipura Lake (Sy.No.26)	100.00	1,00,000/-	12 months	Class-III & Above (SC-Category)
2	Annual Maintenance of Venkateshapura Lake & Jakkur Lake (Wet Land and Water body)	85.00	1,70,000/-	12 months	Class-III & Above Others (General)
3	Annual Maintenance of Thirumenahalli Lake, Chokkanahalli Lake, Agrahara Lake, Palanahalli Lake & Kattigenahalli Lake.	75.00	1,50,000/-	12 months	Class-III & Above Others (General)
4	Annual Maintenance of Yelahanka Lake, Veerasagara Lake & Attur Lake	95.00	1,90,000/-	12 months	Class-III & Above Others (General)
5	Annual Maintenance of Vaderahalli lake, Chikka Bettahalli Lake & Avalahalli Lake (Single Cover System)	40.00	80,000/-	12 months	Class- III & Above Others (General)
6	Annual Maintenance of Allalasandra lake, Ramagondanahalli Lake Harohalli Lake & Medi Agrahara lake	90.00	1,80,000/-	12 months	Class- III & Above Others (General)
7	Annual Maintenance of Rachenahalli Lake, Amruthahalli Lake & Kogilu Lake	90.00	90,000/-	12 months	Class-III & Above (SC-Category)
8	Maintenance of Hebbala lake, Nagavara lake & Kacharakanahalli Lake	75.00	1,50,000/-	12 months	Class-III & Above Others (General)
9	Annual Maintenance of Abbigere Lake, Lakhsmipura Lake,Kammagondanahalli & Bagalagunte Lake	100.00	1,00,000/-	12 months	Class- III & Above (Category-II(A)

Calendar of events: 1. Available of Tender Documents: **03-11-2026 after 16:00 hours**, **2.** Pre-bid meeting: **11-11-2026 at 16:00 hours**, **3.** Last Date for receipt of Tenders: **16-11-2026 upto 16:00 hours**, **4.** Opening of Technical bid: **17-11-2026 at 16:30 hours**, **5.** Opening of Finance bid : **After Approval of Technical bid (will be informed later)**

Sd/-
Executive Engineer (Lakes Division)
Bengaluru North City Corporation

32001/1218/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
UPPER INDRAVATI PROJECT
AT/PO: MUKHIGUDA, DIST : KALAHANDI, ODISHA, PIN: 766026
e-mail address: cceuip1987@gmail.com/louiipbbsr@gmail.com

1. Type of Work : Road Works & Canal works
2. Total No. of Works : 02 nos.
3. Approximate value of work : Rs. 722.12 lakhs to Rs.845.76 lakhs (Excluding GST)
4. Tender Paper Cost : Rs. 10,000/- (online)
5. Bid Security/E.M.D : Rs.7,22,200/- to Rs.8,45,800/- (Online)
6. Period of Completion : 18 (Eighteen Calendar months).
7. Class of Contractor : "A" & Special Class.

Procurement Officer	e-procurement Notice No.	Bid Amount	Availability of online viewing of Tender prior to Bidding		Period for seeking tender clarification	Submission & Availability of bid on-line	Date & time of opening of Technical Bid
			From	To			
1	2		3	4	5	6	7
CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, UPPER INDRAVATI PROJECT, AT/PO- MUKHIGUDA, DIST-KALAHANDI, ODISHA, PIN- 766026.	CCE, UIP-18(02)/2026-27, Dt. 29.10.2026	Rs 72212474/- to Rs 84576091/- (Excluding GST)	04.11.2026 (10.00 AM)	20.11.2026 (up to 5.30 PM)	04.11.2026 to 10.11.2026 during office hours.	04.11.2026 (10.00 AM) to 20.11.2026 (up to 5.30PM)	21.11.2026 at 11:00 AM

Date of opening of technical bid : **Dt-21.11.2026 at 11.00 AM** in the O/O the Chief Construction Engineer, UIP, Mukhiguda, Kalahandi, Odisha, PIN - 766026
Date of opening of financial bid : To be decided after finalization of Technical Bid.
Further details can be seen from the Govt. Website - **www.tendersorissa.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Upper Indravati Project, Mukhiguda
OIPR-32001/32352/1/26-27/0019

25001/1433/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
CENTRAL RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BHUBANESWAR
No : 6649/ Date : 29.10.2026

"e" Procurement Notice for Building Work

1.	Name of the work	:	Building Works
2.	Total No. of Works	:	03 Nos. of Building works
3.	Estimate cost of the work	:	Varies from Rs. 120.18 lakh to Rs. 779.04 lakh
4.	Class of Contractor	:	
	a) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20.00 lakh upto Rs. 3.00 Crores	:	**B Class** (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	b) Estimated cost more than Rs. 1.00 Crore upto Rs. 20.00 Crores.	:	**A Class** (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	c) Estimated cost more than Rs. 6.00 Crore upto Rs. 50.00 Crores	:	**Super Class** (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	d) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20.00 crores	:	**Super class** (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
5.	Period of completion	:	As mentioned in Column-7 of Annexure
6.	Offered rates by bidders	:	The offered rate by the contractor shall be excluding GST
7.	Other details	:	

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of tender On-line for bidding		Date & Time of Opening of Tender	
		From	To	Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6
Chief Construction Engineer, Central Rural Works Circle, Bhubaneswar.	Tender- Online - C.C.25 of 2026	10.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	23.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	25.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	To be intimated later on

Further details can be seen from the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Engineer
Central Rural Works Circle, Bhubaneswar
OIPR-25001/25082/1/26-27/0023

32001/1219/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
UPPER INDRAVATI PROJECT
AT/PO: MUKHIGUDA, DIST : KALAHANDI, ODISHA, PIN: 766026
e-mail address: cceuip1987@gmail.com/louiipbbsr@gmail.com

1. Type of Work : Road Works
2. Total No. of Works : 02 nos.
3. Approximate value of work : Rs. 804.44 lakhs to Rs.834.42 lakhs (Excluding GST)
4. Tender Paper Cost : Rs. 10,000/- (online)
5. Bid Security/E.M.D : Rs.8,04,500/- to Rs.8,34,500/- (Online)
6. Period of Completion : 18 (Eighteen Calendar months).
7. Class of Contractor : "A" & Special Class.

Procurement Officer	e-procurement Notice No.	Bid Amount	Availability of online viewing of Tender prior to Bidding		Period for seeking tender clarification	Submission & Availability of bid on-line	Date & time of opening of Technical Bid
			From	To			
1	2		3	4	5	6	7
CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, UPPER INDRAVATI PROJECT, AT/PO- MUKHIGUDA, DIST-KALAHANDI, ODISHA, PIN- 766026.	CCE, UIP-16(02)/2026-27, Dt. 27.10.2026	Rs 80443737/- to Rs 83442198/- (Excluding GST)	02.11.2026 (10.00 AM)	18.11.2026 (up to 5.30 PM)	02.11.2026 to 07.11.2026 during office hours.	02.11.2026 (10.00 AM) to 18.11.2026 (up to 5.30PM)	19.11.2026 at 11:00 AM

Date of opening of technical bid : **Dt-19.11.2026 at 11.00 AM** in the O/O the Chief Construction Engineer, UIP, Mukhiguda, Kalahandi, Odisha, PIN - 766026
Date of opening of financial bid : To be decided after finalization of Technical Bid.
Further details can be seen from the Govt. Website - **www.tendersorissa.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Upper Indravati Project, Mukhiguda
OIPR-32001/32352/1/26-27/0020

TIMES GLOBAL

* THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 3, 2026

LOVE ALL, TRUST A FEW,
DO WRONG TO NONE
— WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

JACK LOWDEN IS SILENT ON HIS RUMOURED SCREEN TESTS FOR JAMES BOND ROLE , SAYS 'I'M NOT GOING TO ADD TO THE NOISE'

DUSTIN HOFFMAN SAYS HE WAS SLAPPED 27 TIMES FOR A SCENE IN 'THE GRADUATE' WHICH DIDN'T MAKE IT TO THE FINAL CUT

Blue wave meets red flag: On cusp of big win, Dems face internal sabotage

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Washington: Just when Democrats in America were beginning to entertain thoughts of a blue wave, possibly even a blue tsunami, along came Haley Stevens to remind them that nobody is quite as capable of complicating Democratic fortunes as a Democrat.

In an extraordinary convulsion barely 48 hours before Tuesday's midterm elections, the Democratic Michigan congresswoman, who lost ca bitter party primary (inner party election) to progressive Abdul El-Sayed, crossed the political aisle to endorse his Republican opponent, Mike Rogers, in what would be called a last minute "defection" in Indian political parlance.

The immediate political damage is difficult to quantify, but the optics and the timing – coming just when many polls are showing a Republican rout – could hardly be worse for Democrats, who are trying to persuade voters that they are united. Instead, one of their own has provided Republicans with a ready-made advertisement for Democratic disarray. MAGA boss Donald Trump immediately jumped on the break, praising her "bravery."

The Stevens-El-Sayed rupture had been simmering since a bitter Aug primary, which El-Sayed won by less than 1%. It

UNITED STATES MIDTERMS

was not simply a case of a disappointed politician nursing wounded ambitions within the party; the two represent sharply different constituencies and political instincts, particularly over Israel and Gaza war.

Stevens, a staunch supporter of Israel, was bankrolled by the so-called "Jewish lobby". El-Sayed, a progressive son of Egyptian immigrants, campaigned on a more critical position towards Israeli policy and US military support for Israel.

Barely 48 hours before midterms, Dem Michigan congresswoman Haley Stevens (L), who lost party primary to Abdul El-Sayed, crossed political aisle to back Republican Mike Rogers (R)

The primary exposed fault lines between pro-Israel Dems and the party's vocal progressive wing, and the schism is now threatening to play out nationally, undercutting polls pointing to a big win.

Stevens initially endorsed El-Sayed after losing — albeit without much enthusiasm — but the truce was always more a marriage of political convenience than a true reconciliation. The trigger for the final explosion was an ad by El-Sayed supporters linking US financial support for Israel to the rising cost of groceries. Stevens considered the advertisement antisemitic and demanded that El-Sayed disavow it. He eventually rejected the ad's contents, but the dispute had gone personal, with El Sayed, likely emboldened by polls showing he was leading by 10+ points, torching a planned joint church appearance with Stevens and asking her to take a walk. She walked — over to Republican candidate Mike Rogers.

Such election-eve defections being rare in America, Democratic leaders were aghast. Democratic partisans are still hoping that an NYT/Siena poll showing the party leading in all seven crucial Senate races — five of them by +5% — can withstand the last minute Stephens torpedo. The numbers are unbelievable for Dems, particularly in Kansas and Texas, where they have not won a Senate seat in decades. Even allowing for polling error, the geographical breadth of the Democratic advantage suggests a political environment hostile to Republicans.

Still, the Dem are nervous, and the feeling is not entirely irrational. The party has repeatedly discovered that the electorate it sees in surveys is not necessarily the one that turns up at polling stations. Donald Trump's political career has been built, in considerable measure, on voters who are difficult for traditional polling models to capture: less politically engaged people, rural and small-town voters, working-class whites, and those who are reluctant to identify openly with MAGA and some of its nativist and racist agenda.

The 2016 election remains the defining example. Hillary Clinton's 97% winning certainty evaporated in the industrial Midwest and boondocks America, where Trump mobilised voters who had been insufficiently represented in polling samples and turnout assumptions. Even in 2024, Dems were surprised by the extent of Trump's support among working-class voters, including sections of the electorate that had previously been part of their coalition.

This is the so-called hidden Trump voter: somebody who may not be particularly enthusiastic about the Republican Party, may not even like Trump personally, but will turn up to vote Republican when sufficiently motivated. There is another complication: Midterm elections generally have a different electorate from presidential contests. Older, more habitual voters tend to dominate, while younger and less politically engaged voters are more likely to stay home. That will favour Republicans if the Democratic advantage in current surveys — captured by a range of pollsters from Nate Silver to NYT — does not translate into actual turnout.

Fridge cyberattack hits supermarkets across 8 European countries

Reuters

An empty refrigerator at a SuperValu store in Dublin, Ireland

Grocery stores across at least eight European countries were hit on Monday by a suspected cyberattack on freezer systems, which the EU described as a deliberate attempt to disrupt the bloc's food chain.

Retailers in countries from Sweden to Portugal, including Belgium, Estonia, Finland, Ireland, Luxembourg and the Netherlands, reported refrigeration failures three weeks after a cyberattack caused widespread disruption at French grocery stores. Produce that had risked spoiling after temperatures rose overnight was discarded.

No one had claimed responsibility for Monday's incidents or the Oct 12 attack on French retailers that forced hundreds of stores to discard food. EU food and agriculture commissioner Christophe Hansen called the repeated attacks "deeply concerning". "They are a deliberate attempt to disrupt our food supply chain and undermine consumers' confidence in it — a warning that we must take seriously," Hansen said.

Belgian federal prosecutors opened an investigation after dozens of stores across several chains reported disruptions, but had not classified the incident as a cyberattack. Carrefour Belgium said about 15 of its 700 stores were affected, while an Ikea store in Mons reported a cyberattack that caused freezer temperatures to rise early Monday.

Refrigeration group Sabcobel said it had begun securing installations after the French attack, but about 10% remained unfixed and some were in the shops affected. While they did not explicitly call it a cyberattack, chains Delhaize, Colruyt and Intermarche reported technical issues at dozens of Belgian stores, while four Delhaize stores in Luxembourg were affected.

Musgrave said 13 Supervalu stores in Ireland were affected by a cyber incident. Some Dutch corner shops also reported disruption. Portugal's Mosqueteiros group linked incidents at seven Intermarche stores to a cyberattack apparently targeting an external refrigeration-system service provider.

Swedish chain Coop said six of about 800 stores were hit, but the problem had been resolved. Ica reported refrigeration problems at a limited number of Swedish stores connected to an external control system supplied by Danish manufacturer Danfoss, the supplier targeted in France. Danfoss did not respond to an AFP request for comment.

Finland's Kesko group detected irregular temperatures at several stores and said network interference had not been ruled out. In Estonia, hackers raised refrigeration temperatures to 50°C at at least one supermarket, broadcaster ERR reported. AFP

Jet crashes into Florida street, 9 on board dead

ROADS KILL, SKIES STAY SAFE

Reuters

A Learjet crashes in a residential area in Palm Beach County

Year	PASSENGER DEATHS IN US (2020-24)			
	Pass. vehicles*	Buses	Pass. trains	Airlines
2020	23,907	12	2	5
2021	26,453	6	6	0
2022	25,487	17	7	11
2023	24,007	27	1	0
2024	22,703	33	2	0

*Include passenger cars, light trucks, vans, and SUV. Include taxi passengers. Drivers of light duty vehicles are considered passengers

A business jet crashed into a South Florida neighbourhood and erupted into a ball of flames, killing all nine people on board and leaving a fiery crater. The cause was not clear at the time of going to the press.

Video recorded by passersby captured the terrifying moment on Sunday afternoon when the Bahamas-bound aircraft plunged from the sky before slamming into the ground and exploding in Greenacres, about 11 kilometres southwest of West Palm Beach. Flames flickered around chunks of pavement lining the crater as shocked residents looked on in horror.

Florida governor Ron DeSantis said there were no immediate reports of anyone on the ground injured or killed. Authorities have not released the names of those who died.

The jet began its journey at the Austin-Bergstrom International Airport in Texas. Airport spokesperson Jim Reynolds described it as a private aircraft but could not immediately provide details about who was on board.

Camila Corteleti told the New York Post and New York Times that her daughter, 20-year-old Nathalia Gadelha Filgueiras, was one of the pilots. Her pilot's licence showed she had the rating to fly that model of Learjet but not to be in command of the flight.

The plane was heading east at 35,000 feet when the pilot started to report problems. The pilot said ice was accumulating on the jet and that turbulence was jolting it by as much as 700 feet, according to air traffic control recordings captured by LiveATC.net.

The situation rapidly deteriorated. The pilot requested permission to climb another 2,000 feet and then declared an emergency as the jet lost altitude at an alarming rate. "We're descending 8,000 — mayday, mayday — we're descending 10,000 feet per minute," the pilot radioed. "We are in an overspeed condition descending 20,000 feet per minute," the pilot radioed. Moments later, the pilot said: "We're going to crash." Video shows the plane banking sharply to the right before crashing. AP

CLEARING THE AIR: WHO FLIES SAFER

Private Jet vs. Commercial Airline Safety: What the Data Shows

Category	2021 accident rate /fatal rate	Risk Factor
Scheduled Airlines	0.133/0	Safest category overall; highest FAA oversight and crew redundancy
On-Demand Charter	0.76/0.201	'Very safe; mandatory pilot training and maintenance checks'
Private/ Corp Flights	0.26/0	Higher risk; less oversight and no crew duty limits
Top-tier Charter Fleets	Data not publicly available	Independent audits and best-practice safety systems; specific rates not disclosed.

*Accident rates are based on per 100,000 flight hours; Source: Element Aviation

Nukes, Netanyahu, Nov: Nuclear war alarm raised for nth time

US Commentator Claims Bibi Pressing Trump To Launch Strike Against Iran

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Washington: Somewhere in Washington DC, the nuclear clock is apparently ticking. At least according to Tucker Carlson, a former Fox News host and penitent Trump loyalist, who says the US president may be hours away from ordering a nuclear strike on Iran under pressure from Benjamin Netanyahu. The target, according to Carlson, is Pickaxe Mountain, a heavily fortified underground complex near Iran's Natanz nuclear facility.

"Bibi (Netanyahu) calls Trump about it every day," Carlson quoted an "informed observer" as saying in a lengthy post on X, claiming that the Israeli PM is "cornered and desperate" after last week's election results, and he can't form a govt unless Trump helps him. "The only military option is a nuclear strike," Carlson wrote, alleging that the Trump administration has quietly rewritten the US nuclear doctrine since Feb to make battlefield nuclear weapons easier to use.

Carlson also dragged in India, Pakistan, and other nations into his alarmism. A US strike, he warned, would unleash radioactive contamination across the Persian Gulf, potentially trigger nuclear escalation involving Russia, India, Pakistan and North Korea, and bring about World War III. "After the first nuclear strike, World War Three is inevitable. That war would be short and final," he wrote, without explaining why others would get involved.

AFP/File

According to Tucker Carlson, the US target will be Pickaxe Mountain, a heavily fortified underground complex near Iran's Natanz nuclear facility

Carlson has been sounding variations of this alarm for months, suggesting that even Armageddon has trouble keeping appointments. The latest post was greeted with ridicule in serious policy circles despite the adventurism of Trump and his MAGA cohorts.

Neither the White House nor the Pentagon has confirmed a change in nuclear doctrine. Carlson identifies no named American official, produces no documentary evidence and relies on anonymous sources for his central claims. Trump himself told Newsmax in Oct: "I wouldn't use nuclear. We don't have to."

Still, US hardliners have been raising the prospect of an imminent nuclear confrontation with Iran for months, repeatedly drumming up the bogey of Tehran acquiring nuclear weapons within weeks or months. The American bogey of Iran getting nuclear weapons within weeks has now acquired a life of its own with one widely circulated meme features an ancient stone tablet supposedly dating to 1750 BC, bearing the inscription: "Iran is only weeks away from developing nuclear weapons." Another version has archaeologists discovering a 3,000-year-old tablet warning that Persia was weeks away from the bomb.

Carlson is also accused of having his own agenda in cranking up the nuclear alarm. Once among Trump's most enthusiastic media champions, he has become one of the most consequential dissenting voices within the MAGA movement, and his break with Trump has been pronounced over Israel and Iran.

Carlson has argued that America should not subordinate its foreign policy to Israeli interests or be dragged into another war in West Asia. He has attacked Netanyahu's influence in Washington, questioned the rationale for American military intervention and challenged the longstanding assumption among Republican conservatives that supporting Israel is an unquestionable article of faith. The nickname "Qatarlson", popularised by his critics, including Laura Loomer and other pro-Israel conservatives, suggests that his criticism of Israel reflects Qatari influence rather than independent conviction.

There are also larger ideological divisions at play here. One faction of MAGA believes America First means resisting foreign entanglements, particularly wars undertaken for Israel; another regards unwavering support for Israel as integral to US national security and conservative politics.

Intensive negotiations on to avert war: Iran

Iran Monday said "intensive" exchanges were underway with Washington and offered to reopen the Strait of Hormuz under strict conditions, as efforts escalated to avert a return to war. Foreign minister Abbas Araghchi said indirect talks were taking place via mediators. China also urged a return to negotiations, while Iran's security chief discussed the conflict with Russian President Vladimir Putin. "Given the sensitivity and gravity of the current situation, consultations and deliberations are very intensive," Araghchi said in a video interview with the official IRNA news agency. "Qatar and Pakistan are playing a very active mediating role in these negotiations." The Axios news outlet reported that US Vice President JD Vance had sent a letter to Iranian national security chief Mohsen Rezaei about possible new talks, marking the highest-level move in months. AFP

Fake nuke threat alerts sent to emergency apps of Ukraine, Russia

Strikes on Ukraine aid centre kill 18

Russian strikes on a village in Ukraine's southeast killed at least 18 people Monday, Ukrainian President Zelensky said, as some of the victims were collecting humanitarian aid. The strikes on Komyshuvakha in the Zaporizhzhia region come as Moscow resumed fighting and attacks after a rare local truce brokered to evacuate the Russian-occupied city of Oleshky. Zelensky added that the strikes "targeted a school used for humanitarian purposes..." AFP

Kyiv: Ukraine and Russia said their emergency alert apps had been hacked overnight, sending false warnings to citizens about impending air raids, chemical and nuclear attacks. The warnings coincided with the expiry of a six-day local ceasefire brokered by US first lady Melania Trump in a small area of southern Ukraine.

Ukraine's public air raid app started to send false alerts just before 11pm local time Sunday for Kyiv and other areas warning of radiation and chemical attacks and also the risk of street combat in some areas. One of the fake alarms said Russia had launched a hypersonic Oreshnik missile — which is capable of carrying a nuclear warhead — and that a nuclear alert had been declared across Ukraine.

Ukraine's air force said shortly afterwards on the Telegram messaging app that the alert system appeared to have been hacked by Russia, noting that the alerts were broadcast in the Russian language. The Ukrainian language is compulsory for all official communications in Ukraine.

In Moscow, Russian state news agency TASS quoted the ministry of emergency situations as saying early Monday its mobile app had also been hit by a cyberattack. Atesh, a pro-Ukrainian hacking group, posted a screenshot of an alert on its Telegram channel early Monday, stating, "The ministry of emergency Situations app has been hacked!" However, the ministry played down the impact.

A fake message posted by the hackers, seen by Reuters, told Russians nuclear warheads had been launched against all Russian regions and advised people to stock up on three weeks of food and take shelter in their cellars. REUTERS

Israel oppn meets today for PM pick

Party heads in the Israeli opposition camp, led by Gadi Eisenkot, will meet Tuesday after they all endorsed the former military chief to become the next PM. It will be the diverse grouping's first meeting since last week's close-fought election delivered no majority. Eisenkot's Yashar party said the leaders of the so-called change bloc would meet "to discuss coordinating the bloc's next steps" in Herzliya Tuesday morning. Eisenkot's bloc won 48 seats while Netanyahu's camp secured 53. Arab-majority lists won a record 19 seats in the 120-member parliament, making them potential king-makers. AFP

Scottish govt gives IT contract to B'luru firm to administer welfare payment, sparks row

Naomi Canton

London: The Scottish National Party, which governs Scotland, has come under fire from opposition ministers for handing a £35.4 million (almost Rs 450 crore) contract to an IT services company in Bengaluru. Under the contract, Mphasis will manage and maintain Scotland's benefits management platform that delivers welfare benefits to around two million citizens in Scotland.

Scotland first minister John Swinney has just returned from a trade mission to India where he was meant to be finding opportunities to support jobs and prosperity across Scotland, so news that he has instead sent lucrative work to India has sparked fiery criticism back home.

Scottish Labour's social justice spokesman, Mark Griffin, told the "Scottish Mail on Sunday": "We should be using public contracts like this to boost local business and Scottish economy and create jobs in Scotland. All too often, under SNP, good work has flowed overseas. SNP ministers should explain why this decision was made."

A Social Security Scotland spokesperson told **TOI**: "Contracts are awarded in line with the Scottish govt's procurement guidelines, which state that bids are to be treated equally, regardless of the location. This ensures that we award contracts to the bidder offering the best overall value. Investment in technology ensures we are future proof and adaptable to changing demands for our payments."

Sources in the Scottish govt told **TOI** that the platform "requires highly specialised expertise in a niche technology area with a relatively small number of suppliers globally able to demonstrate the scale, experience and capability required".

DAILY PLANET

Reuters

People dressed as Catrinas at a Day of the Dead parade in Madrid

S'pore denies probe into China spy plot tied to Nvidia boss

Singapore has denied investigating a Chinese executive reportedly close to Nvidia chief Jensen Huang, rejecting claims made in a Wall Street Journal report that authorities were "concerned" about possible Chinese espionage. The Journal said in an article published on Friday that officials in the US, Taiwan and Singapore "have grown concerned" about the ties between the Nvidia boss and Alice Huang of Singapore-based data centre firm Megaspeed International. The ties "potentially" gave "Beijing access to information about the world's most valuable artificial-intelligence chips", the report said. Singapore's ministry of home affairs said at the weekend neither the govt nor officials had expressed concerns about Alice Huang's ties to the Nvidia boss or suspicions she was a China intelligence source.

After 28 yrs & 51,000-km trek around the world, Karl Bushby is back in UK

Hull (England): Karl Bushby was taking the final steps Monday of his 28-year odyssey to walk around the world and return to his mother's home in northern England. Bushby was surrounded by journalists as hundreds of people cheered his arrival at City Hall. "Sorry to keep you waiting," he joked. "Is that it, is it done?"

Bushby was a 29-year-old exparatrooper when he walked from his home to a Royal Air Force base near Oxford and caught a flight to South America. He returned as a 57-year-old — softer, greyer and weathered, but far more worldly. "They say it takes a village but literally it took a world to get me here," Bushby said. "The kindness of strangers, so many, from individuals to nation states to get me back here today. I didn't do this alone. There was a big team. The biggest team. Earth."

Bushby set out from Punta Arenas, Chile, on Nov 1, 1998, and has walked 50,000 kilometres across four continents and 30 countries to get home. He navigated shifting ice over the Bering Strait and swam across the Caspian Sea and English Channel to avoid taking a boat or plane — or any transport — to propel him forward.

He had a thirst for adventure, but his mission only came into focus when his father, Keith, sent him a birthday card in the mid-90s. His dad, an army veteran himself, mentioned an argument among his fellow special forces troops about the possibility of walking from London to New York over the Bering land bridge, believed by some scientists to have been used by early humans to migrate from Asia to the Americas at a time of lower sea levels. Perilous jungles, scorching deserts and frozen tundra slowed him down, but bureaucratic red tape often brought his adventure to a halt for long periods.

AP

LONG ROAD HOME: British adventurer Karl Bushby with his mother Angela at her home in Hull

Bushby originally calculated the distance could be covered in about five years, but he knew that was unrealistic.

"You just dump a whole bucket full of reality on that," he said. "We suspected that it was 12 years plus. And the plus was a big plus. But never in our wildest dreams would we ever have imagined 28 years."

He dodged war in the dangerous Darién Gap, the roadless and rugged jungle, rainforest and mountains between South and Central America in 2001, and was then jailed for 18 days after crossing a restricted border zone in Panama. After being airlifted to safety during the 90-km Bering Strait crossing in 2006 with American adventurer Dimitry Kieffer, they started again and faced a standoff with a polar bear, survived near-death plunges into freezing waters and almost lost all their supplies when their sleds plunged in the sea. After managing the rare crossing, the pair were jailed and faced deportation for entering Russia illegally.

It took Bushby almost 10 years to make his way through Russia in fits and starts because of visa struggles and weather that allowed travel only a few months a year. When Russia denied him a visa in 2012, Bushby walked in protest from Los Angeles to the Russian embassy in Washington, DC, which eventually led to him getting the proper paperwork.

Bushby planned to meet with family, including his son, Adam, whom he has only seen a few times over the journey. He was expected to meet his 12-year-old granddaughter for the first time. Then he was off to push his two-wheeled cart the final steps across Hull and reunite with his mother, Angela, whom he hadn't seen in a decade. "It's been a week of lasts," Bushby told the crowd.

"The last day in the tent. The last day on the road. After 28 years you couldn't ask for more than this. This is the last of the last few steps almost to my mother's house." AP

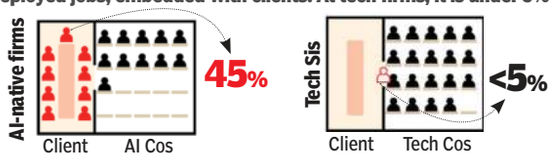
TIMES BUSINESS

THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 3, 2026

ROLE CALL

AI services are set to open a $100-200bn pool of work by 2030. IT services firms or tech firms, already employ much of the talent to win it, but under the wrong job titles

AI-native companies put about 45% of their applied AI staff in forward-deployed jobs, embedded with clients. At tech firms, it is under 5%

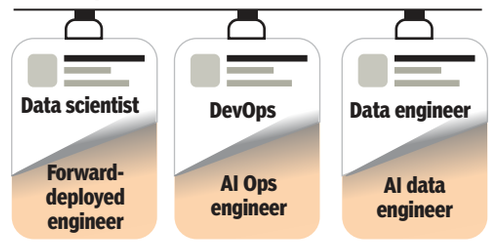


FORTY ROLES: Over 2,500 AI job postings **boil down to 40 distinct roles.** Here are **eight,** and what firms should do about each

Role	Buy	Build	Retain	Watch
Forward-deployed strategist	✓			
Forward-deployed engineer	✓			
AI engineer		✓		
AI architect		✓		
AI data engineer			✓	
AI delivery owner			✓	
Full-stack developer			✓	
AI FinOps				✓

Note
Buy: scarce, pay the premium;
Build: hire and train at scale;
Retain: keep them from leaving;
Watch: emerging

Promote from within: Each of the 40 jobs has a parent portfolio already on tech SIs' books. **Buying in the top-end ones costs up to 35% more than the nearest traditional role**



Source: BCG, The talent is already on your payroll. The clock isn't, Oct 2026

Darius Khambata to leave Tata Trusts

One Of Chairman Noel Tata's Closest Allies Says 'Independence Comes At A Cost'

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Mumbai: Darius Khambata, one of Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata's closest allies, will leave the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) and Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) when his term ends on Nov 8. In a four-page letter dated Nov 2 to Noel and Trusts CEO Siddharth Sharma, Khambata said he would not seek another term, even though both wanted him to stay. He wrote he was "saddened by the current divide" between Noel and N Chandrasekaran, chairman of Tata Sons, in which the two trusts are majority shareholders.

Reappointment needs the consent of fellow trustees, and he said it was "not in my character to seek" it. "That independence comes at a cost," he wrote. He said his stand had at times differed from others, including Noel's.

His exit narrows the boards at a tense moment. SDTT will have five trustees: Noel, Venu Srinivasan, Vijay Singh, Neville Tata, Bhaskar Bhat. SRTT will have four: Noel, Srinivasan, Jimmy Tata, Jehangir H C Jehangir.

At SRTT, Khambata's term lapses automatically. The Maharashtra Charity Commissioner has barred the trust from changing its board while it investigates alleged breaches of public trust law. SRTT can neither appoint trustees nor renew tenures. At SDTT, reappointment needs unanimous approval, which would prove contentious.

The Nov 2 letter is the clearest account of Khambata's thinking. He said he was the first trustee to warn against the Tata Sons listing, calling it "existential" for the Trusts at a May 2025 meeting. He said he drafted the July 28, 2025 resolution, passed unanimously, that reaffirmed opposition to a listing while backing a liquidity solution for minority Tata Sons shareholder, Shapoorji Pallonji Group. The resolution also reposed trust in Chandrasekaran to engage with the RBI on Tata Sons' application for deregistration. Khambata said he did not believe that engagement had been meaningful, much less successful. A second resolution on July 28, 2025, backing a third term for Chandrasekaran as chairman, had since been "overtaken by the astounding events of Aug and Sept 2026," he wrote.

He also criticised those who "would decouple Tata Sons from the Trusts", calling the group a "national treasure in which neither limb is meaningful without the other." Khambata wrote that the "sad events" of Sept 17, "a day that will live in infamy", had "sullied Tata Sons' reputation". At the Tata Sons board meeting that day, Chandrasekaran was reappointed chairman for another five years. Noel opposed the move.

Khambata defended his vote on Sept 11, 2025, when he joined Mehli Mistry, Pramit Jhaveri and Jehangir in opposing Singh's continuation as a Trusts nominee director on Tata Sons board. The move prompted allegations that the four trustees were attempting a "coup".

Khambata had called that "absurd" in a Nov 10, 2025 letter and blamed a media-driven narrative.

In his latest letter, he said the Sept 11, 2025 vote was meant to strengthen opposition to any listing and that later events vindicated it. In April 2026, he said, Singh and Srinivasan told the media they favoured listing, despite having supported Trusts resolutions against one. Neither had explained the shift to fellow trustees, he said. That vote preserved Trusts' effective veto at Tata Sons by keeping Noel as their key representative on the board. Under Tata Sons' articles, he said, the veto works by a majority of the Trusts' nominee directors. The Sept 17 event showed how critical that was, he wrote.

Khambata said the Supreme Court judgment in Tata Sons v Cyrus Mistry validated the Trusts' special rights in the articles and the special duties of Trusts nominee directors. He said it was now untenable to argue that a nominee director who is a sitting trustee can act against the Trust's interests merely because he also owes a duty to the company.

Fault lines within the Trusts have deepened over the past year. Noel, Srinivasan and Singh blocked Mehli's reappointment to SDTT and SRTT in Oct 2025. Jhaveri did not seek another term at SDTT and left in Feb.

Khambata said he seconded Noel's appointment as chairman in Oct 2024 and was glad Mehli proposed it despite pressure to defer.

Khambata emerged as one of Noel's most important supporters as friction between Trusts and the Tata Sons board grew. People familiar with the matter said his imprint has been visible in Trusts' press releases and correspondence with the Tata Sons board. A senior advocate, Khambata first joined the Trusts in 2014 and resigned in Oct 2016, a day after Cyrus Mistry was ousted as Tata Sons chairman. His second stint began in Nov 2023.

KHAMBATA OPPOSED TATA SONS LISTING

- On Sept 11, 2025, four trustees across SDTT and SRTT, including **Khambata,** voted not to renew Vijay Singh's tenure as Trusts nominee director of Tata Sons. It was to secure a stronger opposition to listing
- Khambata said the four "suffered a sustained media campaign designed to discredit us"

- In April 2026, Singh and Venu Srinivasan told the media they favoured listing, contrary to unanimous resolutions they had been party to, without telling co-trustees
- Khambata said the Sept 11, 2025 decision "stood vindicated" because it saved the Trusts' veto for Noel Tata

Powered by RIL surge, sensex rallies 1.2k pts

Benchmark Hits 7-Week High After Index Heavyweight Jumps 12% On Bright Q2 Show

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: Reliance Industries' strong results announced on Friday evening, lifted investor sentiment on Dalal Street on Monday with the sensex opening over 700 points higher. After witnessing a sustained buying trend through the session, the benchmark index closed 1,233 points or 1.3% up at 75,693 points with Reliance's stock alone adding about 750 points, more than half of sensex's gain for the day. On NSE, Nifty closed 388 points or 1.7% at 23,441 points.

Sensex closed above the 75K level after nearly two months. At the close of Monday's session, RIL ended nearly 12% up, adding about Rs 1.8 lakh crore to its shareholders' wealth in just one session. RIL's 11.6% gain was its biggest single-session jump in the stock since April 7, 2020, when at the start of the Covid pandemic it had announced selling a 9.9% stake in Jio Platforms to global social media giant Meta.

The day's Rs 1.8-lakh-crore gain in RIL's market cap was the biggest single-session gain for a company ever, data from ETintelligence showed. In July 2023, HDFC Bank's market cap had jumped by over Rs 3 lakh crore in a single session. But that was the day after it merged HDFC, its parent, with itself and the merged stock started trading on the bourses.

The news that markets regulator Sebi had written to govt about the abolition of the long-term capital gains tax for foreign investors added to the positive sentiment on Monday, market players said. According to Vinod Nair, head of research, Geojit Investments, the domestic markets opened the week on a firm footing, supported by better than estimated Q2 earnings by corporates and improving domestic cues.

"Domestic macro indicators provided an additional boost to sentiment with Oct passenger-vehicle sales growth reflecting healthy festive demand, while gross GST collections increased, reinforcing the resilience of domestic consumption and economic activity. Global cues were also supportive, with softer crude oil prices and renewed US-Iran diplomatic efforts helping ease concerns around energy costs and geopolitical risks."

There are also talks that with the AI rally facing severe headwinds, the Indian market may again turn attractive to foreign fund managers which could, after about two years, again take leading Indian indices northward. The day's rally was aided by a Rs 3,115-crore net buying by foreign funds, data from NSE showed. On the other hand, domestic funds were net sellers at Rs 392 crore. The day's session added about Rs 8 lakh crore to investors' wealth with the market capitalisation of all the companies listed on the BSE now at Rs 482.3 lakh crore. Of the 30 sensex stocks, 23 closed higher, data showed.

US stocks rise

Wall Street's main indices climbed on Monday as oil prices tumbled more than 7% on hopes of a US-Iran peace deal, with investors also bracing for Tuesday's midterm elections.

RIL'S BIGGEST SINGLE-DAY GAINS

DATE	CLOSE PRICE*	% change
18-5-2009	266	21
15-7-1996	11	15
25-3-2020	488	14.6
31-10-2002	30	13
31-10-2008	155	13
19-4-2001	42	12
2-11-2026	**1,300**	**11.6**
2-2-1996	11	11.3

RIL LEADS BIGGEST SINGLE DAY M-CAP GAINS

COMPANY	DATE	MCAP (₹cr)	1-day change**
Reliance Industries	**2-11-2026**	**17,57,877**	**1,83,298**
Reliance Industries	29-1-2024	19,59,442	1,25,706
Reliance Industries	3-6-2024	20,44,084	1,09,367
Reliance Industries	10-12-2021	16,62,776	1,04,947

Compiled by: ETIntelligence.com (*Adjusted closing price in ₹) (**in ₹ cr)

NTT DATA to scale up Mangaluru workforce

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: NTT DATA plans to expand its Mangaluru workforce from around 900 employees currently to more than 2,500 by the end of 2027, giving a boost to Karnataka's efforts to develop technology hubs beyond Bengaluru.

The expansion plans were discussed at a meeting between NTT DATA's senior global leadership and Karnataka IT and BT minister **Priyank Kharge** in Bengaluru. The company, which entered Mangaluru through its acquisition of Niveus Solutions, sees the coastal city and Bengaluru as key hubs for building capabilities in artificial intelligence (AI), cloud and data.

Its expansion will focus on specialised capabilities across healthcare and life sciences, high technology, automotive, manufacturing, AI and data, moving beyond conventional IT services.

The company is also planning a campus in Mangaluru, which is expected to create opportunities for professionals with a combination of technology skills and domain expertise. The state govt said it would support the expansion through industry-aligned skilling, infrastructure development and partnerships with academic institutions.

The govt will also explore partnerships between NTT DATA and the state's startup and deep-tech ecosystem to develop technology solutions.

"Karnataka's next chapter of growth is being written beyond Bengaluru, and Mangaluru is leading that story," Kharge said. He added that the government viewed NTT DATA not just as an investor but as a partner in the state's development.

IndiGo hires 600 pilots, to add 400

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New Delhi: In the largest-ever hiring of cockpit crew by an Indian airline, IndiGo has onboarded 600 pilots in the first six months of this fiscal and is on track to add at least 400 by next March-end, say people in the know. The airline had committed to add pilots after witnessing an unprecedented schedule collapse last Dec. IndiGo had 5,700 pilots as on March 31, 2026, and this number rose to 6,300 by Sept-end.

The flight duty time limitation (FDTL, which regulates pilot duty norms) dispensation will end next March and IndiGo's CEO Willie Walsh said on Monday, in his first interaction with the media in this role, that the airline will have "more than enough pilots to meet the schedules that we have for the airline. We're confident that of fully complying with the FDTL regulations."

> Geopolitical situation is challenging. ATF (jet fuel) accounts for 32% of airlines' operating cost globally. In India, that figure is 40%. The concerning thing is the crack spread (price difference between a barrel of crude and petroleum products like ATF refined from it). Crude prices have not gone that high but premium on ATF pricing has risen
>
> — WILLIE WALSH, INDIGO CEO

A trained pilot, Walsh, who headed British Airways and International Air Transport Association before joining IndiGo this Aug, will spearhead the budget airline's international expansion over coming years, amid the challenges being faced by aviation industry globally. IndiGo, which used to be India's only profitable airline, has also flown into losses for the past few quarters.

"The geopolitical situation is challenging. Aviation turbine fuel accounts for 32% of airlines' operating cost globally. In India, that figure is higher at 40%. The concerning thing is the crack spread (price difference between a barrel of crude oil and the petroleum products like ATF refined from it). Crude prices have not gone that high but the premium on ATF pricing has risen. Luckily availability of ATF is not an issue in India, which exports jet fuel," said Walsh.

Airlines have not fully passed on the hike in operating cost and have taken other measures like cutting capacity in the lean travel July-Sept quarter. Also, due to geopolitical reasons flights have been cut. Saudi flights are impacted right now, with IndiGo also cutting the same.

"No Indian carrier does fuel hedging. We are weighing that option for long hauls expansion. We expect to get our Airbus A350s from the second quarter of 2028. As of now we have four A321 XLRs (extra long range) and will get more of these planes next year," said Walsh. IndiGo has 60 A350s on firm order. "We will have a business class with 16 flat bed seats, premium economy and economy sections in the first 10 A350s. Then we will see whether to increase the number of business class seats in subsequent deliveries. I personally think there will be a case of doing so," said Walsh.

Govt listening to voices of concern in equity mkts: FM

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman has said govt is mindful of concerns among retail investors and equity market participants and will consider calls for policy support to the stock market, even as it seeks to sustain economic growth above 7%.

Sitharaman said the tax structure remained unchanged from FY24, when equity markets had seen strong inflows, but circumstances had since changed, with foreign institutional investors (FIIs) turning net sellers and concerns among market participants becoming louder. She said sustaining growth of over 7% required capital and govt was listening to demands for support to equity markets.

While govt had focused on developing the bond market over the past few years, she said there were now calls for similar attention to equity markets. "I do not want to say more at this point but I recognise the voice," she said at an event organised by Financial Express on Monday.

Sitharaman also said she was seeing a revival in private sector investment, with companies responding to visible demand following the rollout of NextGen GST reforms in Sept 2025. While businesses remained selective about sectors and investment opportunities, she said they were increasingly willing to expand capacity because they could see demand in the market.

> My request to business leaders and commentators is to speak about India's economic trajectory with confidence and optimism that accurately reflects ground realities
>
> —NIRMALA SITHARAMAN, FINANCE MINISTER

"Industry today has the confidence that I'm able to see demand in the market. I can invest and produce and therefore reach the level which I want to reach," she said. At another event, a fireside chat with Hitendra Dave, chief of HSBC India, Sitharaman said govt would continue to drive growth through public capital expenditure while maintaining fiscal discipline. She rejected suggestions that it should loosen spending constraints or disregard fiscal deficits and credit ratings to boost investment.

She said public capital expenditure had generated multiplier effects by creating productive assets and encouraging private investment. "Capital expenditure remains a core engine of our growth strategy. Sustained public capex creates productive assets and crowding-in effects for private investment," she said, adding that govt would continue to support economic momentum through high capital spending.

Sitharaman said fiscal consolidation and growth-inducing expenditure had to be balanced. "We will remain fiscally careful while staying creative and proactive in fostering sustainable economic growth," she said.

She also urged business leaders and commentators to reflect the strength of India's economic fundamentals in their assessment of the country's prospects. "My request to business leaders and commentators is to speak about India's economic trajectory with confidence and optimism that accurately reflects ground realities," she said.

OpenAI takes steps to widen ChatGPT's reach

Aabhas.Sharma & Manash.Gohain | TNN

New Delhi: OpenAI's push to reach more Indians starts with how they ask a question. Users who go straight to ChatGPT's dictation button rather than type are shaping the company's focus on voice, Hindi and other Indian languages, its India MD Prabhjeet Singh said.

India is already ChatGPT's largest consumer user market globally, according to Singh. Reaching a wider audience means making the service easier to use for people, who prefer speaking to typing, communicate in Indian languages or own entry-level smartphones. "Most of India actually doesn't use English as a primary. So real big focus is on Hindi and vernacular," Singh told TOI. Work on those capabilities through the year was beginning to show results, he said. Alongside expanding access, OpenAI is engaging with the govt on data protection, model safety and cybersecurity. Singh said the company was making its models available as part of discussions on protecting businesses and govt infrastructure.

"It is important that companies, govt infrastructure is protected against potential bad actors," he said. "So, I think we are making our models available at different levels of dialogue."

He described the discussions as constructive, but did not specify which models were being made available, the recipients or the arrangements involved. Constructive regulation could strengthen confidence among consumers and enterprises and support wider adoption, he said. For individual users, the challenge extends beyond language. Singh said OpenAI was working to ensure that smartphones with limited memory could deliver the full model experience. ChatGPT Go was introduced with affordability in mind.

The company is also looking beyond programmers and office workers. Singh cited traders using ChatGPT to create customised festive messages for customers and single-person shops exploring help with marketing and inventory management — tasks for which larger businesses can employ dedicated teams. He did not provide figures showing how widely small businesses were using these tools or the savings they had achieved.

Mfg growth eases in Oct: PMI survey

New Delhi: Moderation in output and fresh orders eased activity in the manufacturing sector in Oct, even as export orders rose at their fastest pace in six months. HSBC India manufacturing purchasing managers' index (PMI) released Monday — a high frequency indicator used to gauge the activity levels in the sector — came at 54.7 in Oct from 55.1 in Sept.

The headline figure remained well above the neutral 50 mark — which separates contraction in the sector from expansion — and above its long-term average, with the output growth easing primarily because of slower expansion among intermediate goods manufacturers, the survey said.

On export front, companies reported gains from a broad range of destinations, including Bangladesh, Canada, Indonesia, Oman, Saudi Arabia, Sri Lanka, the UK, US and UAE. TNN

Govt assures Scotch importers of FTA benefits

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Amid problems faced by importers of Scotch in bulk form, commerce secretary Rajesh Agrawal on Monday assured industry representatives that India will stand by its commitment under the trade agreement with the UK and ensure that the duty concession is not affected.

At the heart of the controversy is the import of bulk Scotch, which accounts for 80% of the whisky shipments from the UK. Under the trade agreement, effective July 15, customs duty has been halved to 75% under the FTA, which is to be reduced to 40% in 10 years. Bulk imports are crucial for blending whisky in India and bottling. The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence has, however, been questioning the product classification of bulk whisky with the duty concession available to 220830 tariff line provided they are imported in containers bigger than two litres. Companies have been importing bulk Scotch under three HSN or product codes, 22083092, 22083093 and 22083099.

DRI is examining whether imports under heading 2208 covering spirits and whisky should be used or it should be 2106, which relates to food preparations that are not included elsewhere. Industry is arguing that classification under heading 2106 will render the duty concession meaningless. It has demanded that the tariff concession should be available to finished whisky as well as bulk Scotch.

Industry seeks clarity on bulk Scotch duty concessions under India-UK pact

Govt officials said that the commerce and revenue departments will seek to address industry concerns in the coming weeks. "The ministry of commerce and industry today assured the Indian Alcobev industry that the ambiguity surrounding the current HSN code classification for bulk Scotch imports will soon be resolved...The aim is to resolve the situation fully in due time and to maintain business continuity for companies in the sector," the Confederation of Indian Alcoholic Beverage Companies said after a meeting with commerce secretary Rajesh Agrawal.

Razorpay gets GIFT City payments licence

Bengaluru: Razorpay has received a final licence from the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) to operate as a payment service provider in GIFT City, enabling it to handle cross-border money transfers and support platforms offering overseas investments to Indian residents. The approval follows an in-principle nod in April. The company said its infrastructure in GIFT City, Gujarat's international financial centre, was ready, with banking connections established with RBL Bank and ICICI Bank. Investment platforms using the service are expected to go live soon. TNN

FM junks allegations of favouritism to select grps

▶ Continued from page 1

She was responding to a question on the govt's reaction to Congress LOP Rahul Gandhi's allegations that it was attempting to destabilise the Tata Group.

Rahul has accused the Modi govt of attempting to "criminally destroy" the group and treating Indian businesses as political playthings amid the dispute between Tata Trusts, which own the holding company, and Tata Sons, which owns the operating businesses.

FM also rejected allegations of govt favouritism towards select corporate groups, pointing out that industrial houses targeted in parliamentary criticism were also welcomed and courted for investment by opposition-governed states such as Karnataka and Telangana.

On 23% growth in GST collections during Oct, she rejected suggestions that high revenues merely reflected a rise in imports (which had risen 42%). She said most imports comprised essential raw materials and intermediate goods required by domestic manufacturers to meet export demand.

The minister also rejected allegations that govt was creating instability or undermining democratic processes. She said opposition parties could not have legitimately won elections and formed govts in Karnataka, Telangana and Himachal Pradesh if elections were compromised or regime changes were possible only through street agitation. She criticised the opposition for holding mock parliaments outside legislatures and walking out of legislative debates instead of using their constitutional mandate.

With around 100 elected MPs, she said, the opposition should engage in debates on the floor of the House rather than walk out when govt's responses challenged its claims.

TIMES SPORT

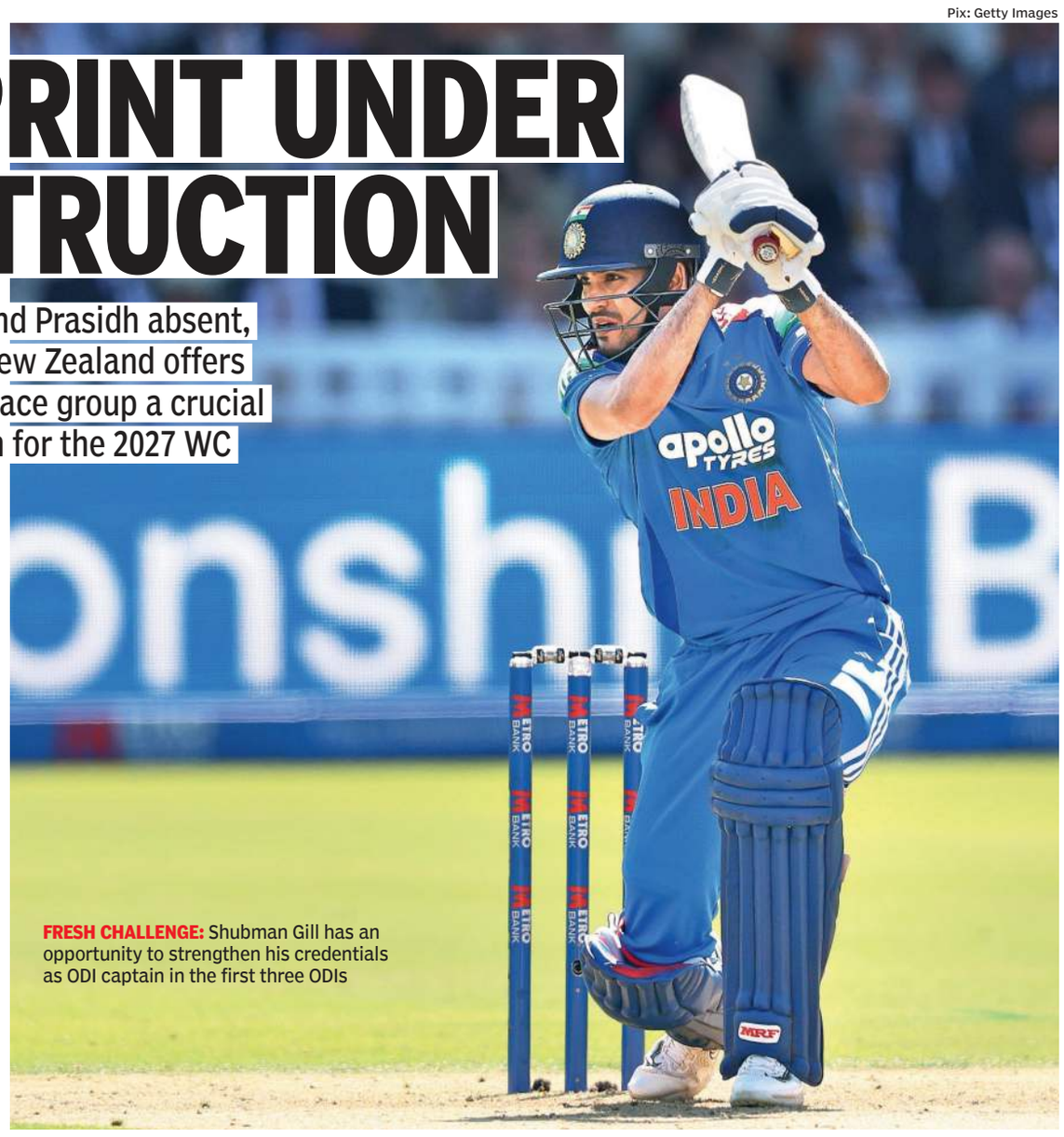
THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 3, 2026

VENUS WILLIAMS TAKING IT 'ONE WEEK AT A TIME' AFTER 17TH LOSS IN A ROW AT HK OPEN

CARLOS ALCARAZ BELIEVES BATTLE AT THE TOP IN 2027 WILL BE MORE THAN A TWO-HORSE RACE

Pix: Getty Images

BLUEPRINT UNDER CONSTRUCTION



FRESH CHALLENGE: Shubman Gill has an opportunity to strengthen his credentials as ODI captain in the first three ODIs

With Bumrah, Hardik and Prasidh absent, the five-ODI series in New Zealand offers India's inexperienced pace group a crucial chance to stake a claim for the 2027 WC

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India have a fair idea of what their ideal ODI bowling attack should look like. What remains uncertain is who, beyond the established names, will fill the remaining pieces of the puzzle.

Jasprit Bumrah remains India's undisputed spearhead, while Mohammed Siraj is the closest thing to a settled second seamer. Beyond that, however, the pecking order is far from finalised. Arshdeep Singh's left-arm variety has made him a proven force in T20Is, but he is still relatively untested in the 50-over format. Gurnoor Brar is only beginning to find his feet, while India's search for a reliable pace-bowling all-rounder capable of easing the dependence on Hardik Pandya remains unresolved.

That is why the five-match ODI series against New Zealand, beginning in Auckland on Wednesday, carries significance far beyond a routine bilateral contest. With the 2027 ODI World Cup in South Africa now less than a year away, India are running out of opportunities to answer some critical questions about their bowling resources.

The absence of Bumrah and Pandya from the tour has already shifted greater responsibility onto a young attack. The blow was compounded by Prasidh Krishna's hamstring injury, ruling out a bowler widely viewed as a near-certain World Cup pick, especially given the fact that he is a tall, hit-the-deck bowler, the kind that does well on pitches in South Africa.

IND VS NZ ODI SERIES

Siraj, with 51 ODIs behind him, becomes the senior figure in the pace unit. Around him are bowlers rich in promise but short on experience. Arshdeep has played just 18 ODIs, Gurnoor only nine, while Auqib Nabi and Anshul Kamboj are still trying to establish themselves at the international level.

Head coach Gautam Gambhir was unusually frank when he described the group as potentially India's "most inexperienced ODI bowling attack". His assessment also underscored the importance of the assignment. If India prosper in New Zealand, it will be because this attack has risen to the challenge in conditions not traditionally in India's comfort zone.

Beyond evaluating individuals, India must identify specialists for every phase of an ODI innings: new-ball operators, middle-overs enforcers, bowlers who can bowl dry and death-bowling finishers. Equally important is finding combinations that can succeed in conditions similar to those expected in South Africa.

And when one talks about weaknesses, the seam-bowling all-rounder question springs up. Nitish Kumar Reddy has emerged as a possible backup to Hardik and in the T20Is, one saw him bowl the difficult overs and with increased pace and effectiveness, but with only eight ODIs and limited evidence of his effectiveness as a fifth bowling option, he remains a work in progress. .

The batting unit, though, gives greater comfort and offers greater certainty. Questions around Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli's future have gradually given way to discussions on how best to maximise their experience. Shubman Gill, meanwhile, has an opportunity to strengthen his credentials as ODI captain, leading in the first three matches before Shreyas Iyer takes charge for the final two as Gill prepares for Tests.

For India, this tour is less about immediate results and more about gaining much-needed clarity. The World Cup blueprint is taking shape. The bowlers now have five matches to prove they belong in it. "If we do well in the One-day series, the credit will go to this bowling attack. When you come overseas, your bowlers win the series," Gambhir stressed.

India have three ODIs against Sri Lanka in Dec and another three against Zimbabwe in Jan. But those games are in Indian conditions which are vastly different from South Africa. If the team has to identify weaknesses and address them, it has to be here, in New Zealand.

India 'A' concede innings advantage

Christchurch: Pacer **Mohammed Siraj** warmed up for the upcoming two-Test series with four wickets in 35 overs for India 'A' but New Zealand 'A's lower order showed a lot of grit to earn a 78-run first innings lead on the penultimate day of the second unofficial 'Test' here.

Replying to India 'A's first innings score of 346, New Zealand 'A', who were reduced to 338 for 8, finished their first innings at 424. The last two wickets yielded 86 runs to provide the hosts a handy lead.

Speedster Siraj took 4/118 in 35 overs while seamer Mukesh Kumar grabbed 5 for 87 in 29 overs to share the bulk of the spoils.

At stumps, India A reached 32 for no loss in their second innings with Yashasvi Jaiswal (20 batting) and Sai Sudharsan (11 batting) negotiating the remaining 11 overs of the day safely. For the Indian senior team support staff, Siraj adding miles to his legs at a venue where the team will play the second Test against New Zealand is certainly a big positive. The Test series against the Black Caps begins on November 19.

Bowling 35 overs is the kind of workout that head coach Gautam Gambhir and Morne Morkel would be pleased with before Siraj links up with the ODI squad at the end of this game.

He looked sharp even with the old ball and was incisive with the new one. His seam bowling partner Mukesh was good with both the first and second new ball but not so much when the Kookaburra became semi-new and subsequently old. Siraj got a wicket with his very first delivery on the third morning.

It was the second over of the day and overnight centurion Matthew Boyle (110, 152 balls) got one that shaped away after pitching and Devdutt Padikkal dived full stretch to his left to snap it up.

This was after adding 208 runs for the fourth wicket with Dean Foxcroft (93, 226 balls), who, on Monday, earned a call-up to national ODI squad for last two games against India.

Foxcroft's near six-hour vigil ended after India got the second new ball. Siraj got this third breakthrough with a sharp in-cutter that found the batter plumb in-front of the stumps.

From 270 for 4, New Zealand A collapsed to 291 for 7 at tea with Mukesh once again showing his prowess with the new ball. An outswinger forced Mitch Hay (31) to nick one to Dhruv Jurel behind the stumps. Siraj then got Brett Randell (5) with a beauty. He bowled a few away going deliveries followed by an in-cutter that went above the stumps beating him completely.

Brief Scores: India 'A' 346 & 32 for no loss (Yashasvi Jaiswal 20 batting). **NZ 'A' 424** (Matthew Boyle 110, Dean Foxcroft 93, Mukesh Kumar 5-87, Mohammed Siraj 4-118). PTI

Pant's fitness test on Nov 9

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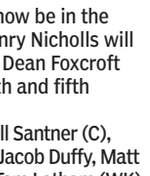
New Delhi: **Rishabh Pant** is set to undergo his match simulation test at the Centre of Excellence (CoE) on Nov 9 before he is cleared to play in the two-Test series in New Zealand, which starts on Nov 19. Pant, who is recovering from a side strain injury, has started his cricketing drills at the CoE.



TOI understands that the CoE on Saturday evening had shared an email with the Indian team management and the selection committee, updating them about the injury status of Pant, Prasidh Krishna and Harshit Rana. Interestingly, Team India head coach Gautam Gambhir on Sunday claimed he had no update on Pant.

"Pant started light training this weekend. The initial plan was to conduct his simulation test by coming weekend. It had to be pushed back because of Diwali. If cleared Pant will fly to New Zealand. The team needs a player of Pant's stature to play the Tests if he clears test on Monday," BCCI source told TOI. It is also learnt that Rana, who has been picked in India 'A' squad for the Rising Stars Asia Cup, is due to be cleared from CoE on Tuesday.

CHAPMAN, RAVINDRA RULED OUT OF INDIA ODIS

Auckland: Batters Mark Chapman and Rachin Ravindra have been ruled out of the five-match ODI series against India starting on Wednesday as they have failed to recuperate from their respective injuries, New Zealand Cricket said on Monday. Chapman is undergoing rehabilitation for his hamstring injury while Ravindra is yet to recover from his shoulder niggle.

RACHIN RAVINDRA

Tim Seifert, who was selected for the fourth and fifth ODIs, will now be in the squad for the full series, while Henry Nicholls will come in for the first three games. Dean Foxcroft has been pencilled in for the fourth and fifth match of the series.

Squad for first three games: Mitchell Santner (C), Michael Bracewell, Devon Conway, Jacob Duffy, Matt Fisher, Matt Henry, Kyle Jamieson, Tom Latham (WK), Daryl Mitchell, Henry Nicholls, Glenn Phillips Tim Seifert, Nathan Smith, Will Young, Blair Tickner.

Last two games: Mitchell Santner (C), Finn Allen, Michael Bracewell, Kristian Clarke, Jacob Duffy, Matt Fisher, Dean Foxcroft, Lockie Ferguson, Mitch Hay (WK), Nick Kelly, Tim Seifert (WK), Blair Tickner, Will Young. PTI

Harsh on Bumrah to say he's picking and choosing matches: Bond

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JASPRIT BUMRAH

With a packed international calendar forcing teams to constantly juggle workloads and preparation, both India and New Zealand have taken steps to keep their key bowlers fresh for the upcoming Test series that will conclude a tour stretching beyond 40 days. Several frontline players were released from the final two ODIs to focus on red-ball cricket, while India opted not to include Jasprit Bumrah in the ODI squad, allowing him to concentrate exclusively on the Tests.

In an interview with **TOI**, former New Zealand pace great Shane Bond discussed the challenges of player management, the value of ODI cricket as Test preparation, and the recurring debate surrounding Bumrah's availability. *Excerpts:*

How challenging is it to navigate tight schedules, player availability and preparation?

It's a challenge. When I look back at my playing days, the best players in a country would generally play two formats, sometimes all three. The schedule was never as congested as it is now. If you were in the New Zealand team, you were among the best 11, 12 or 13 cricketers in the country. Today, you often see two Indian teams playing simultaneously. New Zealand, too, can field very different squads around the world depending on the schedule.

Both teams have split squads for the ODI series. Is that the right approach when turnaround times are short?

It's simply part of modern cricket. Personally, I always enjoyed playing One-day cricket before a Test series because, as a bowler, you spent three-and-a-half hours on your feet and delivered 10 overs at high intensity. I felt it was ideal preparation because a two-hour Test session suddenly seemed relatively short. The only challenge was handling those extra overs.

Does match time still trump net practice as preparation?

Absolutely. Nothing replicates time spent on your feet in a match. You can do all the training and net sessions you want, but it doesn't compare to standing in the field, running from fine leg to mid-on and maintaining that intensity for six hours. That's the kind of preparation players need, not just bowling in the nets.

Does it make sense for Jasprit Bumrah to skip the ODIs ahead of the Test series?

There's often a perception that players are simply picking and choosing what they want to play. I don't think that's the case at all. Experienced bowlers understand their bodies very well. They're constantly discussing their workloads with medical staff and coaches, assessing what they can physically handle. The biggest risk period is always when a player is returning from injury and readjusting to competitive cricket. That's why I think it's pretty harsh on Booms (Bumrah) to suggest he's picking and choosing.

Does workload management become even more important with the ODI World Cup next year?

It applies not just to Booms but to every player. India play an enormous amount of cricket, so managing workloads is essential. You want your best players fit, fresh and ready when the World Cup arrives next Oct or Nov. Every major cricket nation is trying to achieve the same balance, especially with the demands of both international and franchise cricket.

Is that realistic given the packed Future Tours Programme?

It's extremely difficult. Australia, for example, are currently in South Africa before heading home, and then they have a four-Test series against New Zealand. They're working hard to protect their fast bowlers. New Zealand, too, want their best pace attack available for that Australia tour. It's a constant challenge for coaches, trainers and support staff around the world.

What is your assessment of India's current pace attack?

I'm a huge fan of Mohammed Siraj. I love his energy and body language. He's been performing consistently across formats for a long time. India have a very well-balanced attack. The one thing they perhaps lack is a left-arm fast bowler, but they've got height, pace and skill. They hit the seam hard and, importantly, they have depth.

Even someone like Auqib Nabi has come through and looks a quality bowler. Akash Deep is a good bowler too. As a coach, Gautam Gambhir will want enough options to rest and rotate players, and India certainly have that luxury.

Abhishek, Vaibhav in India 'A' squad

India opener Abhishek Sharma and teenage batting sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi were on Monday named in a strong 15-member India 'A' squad for the ACC Men's Rising Stars Asia Cup to be held in Doha from Nov 19 to 29. Tilak Varma will lead the side with Rajat Patidar his deputy. India A have been placed in Group B alongside Pakistan 'A', Nepal and the United Arab Emirates, while Group A comprises Bangladesh 'A', Sri Lanka 'A', Afghanistan 'A' and Hong Kong, China. India 'A' will open their campaign against Nepal on November 20 before taking on Pakistan 'A' on Nov 22.

Squad: Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Prabhsimran Singh (wk), Tilak Varma (c), Rajat Patidar (vc), Rinku Singh, Kumar Kushagra (wk), Suryansh Shedge, Shahbaz Ahmed, Vipraj Nigam, Harsh Dubey, Tanush Kotian, Harshit Rana, Prince Yadav, Arshad Khan. PTI

JUDOKA KHUSHBU STRIKES SILVER

Dakar (Senegal): Teenager Khushbu Rajakbhai signed off with a silver medal after becoming only the second Indian judoka to reach the podium at the Youth Olympic Games here on Monday. Khushbu, 15, settled for silver in the women's 63kg category after losing to Germany's Jolina Reinhold by ippon in a contest that lasted just 48 seconds. The Gujarat judoka had scripted a dream run to the final, raising hopes of a historic gold, but ran into a formidable opponent in Cadet world champion Reinhold, who proved too strong in the title clash. Thangjam Tababi Devi remains India's only other judo medallist at the Youth Olympics, having won silver in the women's 44kg category at the 2018 edition in Buenos Aires, Argentina. PTI

Bengaluru's Dhinidhi bags historic bronze

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Bengaluru: Indian swimming has a new milestone to celebrate, and Bengaluru talent **Dhinidhi Desinghu** is at the heart of it. The 16-year-old became the first swimmer from the country to win a medal at the Youth Olympic Games, claiming bronze in the women's 100m freestyle in Dakar, Senegal, on Monday.

YOUTH OLYMPICS

While Dhinidhi had set her sights on gold and a sub-55-second finish, her podium finish was a historic achievement for Indian swimming. Croatia's Ana Bobanovic took gold in 55.89 seconds, while New Zealand's Alyssa Lawson claimed silver in 56.13 seconds.

The performance had been building momentum from the heats. Dhinidhi clocked 56.80 sec to finish third-fastest overall and become the first Indian female swimmer to qualify for a Youth Olympics final. She carried that form into the final.

"I'm very happy but also at a loss for words. In the heats, my timing went below 57. I've never had a time below 57 in the event, and I knew something special would happen," she told TOI.

Going into the final, there was a mix of nerves and confidence. The conditions, too, worked in her favour. "Generally, when I swim outdoors, and it's hot and humid, I swim better, because the conditions are similar to what it is back home," she said.

The result, however, was initially not quite what she had hoped for. "When I touched the pad and saw the timing, I wasn't very happy. I wanted to win gold and I wanted my time to break 55, but didn't achieve either. But slowly it sank in – I am India's first swimmer to win a medal at the Youth Olympics and that does mean something special," added the teenager, who trains under Nihar Ameen.

The win's significance went beyond the medal itself. Dhinidi believes her podium finish is a breakthrough for women's swimming in the country. "I think what makes it more special is that it's a woman who has given India its first medal in swimming in the competition. It will mean a lot for women's swimming because we're not at the same level as the men. This will make it a memorable chapter in women's swimming in our country and help in the growth of our sport," she said.

She is the third Indian to reach a final at the competition, after two-time Olympian Srihari Nataraj, who made the final in 2018, and Tirthank Pegu, who is competing in the ongoing edition.

But milestones are nothing new to her. Dhinidhi was just 14 when she made her Olympic debut at Paris 2024, becoming the youngest member of the Indian contingent. She had also represented India at the 2022 Asian Games in Hangzhou and the 2024 World Aquatics Championships in Doha.

For now, the triumph is still sinking in. "It (medal) will take some time to sink in. After Paris, it took a couple of years to sink in that I was an Olympian. So, it is safe to say this will take a long time to sink in," she signed off.

India feast on goals

Hockey India

ON A ROLL: Indian players celebrate a goal on Monday

Home Team To Face South Korea Again In Semis

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Jalandhar: Unbeaten India finished the league phase of the Asian Champions Trophy with an 8-0 win over South Korea here on Monday.

Dilpreet Singh (8th, 40th minutes) scored a brace, while Jugraj Singh (11), Harmanpreet Singh (15), Shilanand Lakra (33), Sukhjeet Singh (34), Sanjay Rana (36) and Angad Bir Singh (60) added a goal each. India topped the league with five wins and will again meet South Korea in the semifinals. Malaysia will take on Japan in the other last-four contest as the action shifts to Mohali.

ACT HOCKEY

India built early pressure, with Sukhjeet creating chances. The breakthrough came in the opening quarter when Jarmanpreet Singh sliced through the Korean defence and Dilpreet Singh beat goalkeeper Kim Jaehyeon with a reverse flick.

India doubled the lead with Jugraj converting a penalty corner. Skipper Harmanpreet added another in the 15th minute. India carried the momentum into the second quarter, keeping up their attacking intensity and possession control.

Despite Korea's attempts to fight back, India's defensive organisation and superior ball control kept them in command with a three-goal cushion at half-time.

India made it one-sided in the third quarter with four more goals. Shilanand opened the scoring for the quarter, finishing a penalty corner variation involving Harmanpreet and Jugraj from near the post.

The fifth goal came from strong team coordination, with Harmanpreet's long pass finding Aditya Lalage, who set up Sukhjeet for a simple deflection.

The home team showed no signs of slowing down as Shilanand set up Dilpreet, whose effort the goalkeeper stopped before Sanjay converted the rebound for 6-0. Sanjay then turned provider, controlling Harmanpreet's aerial pass and driving forward before Dilpreet's stick touch made it 7-0. Angad rounded off the tally just before the final whistle.

Other results: China: 1 (Chen Benhai 2) drew with Bangladesh: 1 (Ashraful Islam 38); Japan: 2 (Kentaro Fukuda 24, 54) bt Malaysia: 1 (Abu Kamal Azrai 10).

Under pressure Carrick's United set for Roma test

London: **Michael Carrick** brushed off suggestions he has just two games left as Manchester United boss as he prepares his underperforming side for Tuesday's Champions League clash against Roma.

Carrick's position at Old Trafford is increasingly precarious following Saturday's 2-0 defeat at Chelsea, which extended United's winless run in all competitions to nine games — they last had a longer such sequence in 1984.

CHAMPIONS LEAGUE

Former United and England midfielder Carrick was asked at his pre-match press conference on Monday whether he felt he had just two games remaining at the helm — against Roma and Aston Villa. The Villa match on Sunday comes just before an international break, potentially giving the United hierarchy an opportunity to make a managerial change.

"No, not at all," said the 45-year-old, in his first full season in charge. "If you look into the future, you never know what's going to happen. That doesn't change the way I feel, how we're preparing for the game tomorrow." Carrick also said he had "no concerns" over the commitment of out-of-form Argentine centre-back Lisandro Martinez, who was sent off in United's defeat at Stamford Bridge. **Tonight's matches:** Shakhtar Donetsk vs Sporting CP, Galatasaray vs Stuttgart, Atletico Madrid vs Bayern Munich, Barcelona vs Aston Villa, Feyenoord vs Inter Milan, Bodo/Glimt vs Lille, LASK vs Slovan Bratislava, Man United vs Roma, PSG vs Villareal. Live on Sony Network from 11.15 pm. AGENCIES

Arsenal claim top spot

Liverpool: Champions Arsenal moved three points clear at the top of the Premier League with Kai Havertz's early goal securing a statement 1-0 victory over Liverpool at Anfield on Sunday. German striker Havertz tapped in from Declan Rice's low cross in the 16th minute after the hosts were caught trying to play the ball out of their defence.

FOOTBALL

Liverpool responded strongly as halftime approached with Florian Wirtz curling a free kick against the crossbar and Alexis Mac Allister heading a good chance over the bar. But Arsenal weathered the storm and defended superbly to keep Liverpool largely at arm's length after the break and seal their first Premier League win at Anfield for 14 years. **Results: EPL:** Liverpool 0 lost to Arsenal 1 (Havertz 16). AGENCIES

SNAP SHOTS

Srikanth pulls out of polls

Ace shuttler Kidambi Srikanth on Monday withdrew his candidature from the Indian Olympic Association's (IOA) Athletes' Commission polls, leaving 10 contestants in the fray for the election of nine members. Olympic medallists PV Sindhu and Mirabai Chanu are among the strong candidates for membership of the Athletes' Commission in the elections, which will be held virtually on Tuesday.

Sutar to challenge Paes: Maharashtra State Lawn Tennis Association (MSLTA) president Prashant Sutar on Monday announced his candidature for the vice-president's post in the All India Tennis Association (AITA) elections on Nov 27, setting up a contest against Leander Paes.

Rain washes out opening day: Persistent rain forced a complete washout of the opening day of the main draw at the WTA 250 Chennai Open on Monday, with not a single match possible out of the 10 scheduled for the day.

Zverev's long wait for No. 1 ends: Alexander Zverev finally rose to the No. 1 spot in the men's tennis rankings on Monday, a reward for a dominant season during which he became a two-time Grand Slam champion.

Shelton adds Ferrero to his coaching staff: Carlos Alcaraz's former coach Juan Carlos Ferrero is joining Ben Shelton's coaching staff for the 2027 season. "Huge addition to my team for this upcoming season," the 24-year-old Shelton said Sunday on social media. Former world No. 1 Ferrero helped guide Alcaraz to his first six major titles before their partnership ended last December.

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ANTONELLI: 20 & A KING

Becomes Youngest World Champion, Ends Italy's 73-Year Wait

Kimi Antonelli became Formula One's youngest world champion and Italy's first since 1953 when he finished third behind multiple champions Max Verstappen and Lewis Hamilton in Sunday's thrilling and crash-hit Mexico City Grand Prix.

The 20-year-old Italian drove his Mercedes to a 16th podium finish of the season with a blend of audacity and professionalism that belied his age in a hotly contested race of two safety cars and a red flag stoppage.

FORMULA ONE

"Thank you so much, we did it," he said tearfully on the team radio on his slow-down lap as his esteemed race engineer Peter Bonnington told him it was "a pleasure to be on the journey with you, but it's just the first chapter".

Antonelli soon regained his composure and after thanking his family and Mercedes he added: "We did it. I am so grateful for this moment - and it is one I will live forever. I'm speechless, just trying to process what has happened. "It's been an incredible season and to share the podium with Max and Lewis is truly incredible. I felt more tense this weekend, but I am so happy we got it done."

At 20 years and 68 days old, he became the youngest champion by more than three years to four-time champion Sebastian Vettel and Italy's first since Alberto Ascari of Ferrari in 1953.

Getty Images

ON TOP OF THE WORLD: Kimi Antonelli celebrates in Mexico City

In a two-part race, divided by a 45-minute pause when Valtteri Bottas crashed heavily in his Cadillac, Red Bull's four-time champion came home 0.799 seconds ahead of seven-time champion Hamilton's Ferrari with Antonelli third 3.207 seconds adrift.

It was Verstappen's record-extending sixth win in Mexico, his third this year and the 74th of his career.

Charles Leclerc was fourth in the second Ferrari, after sparking race-long ill-feeling in his team with an opening lap tangle with team-mate Hamilton, who started on pole. "I think we had the pace to win today, but it wasn't meant to be and we'll take it offline and figure out what we can do in the background," said a visibly irritated Hamilton. "We have to hold some serious talks behind the scenes."

Outgoing world champion Lando Norris was fifth in his McLaren with Antonelli's Mercedes teammate George Russell, who needed to win the race to have any chance of stalling the Italian's sprint to the title, in sixth. They were followed home by Oscar Piastri in the second McLaren, Alpine's Franco Colapinto, Liam Lawson in the Racing Bull and Pierre Gasly in the second Alpine.

"The first start made the race for me," said Verstappen who charged from fifth to second on the opening lap. "We lacked some pace, but I hung in there and I was sweating at the end to keep Lewis behind." AFP

K'taka spinners floor Assam

Guwahati: Openers Rohan Patil and Mayank Agarwal made contrasting fifties after bowlers tore through the Assam line-up to give Karnataka early command on the first day of their Ranji Trophy Elite Group B match here on Monday.

Patil made a swift 89 off 87 balls (13x4, 1x6) while Mayank was more patient with his unbeaten 57 (95b) during their 129-run alliance in 24.3 overs.

It helped Karnataka cruise to 180/2 in 36 overs, with stumps drawn slightly early because of poor light.

KV Aneesh (7) was giving company to Mayank, and the

RANJI TROPHY

visitors lead by 45 runs after bundling out Assam for 135, who opted to bat in their first innings. Patil, playing his third match of the season, reached his 50 off 43 balls with a boundary off spinner Sarupam Purkayastha. His first 50 included a stunning 11 fours.

It was the 25-year-old left-hander's second 50 in as many innings after a 72 against Tripura at Mysuru.

Patil and Mayank, who brought up his 50 more sedately in 76 balls with a boundary off off-spinner Amlanjyoti Das, carried

TOI

FIVE STAR: Shikhar Shetty

Karnataka past Assam's feeble first innings total.

However, Karnataka lost Patil and wicketkeeper batter KL Shrijith in quick succession, but Mayank and Aneesh negated the remaining eight overs of the day without much trouble.

Earlier, Karnataka's spin duo of Ritesh Bhatkal and Shikhar Shetty shared all 10 Assam wickets among them to bowl out the hosts cheaply.

Off-spinner Bhatkal took five wickets for 35 runs, and left-arm orthodox spinner Shikhar claimed 5 for 53.

Sibsankar Roy was Assam's top-scorer with 37 off 66 balls before getting cleaned up by Bhatkal. Karnataka made one change to the squad, replacing medium pacer Vyshak Vijaykumar with Vidwath Kaverappa.

SCOREBOARD

Assam (I innings): Nibir Deka c Karun b Bhatkal 12, Pradyun Saikia b Bhatkal 13, Sumit Ghadigaonkar lbw Shikhar 1, Denish Das b Bhatkal 26, Sibsankar Roy b Bhatkal 37, Sarupam Purkayastha c Manvanth b Shikhar 13, Amlanjyoti Das c KArun b Shikhar 12, Roshan Alam lbw Bhatkal 7, Mukhtar Hussain c & b Shikhar 0, Mohit Thakur (not out) 0, Hridip Deka b Shikhar 1. **Extras** (B-12; LB-1) 13. **Total (Allout; 48.1 overs) 135**. **Fall of wickets:** 1-19, 2-20, 3-30, 4-93, 5-98, 6-121, 7-130, 8-130, 9-130. **Bowling**: Vidwath Kaverappa 3-1-9-0, Manvanth Kumar 6-3-15-0, Ritesh Bhatkal 18-4-35-5, Shikhar Shetty 17.1-4-53-5, Shreyas Gopal 4-0-10-0.
Karnataka (I innings): Rohan Patil c Roy b Das 89, Mayank Agarwal (batting) 57, KL Shrijith lbw Das 19, KV Aneesh (batting) 7. **Extras** (LB-5; NB-3) 8. **Total (2 wkts; 36 overs) 180. Fall of wickets**: 1-129, 2-157.
Bowling: Mukhtar Hussain 3-0-20-0, Mohit Thakur 8-0-39-0, Amlanjyoti Das 13-1-51-2, Hridip Deka 3-0-14-0, Sarupam Purkayastha 3-0-19-0, Roshan Alam 6-0-32-0.
Other Group 'B' scores: At Agartala: Tripura: 219/7 in 74.3 overs (Sridam Paul 86, Sentu Sarkar 46; Parth Bhut 3/52) vs **Saurashtra**. **At Mullanpur: Punjab: 276/5 in 80 overs** (Salil Arora 111 batting, Sanvir Singh 100 batting; K Saiteja 3/65) vs **Andhra**. **At Secunderabad: Chhattisgarh: 279/7 in 87 overs** (Anuj Tiwary 72, Vikalp Tiwari 69; Rakshan Readdi 2/34) vs **Hyderabad**. AGENCIES

State girls storm into final

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Karnataka girls claimed a thrilling 55-51 win over Kerala to enter the final of the Youth National Basketball Championship in Pune. For the winners, Mahek Sharma top-scored with 14 points. **Results (Semis): Girls:** Karnataka 55 (Mahek Sharma 19, HS Shreshta 13, Vibha SM 8) bt Kerala 51 (Subhadra Jayakumar 14, Akshara K 13, Malavika V 8).

BANGALORE CITY WIN

Ishaan Mittal and Chandan SA scored to help Bangalore City FC edge past Technico FF 2-1 in the KSFA Super Division football league championships in Bengaluru on Monday. In another match, Kodagu FC defeated Rebels FC 3-1. **Results:** Bangalore City FC 2 (Ishaan Mittal 51, Chandan SA 7) bt Technico FF 1 (Suyash Koshy 11); Kodagu FC 3 (Tanish Singhvi 36-og, Muhammed Unais M 74, Jithu 90) bt Rebels FC 1 (RS Jlcis 59); United Stars FC drew with SCB 0. **Today's matches:** ASC FC vs Roots FC (11am); FC Agniputhra vs FCBU (1.30pm); SUFC vs HAL FC (4pm).

ALVAN STARS FOR BALDWIN

Baldwin Boys' High School rode on Alvan Wilbert's double to claim a 2-1 win over Ebenezer International School in the U-14 category of the Baldwin Shield inter-school football tournament in Bengaluru on Monday.

Results: U-12: Baldwin Boys' HS 0 lost to FAPS 2 (Krithik 10, Zaid 17); Bishop Cotton BS 1 (Dishan Vegi 10) bt St Joseph's Boys' HS 0. **U-14:** Baldwin Boys' HS 2 (Alvan Wilbert 7, 11) bt Ebenezer IS 1 (Chinmaya 12); Bishop

ROUND-UP

Cotton BS 1 (Adnam Baig 28) bt St Joseph's Boys' HS 0. **U-16:** St Joseph's Boys' HS 3 (Diveth 15, Jonathan Jude 20, Renith Vivan 26) bt Cathedral HS 1 (Monish 6); FAPS 1 (Jeremiah 3) drew with Bishop Cotton BS 1 (Mohammed Zahid 10).

KSLTA ADOPTS NATIONAL SPORTS GOVERNANCE ACT

Karnataka State Lawn Tennis Association (KSLTA) adopted the National Sports Governance Act, 2025, following a unanimous resolution at its Extraordinary General Meeting (EGM) held in Bengaluru. KSLTA's move follows the All India Tennis Association's (AITA) adoption of amendments to its Constitution on July 26, 2026, to align with the new legislation, making it one of the first National Sports Federations in the country to do so.

KATARKI ELECTED CHAIRMAN

Arvind S Katarki was unanimously elected chairman and senior steward of the Bangalore Turf Club for 2026-27 at a meeting of the Managing Committee of BTC members held on Monday.

FORMER FOOTBALLER PASSES AWAY

Former Karnataka footballer C Ramachandra, 73, passed away in Bengaluru on Sunday. The goalkeeper, who represented Mysore in the state junior national football championship in 1973-74, also played for Reserve Bank of India and KSRTC, among other teams.

Thosha stars for Neptune

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Thosha S (5/29) stole the limelight as Neptune Cricket Club recently claimed a six-wicket win over Jayanagar United Cricketers in the KSCA U-14 inter-club tournament here.

Batting first, Jayanagar were restricted to 141 all out in 38.3 overs as Thosha picked up a five-wicket haul. In reply, Neptune cantered home in 35.5 overs, losing four wickets. Skipper Nairith Gowda top-scored for Neptune with 42 off 52 balls.

Brief scores: Jayanagar United Cricketers: 141 all out in 38.3 overs (Naman Chauhan 38, Dhiyan Kanchan 2-17, Thosha S 5-29) lost to **Neptune CC: 143/4 in 35.5 overs** (Bennett Eugene 38, Nairith Gowda 42; Aksh Yadav 2-42).
Sangam CA: 188 all out in 47.4 overs (Likith V 58, Tolnur 54, Yetharth Gowda 30; Vishv Raddi 4-23, Kahaan Halani 2-34, Gagan Metre 2-16) lost to **Vijaya CC: 189/2 in 27.2 overs** (Tanush Mishra 76, Aerit Singh 40, Gagan 42n.o).
Bangalore Occasionals: 169/6 in 50 overs (Pranit Prabhakar 32n.o, Monish Milan 30; Chittera Gahan 2-30) vs **RVCE Gymkhana: 22 for no loss in 3.1 overs**. (Match called off due to rain).
Swastic Union CC (1): 254/7 in 50 overs (Ayush 95, Shreyas CM 50; Shreyas N 2-46, Lekhan BY 2-43) bt **Freelancers CC: 172 all out in 39 overs** (Sahil Sahani 30, Shreyas 35; Manikanta Shivu 3-23).
Cambridge CC: 230 all out in 47.1 overs (Deekshith 37, C Akshath 54, Nimith Bora 31; Rishith Reddy 2-42, Vijay Aditiya 2-49, Sangamesh Hariwal 2-29, Gagan Hegde 2-41) bt **YMCA CC (3): 136 all out in 40.2 overs** (Mohammed Patel 2-36, Viren Rajesh 2-21, Samrudh KR 3-25). **National Cricketers: 182/6 in 50 overs** (Joshua Batchu 39, Divit Mahajan 31, Vihan Chaudhary 32; Shaik Modin 3-41, Shivukumar B 2-34) vs **Minerva CC** (Match called off due to rain).
Bangalore United CC (1): 154 all out in 48.4 overs (Gurunareyana Venatesha 2-25, Mokshith Chalicheemala 2-17, Punith M 2-25, Pushkal Menda 2-9) lost to **Hammonds CC: 155/2 in 27.1 overs** (Arnav Reddy 40, MS Akilesh 64).
Young Lions Club: 438/2 in 50 overs (Sachith Yadav 118 (133b; 18x4), Yathin Gowda 31, Atharv Sagar Pal 262n.o (145b; 41x4, 9x6) vs **Wadiyar CC: 34/3 in 11.1 overs**. (Rain stopped play).
Century Cricketers: 237/6 in 44.2 overs (Nishant Dutta 104 (130b; 14x4), Revanth Reddy 32, Pothula Reddy 70; Dhruva NK 2-37) bt **South End SC: 159 all out in 35.1 overs** (Bhuvith S 47, Aniruddh 31, Tanay Bangera 35; Tanash Govila 2-17, Sathvik Holla 3-22) via VJD method. (Match interrupted by rains during the 1st innings and target was revised to 228 in 38 overs).

Vrinda fires Karnataka to victory

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Karnataka registered a 55-run win against Assam in the BCCI senior women's T20 trophy in Surat on Monday. Karnataka, who opted to bat, were off to a flyer, with **Vrinda Dinesh** scoring a 19-ball 52 that included seven fours and three sixes. Her opening-wicket stand of 62 runs off 5.3 overs with skipper Shubha Satheesh (39) laid the platform for Karnataka as they scored 190/6. Niki Prasad also chipped in with 40. Assam never got into the chase, tottering at 15/3 as Shishira Gowda (2/23) scalped two wickets. An unbeaten knock from Khushi Sharma

CRICKET WRAP

(64n.o.) provided some stability, but Assam were restricted to 135/4, handing Karnataka the victory.
Brief scores: Karnataka: 190/6 in 20 overs (Shubha Satheesh 39, Vrinda Dinesh 52, Niki Prasad 40; Gyanashree Barman 2-36) bt **Assam: 135/4 in 20 overs** (Khushi Sharma 64n.o; Shishira Gowda 2-23).

Rohith named captain: Rohith Reddy will lead Karnataka in the Vijay Merchant Trophy, scheduled from Nov 14 in Lucknow.
Squad: Rohith Reddy (C), Niranjan Ashok, Samarth Suresh, Shivaraj R, Athreya Bhat (wk), Viaan Joshi, Bhuvan Gowda C, Preetham HG, Vidhat S, Ayush YS, Ashith Girish, Kushal KA, Aarush P Puthran (wk), Arnav Dere, Avaneesha SN. **Head Coach:** Adithya Sagar; **Assistant Coach**: CB Karthik; Manager: Suhas MS; **S&C Coach:** Pradyumna; **Physiotherapist**: Soumya M; **Performance Analyst**: Mohan R.

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Bangalore Times

TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 3, 2026
ADVERTORIAL, ENTERTAINMENT INDUSTRY PROMOTIONAL FEATURE

DON'T TAKE THE COURT FOR GRANTED: DELHI COURT REPRIMANDS NORA FOR NO-SHOW

Know what our critics say about the latest films P6

Scientists discover a yak from the Ice Age P4

Ragas, rhythms and rapture at the Whitefield Music Festival 2026 P5

HOT TAKES

Any feedback related to stories in Bangalore Times?
Mail us @bangalore.times@timesofindia.com

Fortunate to be part of a project that celebrates India, says Aditi

@theonlyadnan__

Aditi Rao Hydari on being among the muses for the 2027 Pirelli Calender shoot

Shrestha Mukherjee

A shower of flowers, a historic Indian landscape and a frame captured through the lenses of Norwegian photographer Sølve Sundsbø and Indian photographer Avani Rai, daughter of the late legendary photojournalist Raghu Rai, come together in the Pirelli Calendar 2027. For actress Aditi Rao Hydari, being part of this project was not just a career milestone, but an opportunity to be recognised alongside an extraordinary ensemble of women from across creative fields. Titled *India, Beyond a Single Gaze*, the landmark edition is the first in the calendar's history to be shot entirely in India. In a conversation with us, the *Heeramandi* actor reflects on being part of the project, the power of photography and why India cannot be defined through a single image.

CONTINUED ON 6

@buttu_iam27

AMID SECURITY CONCERNS, BIG B GREETS FANS BEHIND BULLETPROOF SHIELD

Amitabh Bachchan continued his 42-year Sunday tradition of greeting fans outside his Mumbai residence, Jalsa, on November 1. This time, however, security was heightened, and he waved to admirers from behind a transparent bulletproof enclosure following a recent bomb threat allegedly targeting the bungalow. Despite the precautions, Bachchan made sure not to disappoint his loyal fans.

Buzzstop

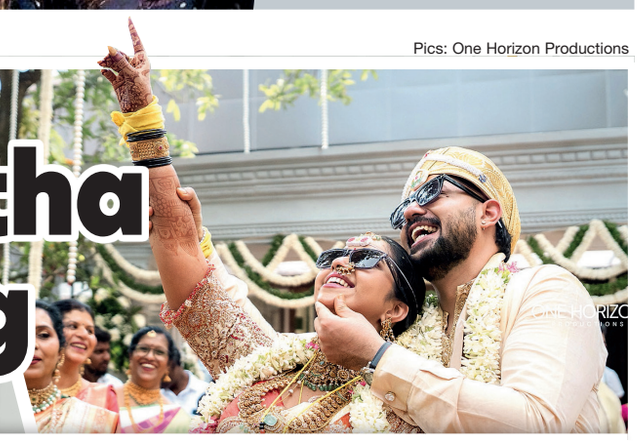
DIA MIRZA'S ANTI-POLLUTION MESSAGE FOR DIWALI TAKEN DOWN BY BMC

The Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) has removed an anti-firecracker video featuring **Dia Mirza** from its social media accounts after a political party chief, Ameet Satam, objected to the campaign followed the Bombay High Court directions on firecracker use in public spaces. In the video, Dia urged citizens not to burst crackers and contribute to noise pollution. Ameet said people did not need lessons on celebrating Diwali, citing cultural traditions. BMC has not explained the takedown. Videos featuring Madhuri Dixit and Ajinkya Rahane remain online.

Pics: One Horizon Productions

WHEN CHILDHOOD FRIENDS BECOME FAMILY:

Inside Pranam Devaraj and Namitha Gopal's intimate B'luru wedding



After four days of fun-filled wedding celebrations, Pranam and Namitha will host their reception on November 4

For senior actor Devaraj's family, celebrations took on a deeply personal note as his younger son, actor Pranam Devaraj, tied the knot with Namitha Gopal at a scenic resort tucked away on the outskirts of Bengaluru, near Nelamangala.

The intimate four-day celebration was conceptualised and steered entirely by the bride and her crew, who curated every detail to mirror their journey. And that journey runs remarkably deep. The groom's sister-in-law, dancer and actor Ragini Prajwal tells us, "The two families share a bond spanning more than 36 years, meaning Pranam and Namitha didn't just meet, they practically grew up together."

The festivities kicked off with high-energy sangeet and mehendi gatherings that featured special performances by Pranam's brother, actor Prajwal Devaraj and his wife, Ragini. This was followed by an intimate, sunlit haldi ceremony that brought the sprawling set of family and friends together. The traditional *muhurtham* on November 1 featured timeless rituals, laughter, and the familiar camaraderie that only decades of shared history can bring.

With the sacred vows taken, the couple and both households are now gearing up to conclude the celebrations with a grand reception on November 4, surrounded by extended fraternity friends and well-wishers.

MSN Research for Better Medicines — Public Awareness Initiative —

PULMONARY HYPERTENSION Awareness Month

MSN Research for Better Medicines — Public Awareness Initiative —

The Landscape of PH in India

Dr. B. C. Srinivas
Cardiologist, Bangalore

Pulmonary hypertension (PH) is an important but often under-recognised health problem in India. It is not a single disease; it can develop because of conditions affecting the heart, lungs, blood vessels or other organs. This makes understanding its underlying cause essential for appropriate treatment.

India faces a unique PH landscape. Conditions such as left-heart disease, rheumatic valvular disease, chronic lung disease, congenital heart disease and chronic blood clots in the lungs can contribute to PH. In the PRO-KERALA registry, which included 2,003 patients from 50 centres, PH associated with left-heart disease accounted for 59% of cases, while pulmonary arterial hypertension (PAH) accounted for 21.2%.

A major challenge is delayed recognition. Breathlessness, fatigue and reduced exercise capacity may initially be attributed to ageing, asthma or other common conditions. Echocardiography can raise suspicion of PH, while right-heart catheterisation remains important for confirming the diagnosis and measuring pulmonary haemodynamics.

India has made progress through specialised PH centres, registries and increasing awareness, but significant gaps remain in timely diagnosis, access to specialised investigations and guideline-directed treatment. Recent Indian expert consensus also highlights the need for better coordinated PH care.

Greater awareness among the public and healthcare professionals can help patients reach appropriate care earlier. Recognising persistent breathlessness as a possible warning sign is an important first step.

PH in Special Patient Groups

Dr. Sreekanth B. Shetty
Cardiologist, Bangalore

Pulmonary hypertension (PH) is a condition in which pressure in the blood vessels of the lungs becomes abnormally high, placing extra strain on the right side of the heart. Although PH can affect anyone, its causes, symptoms and treatment considerations may differ considerably in certain patient groups. Recognising these differences is important for timely diagnosis and appropriate care.

Children and adolescents may develop pulmonary hypertension because of congenital heart disease, developmental conditions or other underlying disorders. Symptoms such as breathlessness, poor exercise tolerance, fatigue or slow growth may be subtle. Evaluation by a team experienced in paediatric pulmonary hypertension is particularly important because disease behaviour and responses to treatment can differ between children and adults.

Pregnant women with pulmonary arterial hypertension (PAH) require especially careful planning. Pregnancy increases the workload on the heart and circulation and can pose significant risks in women with established PAH. Pre-pregnancy counselling and coordinated care involving PH, cardiology, obstetric and anaesthetic specialists are therefore essential.

People with connective tissue diseases, such as systemic sclerosis, may develop PAH as a complication. Regular assessment for symptoms and appropriate screening can help identify pulmonary vascular disease earlier.

Older adults frequently have multiple conditions, including heart failure, valvular heart disease and chronic lung disease, which can cause or contribute to PH. In these patients, distinguishing PH related to left-heart or lung disease from PAH is important because treatment approaches differ. Echocardiography, pulmonary function testing, imaging and, when necessary, right-heart catheterisation may help establish the underlying cause.

Ultimately, PH should not be treated as one disease with one treatment strategy. Understanding the patient's age, associated diseases, pregnancy status and underlying cause allows doctors to individualise evaluation and management. Early recognition and referral to a specialised PH centre can be particularly valuable when the diagnosis is complex or uncertain.

Early Testing for Better Outcomes

Dr. Sanjay Bhat
Cardiologist, Bangalore

Many serious health conditions do not cause obvious symptoms in their early stages. Pulmonary hypertension (PH) is one such condition. It occurs when the blood vessels in the lungs become narrowed, blocked or otherwise affected, making it harder for the heart to pump blood through the lungs. Because early symptoms can be mild or easily attributed to other causes, diagnosis may sometimes be delayed.

One of the most important warning signs is unexplained breathlessness, particularly during activities that were previously comfortable. Persistent tiredness, reduced exercise capacity, dizziness, chest discomfort or fainting may also require medical evaluation. Swelling of the feet or ankles can occur in more advanced disease.

Early testing does not mean that everyone with breathlessness has PH. Instead, it helps doctors determine whether symptoms are related to the heart, lungs or another underlying condition. A detailed medical history and physical examination are usually the first steps.

Recommended tests such as an electrocardiogram (ECG), chest imaging, lung-function tests and echocardiography. An echocardiogram is a non-invasive ultrasound examination of the heart that can provide important clues about pressure in the pulmonary circulation and how well the heart is functioning. Depending on the findings, additional investigations may be needed to identify the cause.

When pulmonary hypertension is strongly suspected, right-heart catheterization may be performed. This specialized test directly measures pressures within the heart and pulmonary arteries and is used to confirm the diagnosis and characterize the condition.

Early diagnosis can be particularly important because PH has several possible causes, and treatment depends on the underlying type. Identifying associated heart or lung disease, blood-clot-related conditions or other causes allows doctors to choose appropriate management. The message for the public is simple: persistent or unexplained breathlessness should not be ignored. Seeking medical advice early can help identify the cause, avoid unnecessary delays and provide an opportunity for appropriate treatment and follow-up.

Recognizing Early PH Warning Signs

Dr. Satish K S
Pulmonologist, Bangalore

Pulmonary hypertension (PH) is a condition in which pressure in the blood vessels of the lungs becomes abnormally high. The increased pressure can make the right side of the heart work harder to pump blood through the lungs. Because PH can develop gradually, its early warning signs may be subtle and are sometimes mistaken for ageing, lack of fitness or other heart and lung problems. Recognizing these changes early can help patients receive appropriate evaluation sooner.

One of the most important early symptoms is unexplained breathlessness, particularly while walking, climbing stairs or performing activities that were previously comfortable. Persistent fatigue and a noticeable reduction in exercise capacity may also be early clues. A person may find themselves stopping more frequently during routine activities or taking longer to recover after exertion.

Other warning signs include dizziness, light-headedness, chest discomfort, a rapid or irregular heartbeat and episodes of fainting. Swelling of the feet, ankles or legs can occur when the right side of the heart begins to struggle with the increased workload. Fainting during physical activity or rapidly worsening breathlessness should receive prompt medical attention.

It is important to remember that these symptoms are not specific to PH. Similar complaints can occur with asthma, chronic lung disease, anaemia, coronary artery disease and other conditions. Therefore, symptoms alone cannot establish a diagnosis.

When PH is suspected, doctors may perform a clinical examination along with tests such as electrocardiography, blood tests, oxygen assessment, pulmonary function tests and echocardiography. Echocardiography can identify changes that raise suspicion of PH and assess right-heart function. In appropriate patients, right-heart catheterization is used to confirm the diagnosis and directly measure pressures within the pulmonary circulation.

People with conditions that increase the risk of PH—such as connective tissue diseases, congenital heart disease, chronic lung disease or previous blood clots—may require particular attention to new or worsening symptoms.

The key message is simple: persistent or unexplained breathlessness should not be ignored. Recognizing early warning signs and seeking timely medical evaluation can help identify PH and its underlying cause, allowing appropriate management and regular follow-up.

Adults Living with Congenital Heart Defects

Dr. Yogesh Kothari
Cardiologist, Bangalore

Advances in medical care have enabled many children born with congenital heart defects (CHD) to survive into adulthood. Today, a growing number of adults are living active and fulfilling lives despite having a heart condition from birth. However, reaching adulthood does not always mean that the heart problem has disappeared.

Congenital heart defects are structural problems of the heart that develop before birth. Some are mild and may require little or no treatment, while others require medicines, catheter-based procedures, or surgery during childhood. Even after successful treatment, adults with CHD may need lifelong medical follow-up because their heart can change over time.

Some adults may experience symptoms such as breathlessness, unusual tiredness, palpitations, dizziness, swelling of the legs, or reduced ability to exercise. These symptoms should not simply be attributed to ageing, stress, or lack of fitness. In some cases, they may indicate an underlying heart or lung complication that needs medical attention.

Regular follow-up with a cardiologist familiar with adult congenital heart disease can help identify problems early. Depending on the type of defect, doctors may monitor heart rhythm, heart function, blood pressure, oxygen levels, and pulmonary circulation. Some patients may also develop pulmonary hypertension, a condition involving increased pressure in the blood vessels of the lungs, which can require specialized evaluation and treatment.

Lifestyle also plays an important role. Maintaining a healthy weight, staying physically active according to medical advice, avoiding smoking, following prescribed medicines, and attending regular check-ups can support long-term heart health.

Adults with congenital heart defects can lead productive lives, pursue careers, build families, and remain socially active. The key is recognizing that a repaired heart may still require lifelong care.

With regular monitoring, timely treatment, and greater awareness, adults living with congenital heart defects can continue to look forward to a healthier and more active future.

Understanding Eisenmenger Syndrome

Dr. Karthik Vasudevan
Cardiologist, Bangalore

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Managing Stress While Living with PH

Dr. K. Subramanyam
Cardiologist, Bangalore

Living with pulmonary hypertension (PH) can be challenging. Breathlessness, fatigue, limitations on physical activity and concerns about the future may contribute to stress, anxiety or low mood. These emotional challenges can affect sleep, daily activities and overall quality of life. Current PH guidelines emphasise a holistic approach that includes the patient's physical and psychosocial well-being.

Managing stress begins with understanding the disease and following the prescribed treatment plan. Medicines should be taken regularly and should not be stopped or changed without medical advice. Keeping regular appointments also helps doctors monitor symptoms, exercise capacity and heart function.

Simple strategies can help. Practising slow, relaxed breathing, meditation, gentle relaxation exercises and maintaining a regular sleep routine may help reduce everyday stress. Physical activity should be individually tailored; patients should discuss suitable exercise with their healthcare team rather than suddenly starting strenuous activity.

Talking openly with family members, friends or a counsellor can provide emotional support. Patient support groups may also help individuals feel less isolated and learn practical ways of coping with a chronic condition.

It is equally important to recognise persistent anxiety, sadness, sleep problems or loss of interest in usual activities.

These symptoms should be discussed with a healthcare professional because mental health is an important part of comprehensive PH care.

With appropriate medical treatment, emotional support and healthy coping strategies, patients can better manage stress and focus on maintaining their quality of life.

Bridging the Awareness Gap in PH

Dr. (Prof.) Prasanna Kumar T
Pulmonologist, Bangalore

Breathlessness is often considered a normal part of getting older, being unfit or simply being tired. However, in some people, it may be a sign of an underlying condition called pulmonary hypertension (PH). Despite affecting people across different age groups, PH remains relatively unfamiliar to the general public. This lack of awareness can sometimes lead to delays in diagnosis and treatment.

Pulmonary hypertension occurs when the blood pressure in the arteries that carry blood from the heart to the lungs becomes abnormally high. Over time, the increased pressure can place extra strain on the right side of the heart and affect its ability to pump blood efficiently.

One of the challenges with PH is that its early symptoms can be difficult to recognise. Breathlessness during routine activities, persistent tiredness, chest discomfort, dizziness, fainting and reduced exercise capacity may develop gradually. These symptoms can overlap with many other common conditions, making it easy to overlook the possibility of PH.

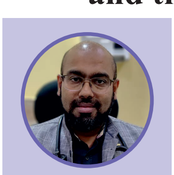
Improving awareness among the public is therefore important. People should understand that persistent or unexplained breathlessness is not always something to simply live with. When symptoms continue, particularly when they interfere with daily activities, seeking medical advice can help identify the underlying cause.

Awareness is also important among people living with conditions that may increase the risk of PH, such as certain heart or lung diseases, connective tissue disorders and congenital heart conditions. Recognising warning signs and discussing them with a healthcare professional can support earlier evaluation.

Diagnosis may involve several tests, including an echocardiogram, lung function tests, imaging and blood tests. In selected cases, right heart catheterization may be used to confirm pulmonary hypertension.

Bridging the awareness gap does not mean creating fear. It means helping people recognise important symptoms and encouraging timely medical evaluation. Better awareness, earlier recognition and appropriate medical care can help people with pulmonary hypertension manage their condition and maintain a better quality of life.

Congenital Heart Disease and the PH Burden in India



Dr. Thabit Ahmed
Cardiologist, Bangalore

Congenital heart disease (CHD) refers to structural problems of the heart that are present from birth. Advances in diagnosis and treatment mean that many children born with CHD now survive into adulthood. However, for some patients, the condition can have long-term consequences, including pulmonary hypertension (PH)—high blood pressure in the blood vessels that carry blood from the heart to the lungs.

In some congenital heart defects, abnormal openings between the chambers of the heart allow excessive blood flow to the lungs. Over time, this increased pressure and flow can damage the pulmonary blood vessels. If left untreated, these changes may become progressive and, in severe cases, difficult to reverse.

India faces particular challenges in addressing this burden. Many patients with CHD may not be diagnosed early, particularly when symptoms are mild during childhood. Limited awareness, delayed referral to specialist centres, and unequal access to advanced cardiac investigations can further delay appropriate care. Adults who underwent treatment for CHD during childhood may also require lifelong follow-up, but regular monitoring is not always maintained.

Common warning symptoms include breathlessness during activity, unusual tiredness, dizziness, fainting, chest discomfort, and reduced exercise capacity. These symptoms should not simply be attributed to age, lack of fitness, or a busy lifestyle, particularly in someone with a known history of CHD.

Early diagnosis and appropriate follow-up are therefore essential. Echocardiography is an important initial investigation, while selected patients may require more detailed evaluation, including right heart catheterization, to accurately assess pulmonary pressures and confirm the diagnosis.

The management of CHD-associated PH depends on the underlying heart defect, the severity of pulmonary vascular disease, and the individual patient's clinical condition. Treatment may involve correcting the congenital defect when appropriate, medicines for PH, and regular specialist monitoring.

India can reduce the long-term impact of CHD-associated PH through earlier detection, timely referral, better access to specialist care, and continued follow-up from childhood into adulthood. Recognizing symptoms early and seeking medical evaluation can make an important difference in the lives of patients living with congenital heart disease.

Can PH Be Managed Without Medication?

Dr. G. Vivek
Cardiologist, Bangalore

Pulmonary hypertension (PH) is a complex condition, and whether it can be managed without medication depends on its type, underlying cause and severity. For many patients, particularly those with pulmonary arterial hypertension (PAH), disease-specific medicines are an important part of treatment and should not be stopped or replaced with lifestyle measures without medical advice.

However, non-drug measures play an important supportive role. Treatment of the underlying cause is essential. For example, in PH associated with lung disease, optimising lung disease, correcting significant low oxygen levels and managing sleep-disordered breathing are important. In PH related to left-heart disease, treating the underlying heart condition is central to management.

Healthy habits can also support overall well-being. Medically supervised exercise or rehabilitation, when appropriate, can improve exercise capacity. Avoiding tobacco smoke, maintaining a healthy weight, following recommended vaccinations and receiving psychosocial support can also contribute to comprehensive care.

Some forms of PH may require procedures rather than long-term PAH medicines. For example, selected patients with chronic thromboembolic pulmonary hypertension may benefit from pulmonary endarterectomy or balloon pulmonary angioplasty.

Therefore, PH should not be treated with lifestyle measures alone unless a specialist determines that this is appropriate. Accurate diagnosis, identification of the cause and regular medical assessment are essential to decide the safest and most effective treatment plan.

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It is during our darkest moments that we must focus to see the light - Aristotle

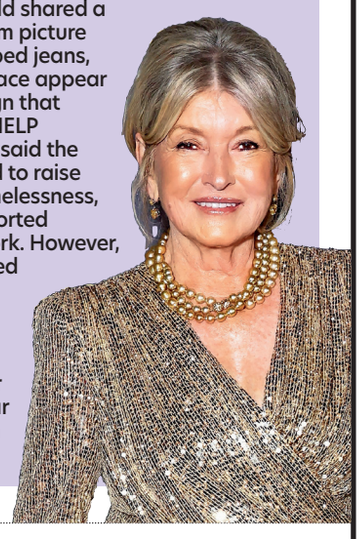
UP TO DATE WHAT'S #TRENDING AND WHY

Scientists discover mysterious yak-like mammal that roamed Siberia alongside Ice Age giants

Scientists have identified a previously unknown yak-like mammal that roamed Siberia during the Ice Age, alongside woolly mammoths and woolly rhinoceroses. Nicknamed 'Yak X', the extinct animal was identified from 20 tiny bone fragments recovered from sites in the Altai Mountains. Genetic analysis revealed that its evolutionary lineage separated from the ancestors of modern yaks around 400,000 years ago. "It is unusual, especially to recognize a large mammal species from small, unidentifiable fragments," evolutionary geneticist Love Dalén told *Reuters*. Researchers also believe the animal may have been hunted by Denisovans, an extinct group of human relatives whose remains were discovered in the same region. Genetic evidence suggests Yak X's population may have declined during a warmer period around 120,000 years ago. However, its youngest specimen dates to approximately 27,000 years ago, indicating that it survived at least until then.

Martha apologises over Halloween costume flak

American television personality and businesswoman Martha Stewart has apologised after facing criticism over her Halloween costume depicting a homeless person. The 85-year-old shared a now-deleted Instagram picture of herself wearing ripped jeans, makeup to make her face appear dirty and holding a sign that read, "I AM HUNGRY HELP ME!!" Initially, Stewart said the costume was intended to raise awareness about homelessness, an issue she has supported through charitable work. However, she later acknowledged that her response did not go far enough. "It's hard to admit when you've really screwed up. My earlier statement didn't go far enough," she wrote on Instagram.



Reese's production company cuts 30 jobs after buyback

Reese Witherspoon's production company Hello Sunshine has reportedly laid off around 30 employees, nearly half its workforce, following its reacquisition by the actor and French media group Mediawan. According to *Variety*, the restructuring will prioritise film and television production and Reese's Book Club, while scaling back direct-to-consumer operations. Witherspoon and Mediawan bought back the company from Candle Media in October, five years after its $900 million valuation.

SRK celebrates 61st birthday with King song release

Shah Rukh Khan marked his 61st birthday with special surprises for fans. His residence, Mannat, was decorated with larger-than-life projections featuring dialogues from his upcoming film *King*, including *King Akela Kaafi Hai* and *Darr Nahi, Dehshat Hoon*. The Bandra-Worli Sea Link was also illuminated with his pictures and birthday greetings. Adding to the celebrations, the makers of King released a romantic track, *Tu Mil Jaaye*, featuring Shah Rukh and Deepika Padukone. Sung by Arijit Singh and Madhubanti Bagchi, the song features an English rap penned by Ed Sheeran and is composed by Sachin-Jigar, with lyrics by Kumaar. Directed by Siddharth Anand, the film is scheduled for a worldwide theatrical release on December 24, 2026.

HOT TAKES

That time of the year when we all go nuts

POV

If you are planning to send, pass on, recycle or invest in (yet) another dry-fruit hamper this Diwali, think again. Because someone, somewhere is already drowning in a sea of nuts.

The Diwali dry-fruit box is a certain generation's equivalent of a store-bought greeting card. When you ran out of things to say, you picked a card. So when you see almonds, cashews, walnuts, pistachios, raisins, or a few dates, neatly stacked in a plastic or velvet-lined tray, you know someone is wishing you prosperity, goodwill and, most importantly, remembered you.

But the customised hamper has arrived, and it is exuding some serious main-character energy. There are Japanese-style cookie *mithais*, baklavas, kunafas, artisanal chocolates, flavoured nuts, gourmet preserves, exotic teas and enough imported delicacies to make you wonder whether it is Diwali or an international food festival. Some hampers even require an instruction manual.

Image generated by AI

Against this backdrop of flavours, colours, textures and Instagram-worthy designs (some straight out of a Wes Anderson frame), comes the humble dry-fruit tray. The household's collective response is a barely concealed: "Oh no, not another one!" The almonds are perfectly good, the cashews perfectly respectable, but there are already three trays occupying the dining table, two in the refrigerator and one that nobody can quite remember who sent.

Of course, one must be grateful. Dry fruits are expensive, nutritious and have a perfectly respectable cultural pedigree. Their association with prosperity and festive abundance goes back generations. But there is a difference between appreciating a tradition and being buried under its annual inventory. Besides, an almond from any angle is still an almond. Brown, familiar and hardly photogenic.

So, dear friends and associates, a gentle plea. If you are contemplating a dry-fruit box, please declare your intentions early. People need to plan storage, distribution and, if necessary, discreet onward gifting. Alternatively, surprise us with something we haven't encountered in the previous 17 hampers.

And if you absolutely must send dry fruits, at least make sure they are the last ones to arrive. An infinite capacity for cashews is not among Diwali's many blessings.

Agree? Disagree? Got a POV idea? **Write to us at:** pov@timesofindia.com

LEISURE

SUDOKU CHALLENGE

Level: Medium

		8	3		7			2
	4			8		1	9	
				5				
					9	2	7	
3								8
	5	7	2					
				6				
	3	9		4			6	
4			7		5	8		

HOW TO PLAY

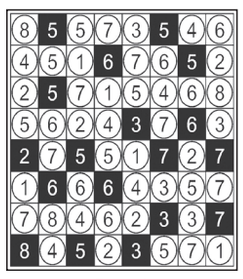
Fill in the grid so that every horizontal row, every vertical column and every 3x3 box contains the digits 1-9, without repeating the numbers in the same row, column or box.You can't change the digits already given in the grid. Every puzzle has one solution.

TIMES HITORI

HOW TO PLAY

1. A number may appear just once in each row or column. Eliminate repeat numbers by darkening cells. (see example)
2. Darkened cells must never be adjacent in a row or column.
3. Unmarked cells must create a single continuous area, undivided by darkened cells.
4. Every time you darken a cell, you can automatically circle its vertical and horizontal neighbours, which means they cannot be eliminated.
5. Any cell "sandwiched" between neighbours of the same value can be circled. (e.g. 6 (4) 6)
6. A "triple" is a special case of sandwich. Circle the centre cells, and darken the ends. (e.g. 6 6 6)

4	3	5	4	7	1	2	8
4	1	5	9	7	6	3	8
9	2	4	4	1	1	8	3
7	7	7	5	7	2	7	4
3	5	6	1	4	8	9	2
4	4	5	2	6	4	5	4
1	9	3	1	8	4	7	5
8	8	8	7	2	1	1	6

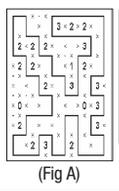


Example

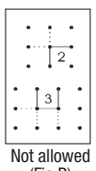
LOOP THE LOOP

RULES

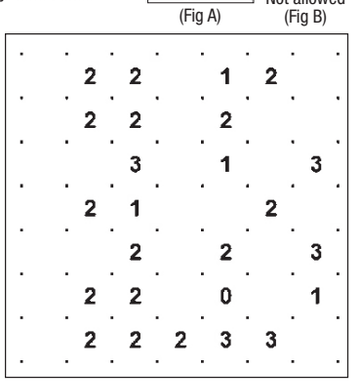
- Connect adjacent dots with vertical or horizontal lines, creating a single loop (Fig A).
- Crossovers or branches are not allowed (As shown by dotted lines in Fig B).
- Numbers in the puzzle indicate the number of lines that should surround it, while empty cells may be surrounded by any number of lines.
- You can't draw lines around zeroes.
- Each puzzle has just one unique solution.



(Fig A)



Not allowed (Fig B)

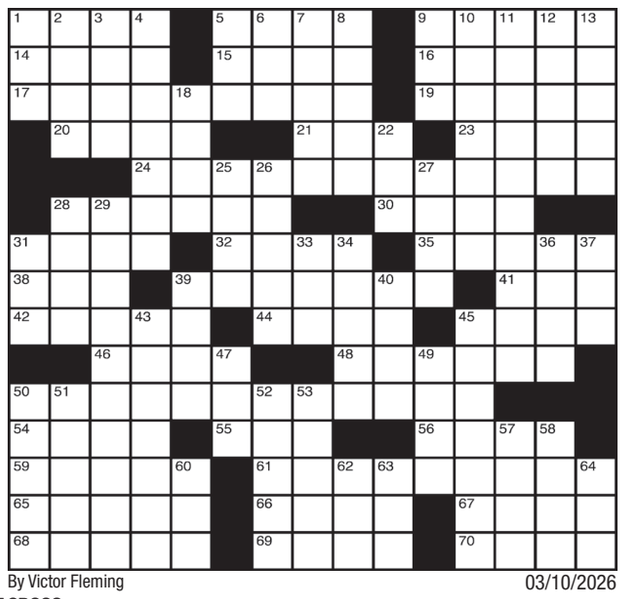


HOW TO BEGIN:

Example (Fig A) - Begin with the zero next to 3. Since no lines can be drawn around zero, mark crosses around it, as shown. Now there is a cross in one space around 3. So we know the three lines of 3 can only be drawn in the remaining three spaces. Next, these lines can only be extended in one direction each. Continue, using the same logic.

Hints: Keep eliminating possibilities by marking crosses in spaces between dots where a line isn't possible, i.e., if you have already completed required lines or where a line extension may create a branch or cause a deadend **(Fig B)**.

THE DAILY CROSSWORD



By Victor Fleming 03/10/2026

ACROSS

1 Cherry centers
5 Eco-friendly commuting option
9 Big blowout
14 2026's "The Odyssey," for one
15 Workplace inspection org.
16 Pry bar, e.g.
17 *Broad-brimmed topper made of straw
19 New Zealand native
20 Olympic swimmer Torres
21 Mauna __: Hawaiian volcano slightly taller than Mauna Loa
23 Soapy tub gunk
24 *Dry-cured meats from Smithfield
28 Bartending tool
30 Chatted privately online, for short
31 Greek god of war
32 Owlet's home
35 Smells
38 Steeped beverage
39 *Seattle NFL player
41 French "yes"
42 Coffeehouse flavor
44 Use a keyboard
45 Torso bones
46 Will beneficiary
48 Art studio stands
50 *Joe Biden's vice president
54 Grew older
55 Grumpy pal
56 Respiratory organ
59 Lost color
61 Puzzle solver's breakthrough, or what the answers to the starred clues have in common
65 Maker of soccer and rugby gear
66 Part in a film
67 Big birds of Australia
68 Fluff, as hair
69 Raggedy Ann, e.g.
70 Nothing to write home about

DOWN

1 __ talk: motivational chat
2 Apple tablet since 2010
3 Writer/actress Fey
4 Woolen wraps
5 Feathery wrap
6 Sorta
7 Tan kin
8 Gobbled up
9 Racial justice movement letters
10 Like a dog who's ready for a walk
11 Healthy fat with a high smoke point
12 Skin care product
13 Cuts back a bit
18 Major water pipe
22 Provide support
25 Russo of "Major League"
26 "Awesome!"
27 Totally wild
28 Creme-filled sandwich
29 French dessert with fruit and ice cream
31 Drive-thru device
33 Timid
34 Slender candle
36 Massages
37 Bro kin
39 Catamaran feature
40 __ and tear
43 Web page banners
45 Job applicants' submissions
47 "Awesome!"
49 Rural storage tower
50 Broken beyond repair
51 Athlete's best effort
52 Accumulate excessively
53 "Bless you" preceder
57 Reef-dwelling Pixar character
58 African antelopes
60 Female deer
62 __-purpose flour
63 Blanc who voiced Bugs
64 Chinese menu general

Monday's Puzzle Solved

A	B	B	A		F	O	M	O		M	A	C	Y	S
S	E	E	R		L	A	I	C		A	W	A	I	T
K	N	E	E	P	A	T	C	H		J	E	R	K	Y
S	E	T	T	O		E	A	R	L	E		D	E	E
			H	E	R	S	H	E	Y	S	K	I	S	S
D	E	B	A	T	E				E	T	A			
O	R	E			D	O	R	A		I	T	S	O	K
H	I	T	S	F	O	R	T	H	E	C	Y	C	L	E
A	C	H	O	O		B	E	A	R			A	D	D
			L	O	S				A	D	O	R	E	S
F	A	C	E	T	H	E	M	U	S	I	C			
A	D	A		P	E	S	O	S		E	T	U	D	E
K	A	P	P	A		S	O	U	L	M	A	T	E	S
E	G	R	E	T		A	L	A	I		V	I	E	S
R	E	A	C	H		Y	A	L	E		E	L	M	O

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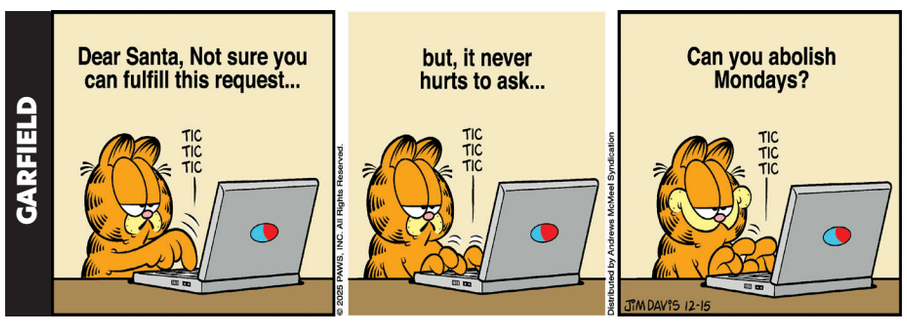
GARFIELD



SCRAMBLE

Rearrange the letters in the four word jumbles, one letter to each square/circle, to make four ordinary words

KNAEO
IYSSS
GLTIIN
RAPPED

HOW TO PLAY

Now arrange the letters in the circles to form the answer to the riddle or to fill in the missing word as indicated

We are ne'er like angels till our ___ __. - Thomas Dekker (7,4)

EVENTS

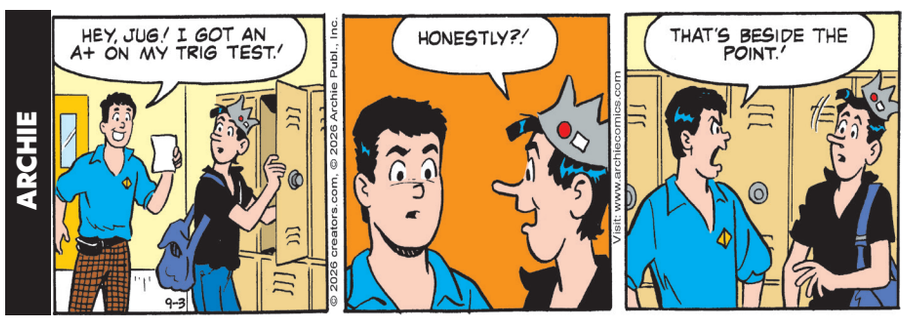
WORKSHOPS

DIY Water Candle: Join session to combine water, liquid layers, natural botanicals and cooking oil to make candles at Espressoulster Coffee in Koramangala on November 3 from 3 pm onwards.

Blindfold Art Date: Join this unique bonding session with your friend or partner over canvas and paints at The Rendezvous in Koramangala on November 3 from 2 pm onwards.

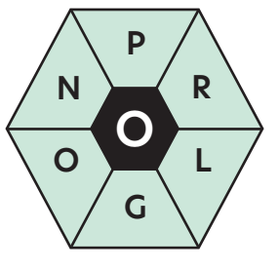
Email us at bangalore.times@timesofindia.com

ARCHIE



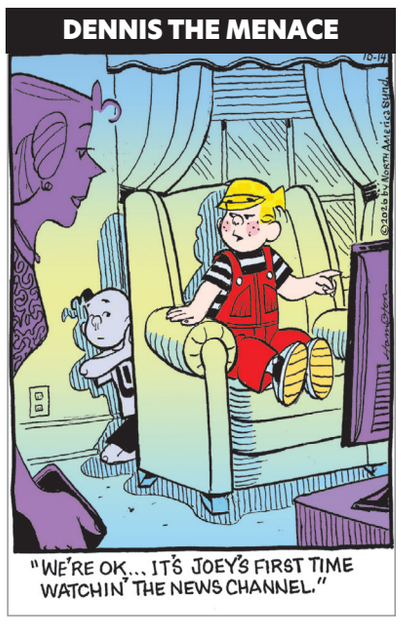
SPELLATHON

Today's Ratings:
07-average | 08-good | 10-outstanding



How many words of four or more letters can you make from the letters shown in today's puzzle? In making a word, a letter can be used as many times as it appears in the puzzle. Each word must contain the central letter. There should be at least one seven letter word. Plurals, foreign words and proper names are not allowed. British English Dictionary is used as reference.

DENNIS THE MENACE



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See what the stars have in store for you - according to your moon sign.

ARIES: There is no point being possessive about something you have in your grasp but fear losing. The planets warn that the more you try to hold on to it the more likely it is you will lose it, so enjoy it but employ a gentler grip.

TAURUS: The more you try to pry secrets out of family and friends over the next 24 hours the more they will keep what they know to themselves. Pretend like you don't care while keeping your eyes open and your ears tuned.

GEMINI: Money matters will take centre stage now, and it's likely you will either splash out extravagantly or refuse to spend your hard-earned cash at all. Take a more balanced path.

CANCER: Don't think of yourself as a star in the making; think of yourself as a big star already who is about to become absolutely huge.

LEO: You will notice that one-to-one situations become a bit more abrasive. Even so, there will still be plenty of opportunities to join with others in causes you can all believe in.

VIRGO: Do what makes you feel good today, but strive to be aware of the effect your actions have on other people. If your needs clash with the needs of others, it does not have to be an either-or game – it's quite possible both sides can win.

LIBRA: Dealing with employers and other authority figures gets a bit tense. Make sure they know you are not the sort to be intimidated.

SCORPIO: You will not only go the extra mile to reach your aims this week, but you will go the extra mile – whatever it takes. At this time of year, your frame of mind is so positive that your most outrageous dreams will soon become realities.

SAGITTARIUS: You are sure to have plenty to say for yourself but try not to be too verbally aggressive, or you could turn people against you. Everything you say must have a positive aim.

CAPRICORN: This is the ideal time to do a bit of self-analysis. Try to get rid of all that is old and outdated in your mind. Be ruthless with your ideas and opinions. It will help immensely.

AQUARIUS: You will face some challenges over the next few weeks and will need to be on your toes both physically and mentally. The good news is no effort will be too much for you to make.

PISCES: Creative activities will go well for you now and if you get serious about an idea you previously just toyed with it could bring the kind of recognition you secretly crave. Have faith in the vision you have been nurturing – it will bloom very soon.

SOLUTIONS TO GAMES/PUZZLES

TIMES SUDOKU

4	1	6	7	2	5	8	3	9
2	3	9	8	4	1	7	6	5
8	7	5	9	6	3	4	2	1
9	5	7	2	3	8	6	1	4
3	2	1	4	7	6	9	5	8
6	8	4	5	1	9	2	7	3
7	9	2	1	5	4	3	8	6
5	4	3	6	8	2	1	9	7
1	6	8	3	9	7	5	4	2

LOOP THE LOOP

TIMES HITORI

6	1	7	2	8		3	5	4
1	9	3	6	5	4	7	8	2
3	5	6	1	4	8	9	2	7
4	7	5	2	9	1	8	3	6
9	2	4	1	7	6	3	5	8
4	1	9	7	6	3	2	8	5
8	3	2	5	1	9	4	7	1
5	6	1	4	8	2	9	1	3
2	4	8	9	3	5	1	6	7

SPELLATHON

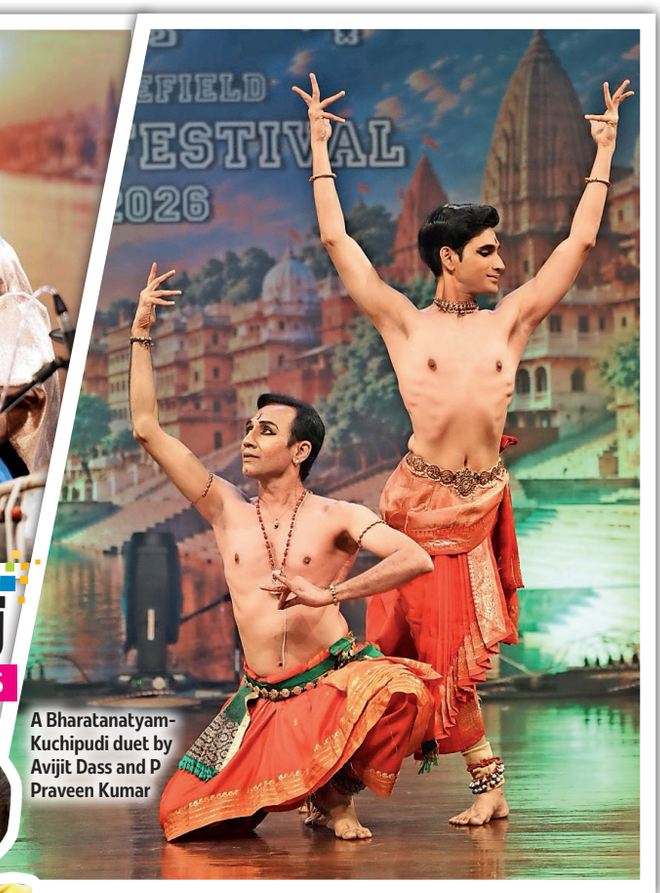
goon, logo, long, loon, loop, polo, pool, poor, PROLONG, prong

SCRAMBLE

Words: Oaken, sissy, tiling, dapper
Answer: We are ne'er like angels till our passion dies. - Thomas Dekker

Ragas, rhythm and rapture at Whitefield Music Festival 2026

Hindustani and Carnatic vocalists Rina Basu and Phaniraj Shivakumar



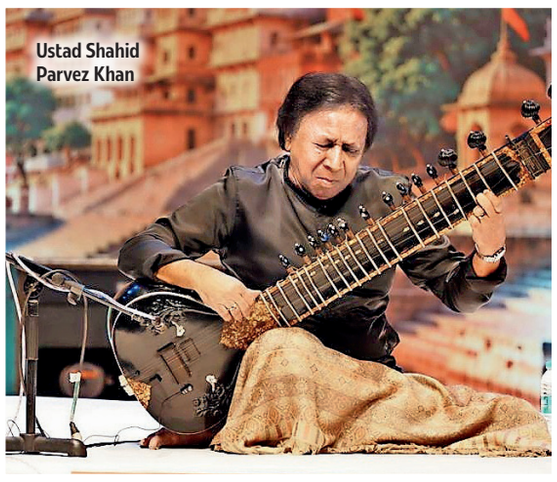
A Bharatanatyam-Kuchipudi duet by Avijit Dass and P Praveen Kumar

SNAPSHOTS

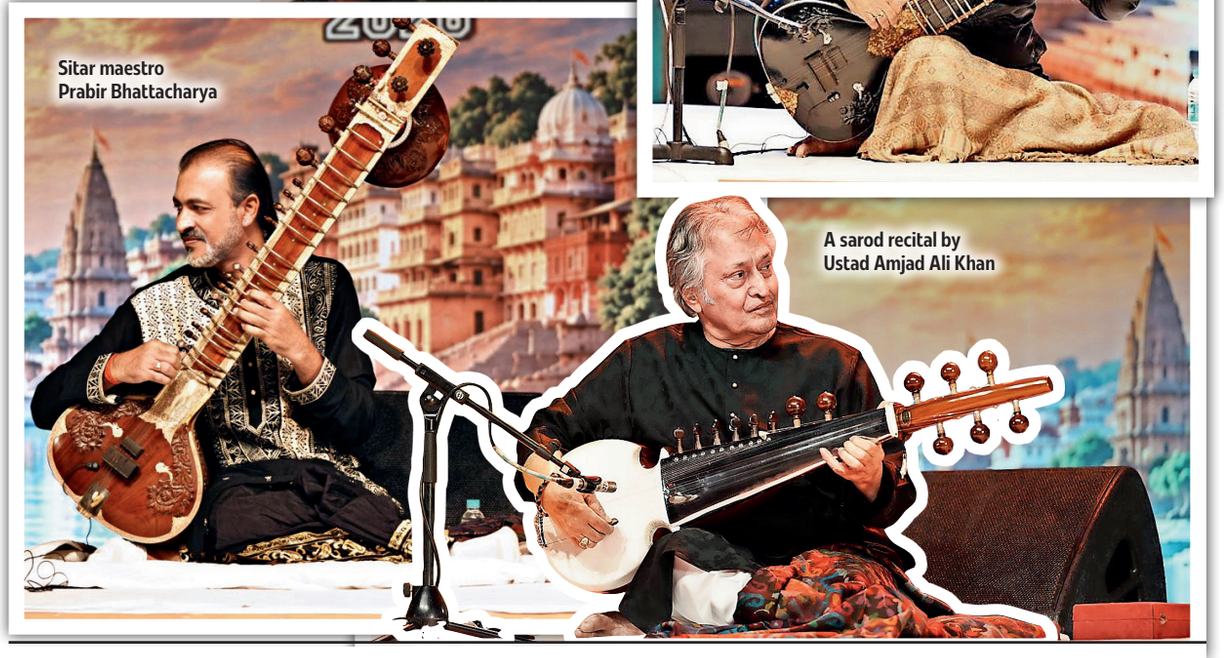
Three days. Countless ragas. One unforgettable celebration of Indian classical music. The 10th edition of the Whitefield Music Festival in Bengaluru brought together some of the country's finest maestros. Among the highlights were a violin recital by Dr L Subramaniam, accompanied by Pt Anindya Chatterjee on tabla, and a dance *jugalbandi* featuring Avijit Dass in Kuchipudi and P Praveen Kumar in Bharatanatyam. The festival closed with a grand finale: a sarod recital by Ustad Amjad Ali Khan, joined by Pt Tanmay Bose on tabla, Giridhar Udupa on ghatam and Ravichandra Kullur on flute.

Karthikeyan Sairam

L Subramaniam



Ustad Shahid Parvez Khan



Sitar maestro Prabir Bhattacharya

A sarod recital by Ustad Amjad Ali Khan

AI-generated image for representational purpose only

'Every musical tradition has a story to tell'

Carnatic musician, educator and author Chitra Srikrishna on looking beyond playlists and genres to discover the stories, people and traditions that shape Indian music

Mehwash Hussain

Chitra Srikrishna

We listen to music on the move, discover songs through reels and build playlists around moods. Yet, in a world where music is always within reach, how often do we pause to understand what we are listening to, the traditions it comes from, the people who keep it alive, or the stories that give it meaning? For Carnatic musician, educator and author Chitra Srikrishna, this is an invitation to listen differently. Her work that took shape when she was teaching music appreciation at a university, *Band, Baaja, Bhava*, looks beyond familiar musical categories to explore the people, histories and traditions that make up India's diverse musical landscape. "I found the need to write stories that any reader, somebody who listens to music, can instantly relate to. The aim was to make Indian music accessible without relying on technical jargon," she says.

'MUSIC IS MORE THAN WHAT FITS INTO A PLAYLIST'

Chitra points out, "Short-form videos and endless scrolling have encouraged people to consume music in snippets rather than experience an entire musical composition. So, yes, we may be listening to more music, but are we really listening more deeply? Through my work here, I am urging people to listen more closely and listen deeply."

Listening deeply, however, is not just about spending more time with a piece of music. It is also about looking beyond the labels through which we tend to understand it. "Indian music is widely appreciated; however, it is often put into boxes of genres: classical, folk or devotional. But there is so much that connects these different traditions. I also realised there were so many musicians who were still undiscovered," explains Chitra. One such discovery was a Tarpa player who received national recognition. "When you look at folk music and folk musicians, so many remain undiscovered. It is a never-ending journey of discovery, like peeling the layers of an onion," she says. The stories she wanted to bring to readers focused not only on musical forms but also on the people navigating them. Women musicians, in particular, have had to negotiate barriers across genres. "Women have never had it easy. They have to work harder across genres from folk to classical to contemporary music. Hearing their voices represented and understanding what it takes for them to pursue music are stories that I felt had to be shared," she adds.

> **Women have never had it easy. They have to work harder across genres, right from folk and classical music to contemporary sounds**

That shift took her into unfamiliar territory, including desi hip-hop. She attended rapper Arivu's concert in Chennai, using the experience, alongside research and conversations, to understand music beyond the conventions she knew best. Ultimately, her work, she says, is an invitation to approach music with curiosity rather than familiarity. A song can be more than a favourite on a playlist; it can be a doorway into a community, a cultural tradition or the life of a musician whose story might otherwise go unheard. The more closely we listen, the more there is to discover.

Take time to do what makes your soul happy - Unknown

@akshat_rastogi22

There is no single way to be a woman, just as there is no single way to define India: Aditi

CONTINUED FROM 1

What was the concept behind your photographs?

For my photographs, I was showered with flowers, and there was a lovely idea of the flower becoming me and me becoming the flower. Flowers are woven into our everyday lives: we wear them in our hair, offer them in prayer, enjoy their fragrance and associate them with the gardens where we played as children. There is something delicate and beautiful about them, and their fragrance is something that lingers long after.

You share the calendar with women such as Padma Lakshmi, Anoushka Shankar, and Freida Pinto, among others. What was it like sharing this platform with women from such different creative identities?

Something beautiful happens when women from different backgrounds and creative worlds come together. Each woman brings her own experiences, perspective and story, which makes the collective so interesting. What I find particularly meaningful about this calendar is that it brings together women who have carved their own paths across different fields. There is no single way to be a woman, just as there is no single way to define India. When these different identities share the same platform, they create a richer and more expansive picture of who we are. There is something powerful about celebrating individuality while being part of something larger than yourself. And a fun fact: there are three women from Hyderabad in the Cal – Bhavitha (Mandava), Avantika (Vandanapu) and me!

Pirelli has a distinctive legacy in fashion and fine-art photography. In an age when we consume images rapidly, often scrolling past hundreds on social media, what gives a photograph the ability to stay with us?

I think what makes a photograph memorable is its ability to make you feel something, evoke an emotion or leave you with a thought long after you have seen it. Unlike a film, which unfolds over time, a photograph captures a single moment, yet it can hold an entire story within it. For me, a photograph stays with you when it makes you curious, moves you or allows you to see something familiar in a completely different way.

'It's a bucket-list moment for me'

Describing the significance of being a part of The Cal, she shares, "It is not something I could have ever imagined or planned. I was chosen to be part of this narrative, and I was thrilled to be included. It is certainly a bucket-list moment for me. The calendar is iconic and has been a collector's piece since its very first edition, so being part of an edition that celebrates India in such a distinctive way feels incredibly special. It is also an opportunity to be part of something that goes beyond my work as an actor. I feel fortunate to have been chosen alongside such extraordinary women."

The actor with fellow Hyderabadi Bhavitha Mandava and Anoushka Shankar at the Cal unveiling in Delhi

'The fact that Avani Rai has continued and integrated her father Raghu Rai's legacy is beautiful and poweful'

Speaking about the shoot, Aditi shares, "I think they add extraordinary depth to the way India is seen and understood. Every photographer brings a distinct sensibility, shaped by their experiences, influences and relationship with their subject. Raghu Rai's incredible six-decade photographic archive is an important part of India's visual history, and the fact that Avani Rai has continued and integrated that legacy is beautiful and powerful. To have that photographic history come into conversation with Sølve Sundsbø's distinctive artistic vision creates a fascinating dialogue between different perspectives and generations. It reminds us that the way we see a country is constantly evolving, even as its history and memories continue to inform the present."

FILM REVIEWS
NOW IN CINEMAS...

A reminder that good friends make a difference in lives

CHANDRAHAASA
(Family Drama)
★★½
Cast: Harish Hiriyur, Chayashree Umesh, Ningaraju Mandya, Santhosh Keri
Director: Anand Shivappa Kalakabandi
Duration: 2hrs, 9mins
Language: Kannada (UA)

Should you watch it?
Watch it for a simple story with relatable characters and a meaningful message.

Review in short

Set in a small town in North Karnataka, *Chandrahaasa* is a family drama that follows Somasekhar, an unemployed young man who struggles to embrace responsibility after marriage. While his genuine friend Chandra encourages him to mend his ways, Santhu leads him towards cricket betting and the lure of quick money. As poor financial decisions leave him burdened with debt and social embarrassment, Somasekhar is forced to confront the consequences of his choices. The film explores friendship, family bonds and personal responsibility through a simple, relatable narrative. Though reminiscent of a television drama in its treatment, *Chandrahaasa* offers an accessible family entertainer with a straightforward message and reasonably good performances.

– Susmita Sameera

A hauntingly beautiful tale of love, loneliness and longing

PYRE
(Drama)
★★★★
Cast: Padam Singh, Heera Devi, Subhash Chandra, Shubham Chaudhary, Sadab Khan
Director: Vinod Kapri
Duration: 1 hr and 55 mins
Language: Hindi (U)

Should you watch it?
Watch it if you like a film that stays with you long after the credits roll.

Review in short

In writer-director Vinod Kapri's film about isolation and hope against hope, an elderly couple, Padam Singh (Padam Singh) and Tulsi (Heera Devi), living in a ghost village in Uttarakhand's Kumaon region, wait for their son, who left for Mumbai nearly 30 years ago and never returned. The movie heartrendingly depicts isolation, loneliness and enduring love, while portraying how migration turns remote places into ghost towns and how these regions are neglected. Manas Bhattacharyya's cinematography gives the film a beautiful yet wistful tonality. Padam Singh and Heera Devi are ordinary people who have never faced the camera before. The supporting cast also adds to the film's emotional resonance. Despite its leisurely pace, you remain invested in the story for its tender moments, heartbreaking silences and deeply moving portrayal of love and longing.

– Dhaval Roy

Want a more detailed review? Head to **etimes.in**

RATING SCALE
TRASH ★ | BELOW AVERAGE ★★ | AVERAGE ★★½ | ABOVE AVERAGE ★★★ | GOOD ★★★½ | VERY GOOD ★★★★ | OUTSTANDING ★★★★½ | MASTERPIECE ★★★★★